

The Teacher Game for the North Central High School Bicentennial Class of 1976

Bill Worstell

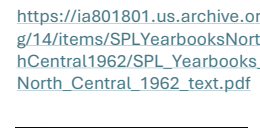
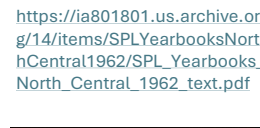
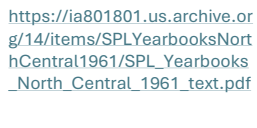
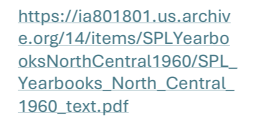
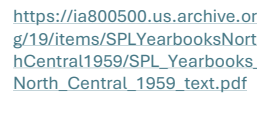
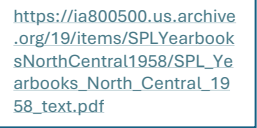
June 10, 2026

OK, so I got carried away with this, just a little.

I wanted to make a tribute to our teachers, and to use some AI tools to look them up and to gussy it up a little (similar to what I've done on a family history project). Over the last fifty years, I've made zillions of presentations in a whole lot of different styles – this style is “hyperlinked excess”. Don't even think of trying to read it all – it's for reference if you want to click on links. It's also a game, as you will see – let's see how good you are at remembering your teacher's names from 50 years ago!

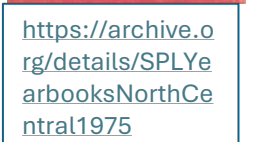
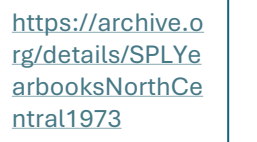
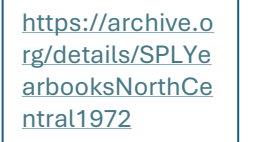
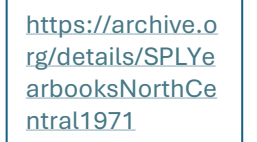
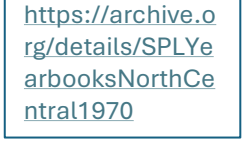
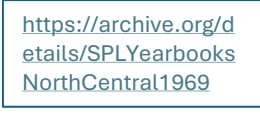
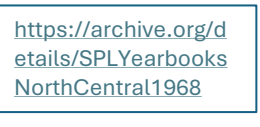
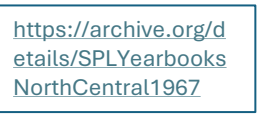
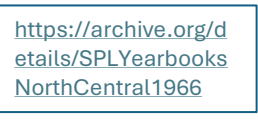
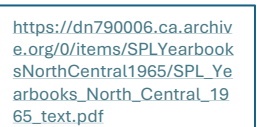
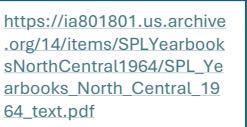
When the AI found an online stash of decade after decade of Tamaracks posted online by the Spokane Public Library, the rest was History.

The teachers selected here are those I remember best from our Senior Year. My apologies to the rest – but please look them up in the Tamaracks and in publically available bios/obits. It's easy, and the links are here to get you started.



tamarack

1976



Tell 'em what you're going to tell 'em (Outline)

The evolution of **North Central High School (NC)** mirrors the transformation of American public education, shifting from an elite, classical academy into a modern, comprehensive institution. As you prepare to celebrate the landmark **50th anniversary of the Class of 1976**, looking back reveals how the school adapted across four distinct eras.

1908: The Era of Classical Academies and Civic Pride

When North Central opened its doors in September 1908, it stepped into a national educational landscape heavily influenced by the **1893 Committee of Ten report**, which standardized high school as a rigid, academic preparation ground for college. High school was still considered optional, and Spokane was experiencing a massive population boom fueled by the railroads and mining.

- The Educational Philosophy:** High school was meant to refine the mind through a strict, classical curriculum. Rote memorization, public speaking, and mental discipline were paramount.

- The Environment:** NC opened with just 12 classrooms in a magnificent structure that was a testament to civic pride. The academic atmosphere was elite and formal, emphasizing Latin, Greek, classical literature, rhetoric, and advanced mathematics. Early milestone events included visits from monumental historical figures like **William Jennings Bryan** and **Booker T. Washington**, highlighting the school's focus on oratory and civic responsibility.



A group of cheerleaders from North Central High School huddle under umbrellas in the fall of 1943. Photo courtesy of North Central High School (Photo courtesy of North Central High School / The Spokesman-Review)

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/mar/02/then-and-now-early-spokane-schools/>

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Central_High_School_\(Spokane,_Washington\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Central_High_School_(Spokane,_Washington))

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2008/jun/05/nc-marks-centennial/>



South Central was first: “We see your colors flying high, it’s Halloween!”

Spokane: Early Education

By **Stephen B. Emerson** | Posted 8/08/2008 | HistoryLink.org Essay 8723

▶ 0:00 / 9:00 ———▶ 🔊 ⋮

<https://www.historylink.org/file/8723>



<https://www.spokesman.com/then-and-now/2022/jul/25/then-and-now-spokane-high-school/>

Which of our Teachers was a member of North Central's Class of 1947?

Theme Song: Good Rockin Tonight

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2nnOy_jbCa8&t=13s

Good Rockin Tonight

Song by Roy Brown



YouTube • TheBluesfan12

Roy Brown - Good Rockin' Tonight 1947



YouTube • Roy Brown - Topic

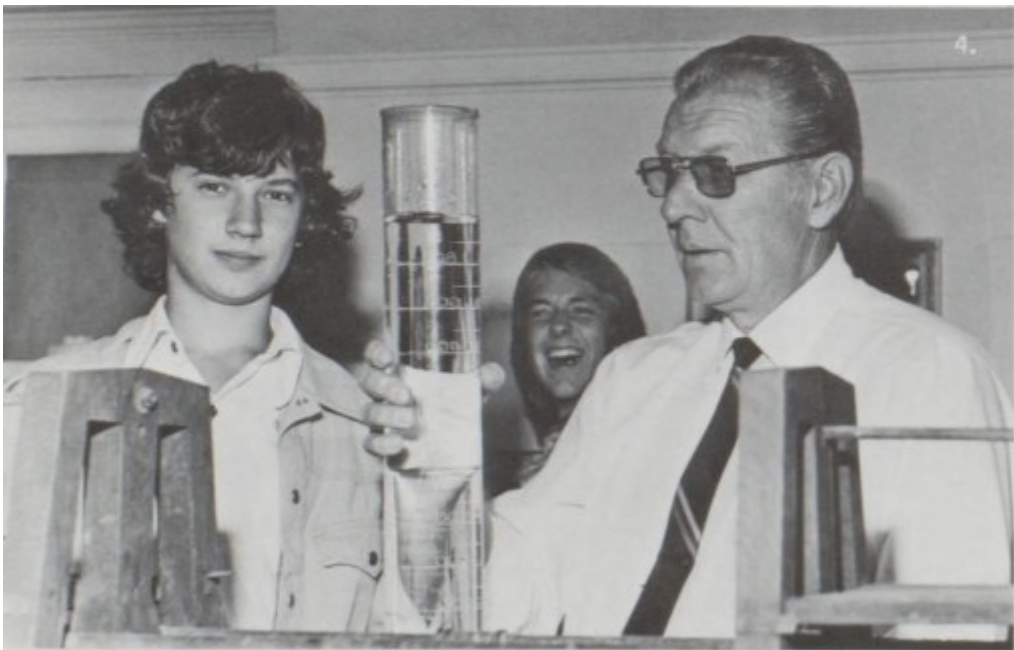
Good Rockin' Tonight

Provided to YouTube by Wnts Good Rockin' Tonight - Roy Brown Roy Brown,...

May 28, 2018



Simonson Photos



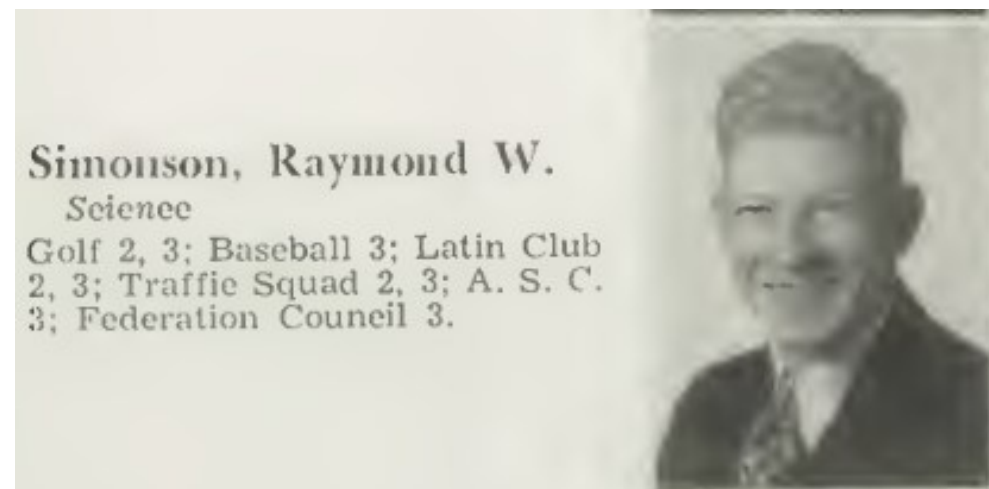
I found **yearbook and educational traces**, but **not a clean public obituary** for the North Central teacher Raymond Simonson in this pass. The public record trail is still useful. The strongest identification is that **Raymond Simonson was himself a North Central student before returning as a teacher**. The 1947 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson** among the January class students, and the 1952 Washington State College *Chinook* lists **Raymond Simonson, General, Spokane**, which fits a North Central graduate who later returned to Spokane Public Schools. ***For all I can find, he could be a near-centenarian and with us still.***

By **1954**, he was on the North Central faculty. In later yearbooks he is identified more specifically with **biology**, and sometimes **chemistry**: the 1956 *Tamarack* lists him in Science as **biology**; the 1958 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson, biology**; and the 1959 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson, chemistry**.

Age 18 in 1947, so born in 1929

He also had a substantial role in **boys' golf**. The 1959 *Tamarack* reports that a team coached by **Raymond Simonson** won the Lewiston Invitational Golf Tournament. The 1963 *Tamarack* says the varsity golf team, coached by Raymond Simonson, placed second in the fall All-City high-school tournament. In 1964 and 1965, he is listed with **Biology / Boys' Golf**, and in 1965 he is also listed with **Biology, Chemistry**.

He was still present in the 1970s. The 1972 *Tamarack* includes **Raymond Simonson** in a science/biology context, and 1976 evidence is consistent with a career continuing at least that long.





1947 Tamarack

Taking Five



thirty

What was NC like in 1947?

Associated Student Councils – Boy's Federation and Girl's League; Junior Red Cross; Color Girls; Red Feathers; News Staff; Tamarack Staff;

Orchestra, Choir, Three Fives; The N.C. Band; "Rosamunde" Operetta; "Papa Is All" drama;

Sports, Princesses and Pageants

Simonson, Raymond W.

Science

Golf 2, 3; Baseball 3; Latin Club 2, 3; Traffic Squad 2, 3; A. S. C. 3; Federation Council 3.



The Prom "and Graduation Dancers."



Who was the Earliest of our Teachers to Teach at NC?

Theme Song:

Sam's Song (The Happy Tune)

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sam%27s_Song_\(song\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sam%27s_Song_(song))

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uwwu5zp9OhM>



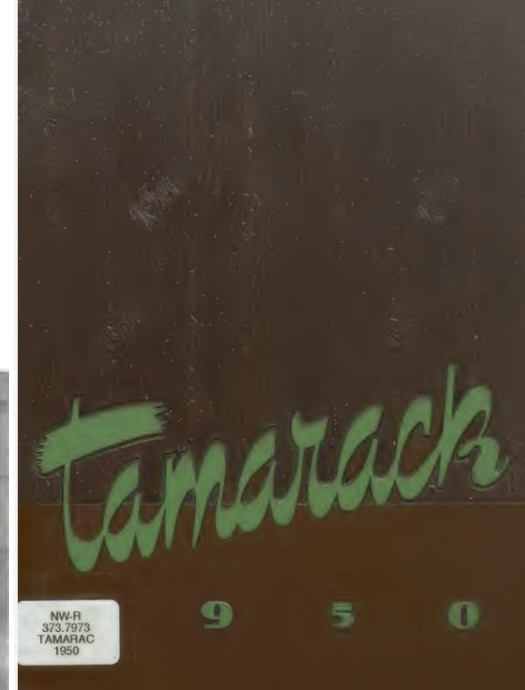
Sam's Song (The Happy Tune)



Bing Crosby

203K subscribers

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The Clubs did get a little weird in 1950: Conform!



John Rodkey
Social Studies
Senior Class Adviser

1954 Tamarack



1971 Tamarack

1972 Tamarack

1970 Tamarack

1955 Tamarack

1955 Tamarack

1973 Tamarack

1953 – age 30

**1974
Tamarack**

**1976
Tamarack**

**1975
Tamarack**

John P. Rodkey served as the beloved principal of North Central High School in Spokane, Washington, from 1959 until 1979. Born in 1921, he passed away on May 16, 2012. Before his long career in education, he served as a radio operator in the Army Air Forces during WWII.

Life and Legacy:

- **Background:** Born on a farm in Colorado, his family relocated to Post Falls, Idaho, during the Great Depression.
- **Career:** He spent 20 years at the helm of North Central High School, bringing deep compassion, grace, and energy to the student body.
- **Personal Life:** He was married, raised three children, and was a dedicated member of his church who valued faith, learning, and storytelling.

You can read more about his remarkable life or pay tribute through the full [Obituary for John P. Rodkey](#) published by Heritage Funeral & Cremation, or explore his legacy feature in the [Spokesman-Review](#).

John graduated from Whitworth College with his BA degree in Recreational Leadership in 1947 and a BA in Psych / Soc / Education in 1948. He later received his Master's Degree in Administration in 1958. He remained a loyal and active alum of Whitworth University. After student teaching at North Central High, he was hired to teach there after his college years. He taught from 1948 - '57, then served as Vice Principal of Shadle Park for the two opening-years, '57-'59. He then came back to NC as principal from '59-79.





My NC Institutional Lifetime Achievement Award

This goes to the Captain of our ship, Mr. Rodkey, here shown astride his majestic steed and approving the inaugural Rowdy Squad Regalia, and to his staff. In September, 1976 I was flying to Boston with a layover in Chicago when I discovered they had pinball machines there (that's me on the wall over there, with plenty of hair but no beard). Being skilled in the art and never tilting, I won a few bonus rounds, and missed my connecting flight. Mr. Rodkey, who had a brother in the Boston Area, had arranged for his brother to meet me at Boston Logan Airport and get me to Harvard Yard. When I did not arrive, he somehow tracked me down and got me there after dark to drop me off 1000 miles from anybody I knew. I think it was students like me who drove Mr. Rodkey to his tricycle, but he was ever up to the job.

Life lesson learned: Focus! And Priorities!
Technical lesson learned: If you absolutely must multi-task, keep a sharp eye on the clock.



Who was the Earliest of our Teachers to have Consecutively Taught at NC?

Theme Song: Rocket 88

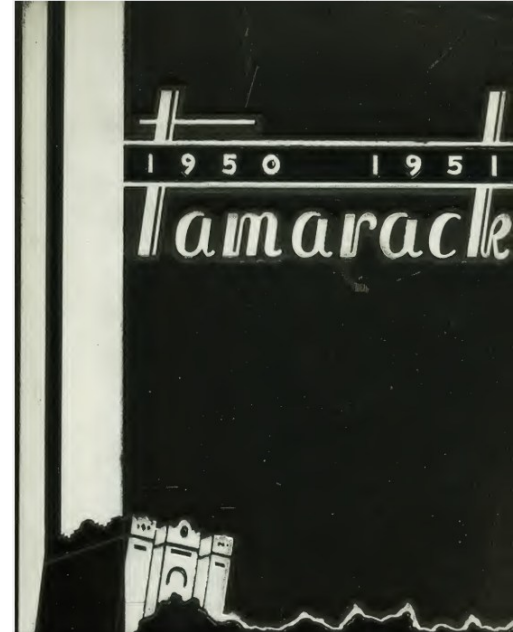


https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rocket_88

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WcFlj8OuIEI&list=RDWcFlj8OuIEI&start_radio=1



https://ia600607.us.archive.org/23/items/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1951/SPL_Yearbooks_North_Central_1951_text.pdf

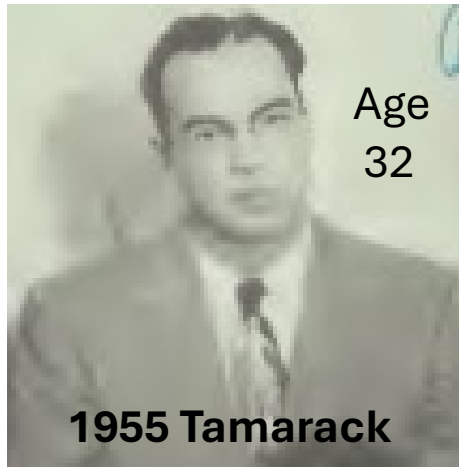


The Clubs are still a little weird in 1951: Conform!





Age
30-41



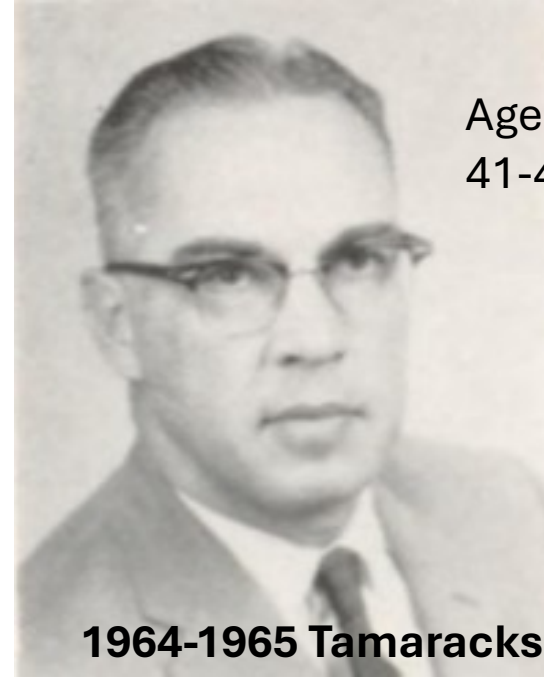
Age
32

1955 Tamarack



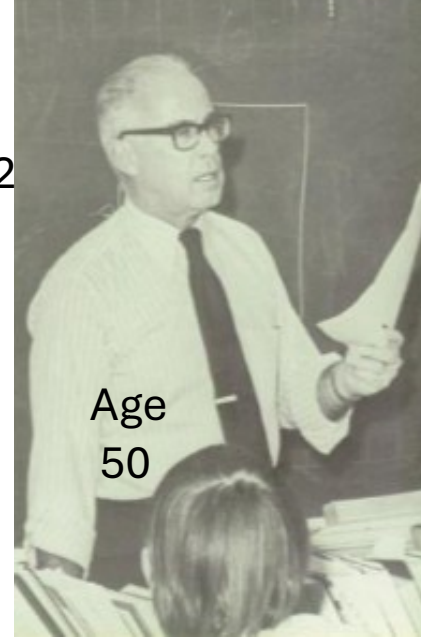
Age
33-40

1956-1963 Tamaracks



Age
41-42

1964-1965 Tamaracks



Age
50

1973 Tamarack

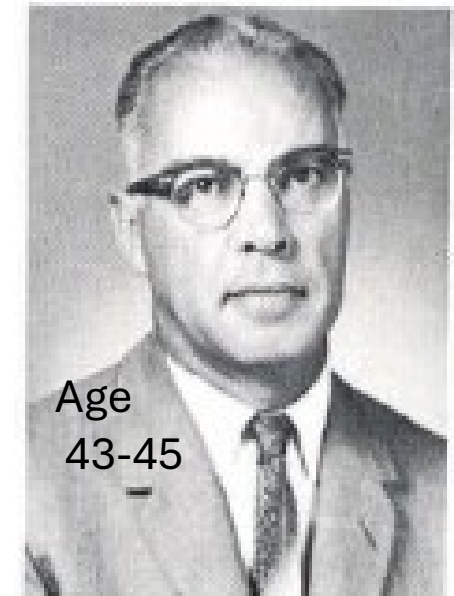


1969
Tamarack Age
46

1971 Tamarack

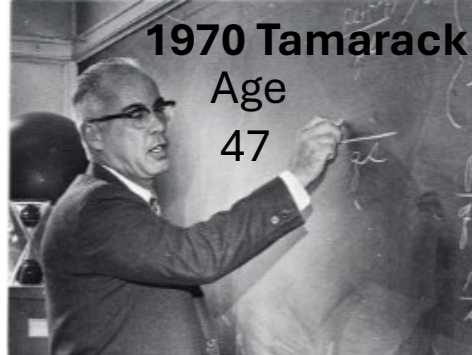


Age
48



Age
43-45

1966-1968 Tamaracks



1970 Tamarack
Age
47



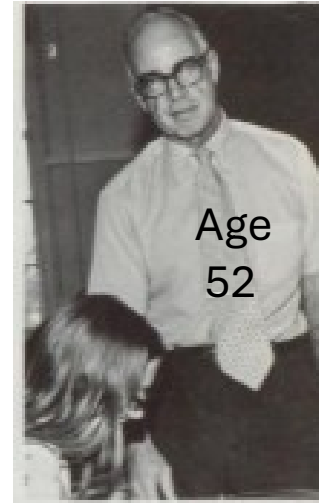
Age
51

1974 Tamarack



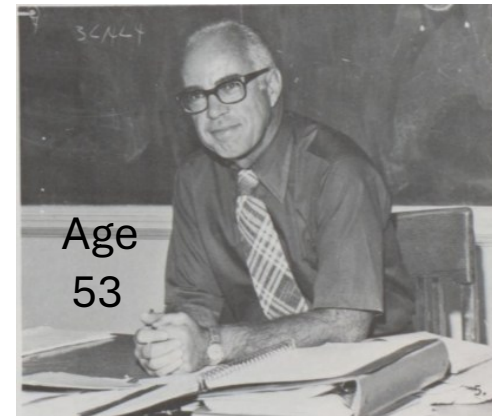
Age
49

1972
Tamarack



Age
52

1975
Tamarack



Age
53

1976 Tamarack



It's the 1953 Tamarack, and ladies and gentlemen, we have a winner!

Mr. Exley was the first of our teachers to have taught at NC! And it's not even close – except for Mr. Rodkey, who is a special case, with a gap in his tenure.

He had in fact been teaching there for more than 25 years, since 1950. We have photographic evidence that he did not age a day his first 3 years.



1953 – age 30

Mr. Exley -

Burrill Dean Exley (1923–1997) was a beloved math teacher, coach, and department head at North Central High School in Spokane from 1950 to 1978.

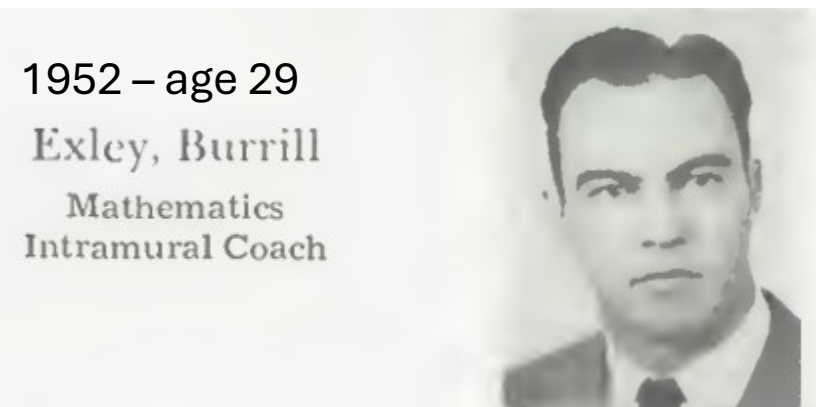
Biographical Highlights:

•Early Life &

Service: Born in Colville, Washington, he was a veteran of World War II.

•**Career:** He taught algebra and geometry at North Central High School for 28 years. Afterward, he taught at Kennedy High School in Burien, Washington, from 1980 to 1985.

1953 Tamarack



1952 – age 29

Exley, Burrill
Mathematics
Intramural Coach

1952 Tamarack

1951 Tamarack



Mr. Rodkey did not age for 2 years.

1949 Tamarack

1949 – age 28

JOHN RODKEY
English
Mathematics
Social Studies
Frosh Athletics



1950 Tamarack

John Rodkey
Social Studies
Whitworth College, B.A., B.Ed.





1976 Tamarack with Mr. Exley age 53

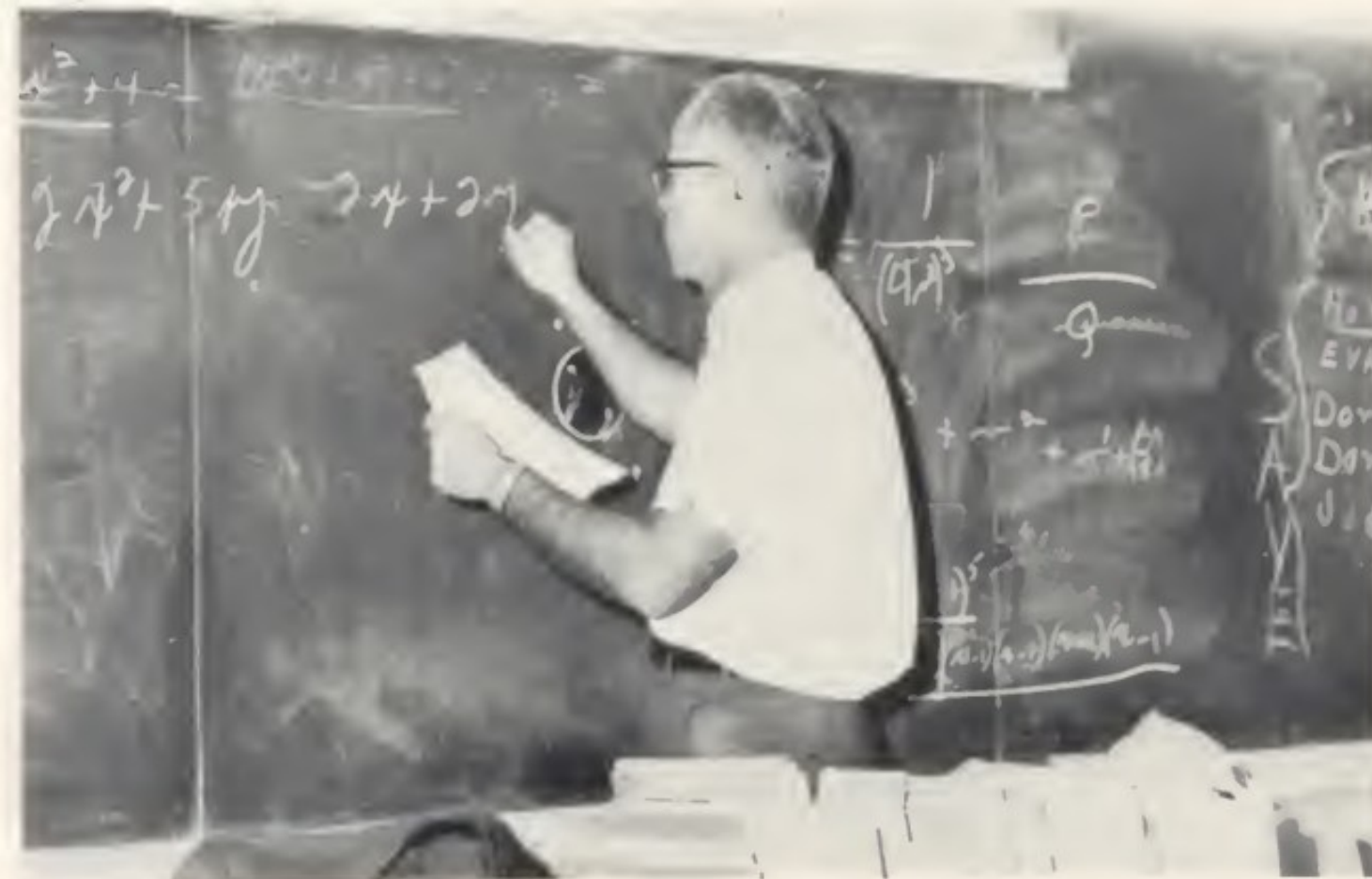
<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1997/jun/27/obituaries/>

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2025/aug/25/this-day-in-history-gerald-ford-calls-new-kootenai/>

Burrill Dean Exley was born **May 8, 1923**, in or near **Colville, Washington**, and died **June 19, 1997**, at age **74**. His obituary appeared in *The Spokesman-Review* on June 27, 1997, under “Burrill Exley, Seattle.” It says no service was held at his request and that Bleitz Funeral Home in Seattle handled arrangements.

The obituary gives the key North Central facts very clearly: he was a **World War II veteran** and served as a **teacher, coach, and math department head at North Central High School from 1950 to 1978**. After leaving North Central, he taught at **Kennedy High School in Burien, Washington, from 1980 to 1985**. He was survived by his wife **Marion**, daughter **Linda Rumans**, and a granddaughter. A Washington State University record lists **Burrill Dean Exley** receiving a **Bachelor of Education** on **October 4, 1950**, which aligns neatly with his beginning at North Central that same year. The 1951 *Tamarack* faculty listing gives a fuller educational line: **Washington State College, B.A., B. of Ed.; Whitman College; Murray State Junior College; Dayton University**, and identifies him as a mathematics teacher, senior class adviser, and involved with intramural sports. The yearbooks also document his long role in the math department. The 1967 *Tamarack* lists **Burrill Exley — Mathematics, Department Head, Scholarship Committee**, and the 1969 *Tamarack* lists him as **Math Dept. Head**. Earlier yearbooks show his coaching role as well: the 1958 *Tamarack* refers to “**Burrill Exley’s cross-country team**” taking honors, and the 1957 *Tamarack* mentions track activity under Coach Exley.

One charming extra: a 2025 *Spokesman-Review* “This day in history” item reached back to 1925 and described 27-month-old **Burrill Dean Exley** as a Spokane Valley “mental wizard” who knew the alphabet at 17 months and could spell more than a dozen words — a delightful foreshadowing for a future math teacher.



From the
**1968
Tamarack**
with Mr.
Exley at the
chalk board,
age 45.

Mr. Burrill Exley stumps his
new Math Seminar class
with a factoring problem.

My experience of the NC Math Department was a little unusual - I was allowed to sort of roam ahead in my earlier years, and by my Junior Year at NC I was taking Senior Math. This was not popular with some of the actual Seniors, as it undercut the natural order of things. One Senior Classmate in particular informed me of this in the boy's room down the hall after class, with a group of fellow-minded classmates who had had to put up with some wise-ass Junior in there, and that I had better shut up and quit raising my hand. I did.

From the **1951 Tamarack**

By Senior Year I was well-prepared by my NC Math teachers for the Math part of the SAT and the Math Achievement test which were the point of everything (770, 800). They also somehow enrolled me in Calculus over at Gonzaga (Math BC AP Exam: 5/5), to be Introductions to Linear Algebra and to Differential Equations at Gonzata (that last as a "High School Bowl Scholar").

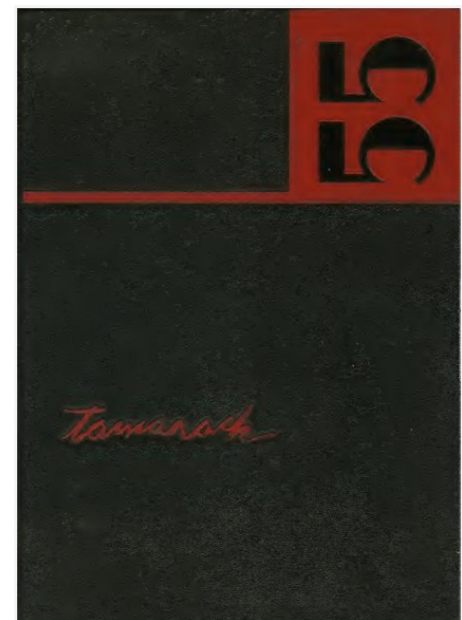
They put huge (overly huge) significance on standardized tests back then, and these guys put me over the line. When I got to Harvard, I was good to go.



Chalk work--an integral part of any math class

1954 Tamarack

Theme Song: Flip, Flop and Fly



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aNpvOUmXglM&list=RDaNpvOUmXglM&start_radio=1

Faculty Helps Students Maintain Responsibilities

1972 Tamarack
Age 56



1955 Tamarack
Age 39



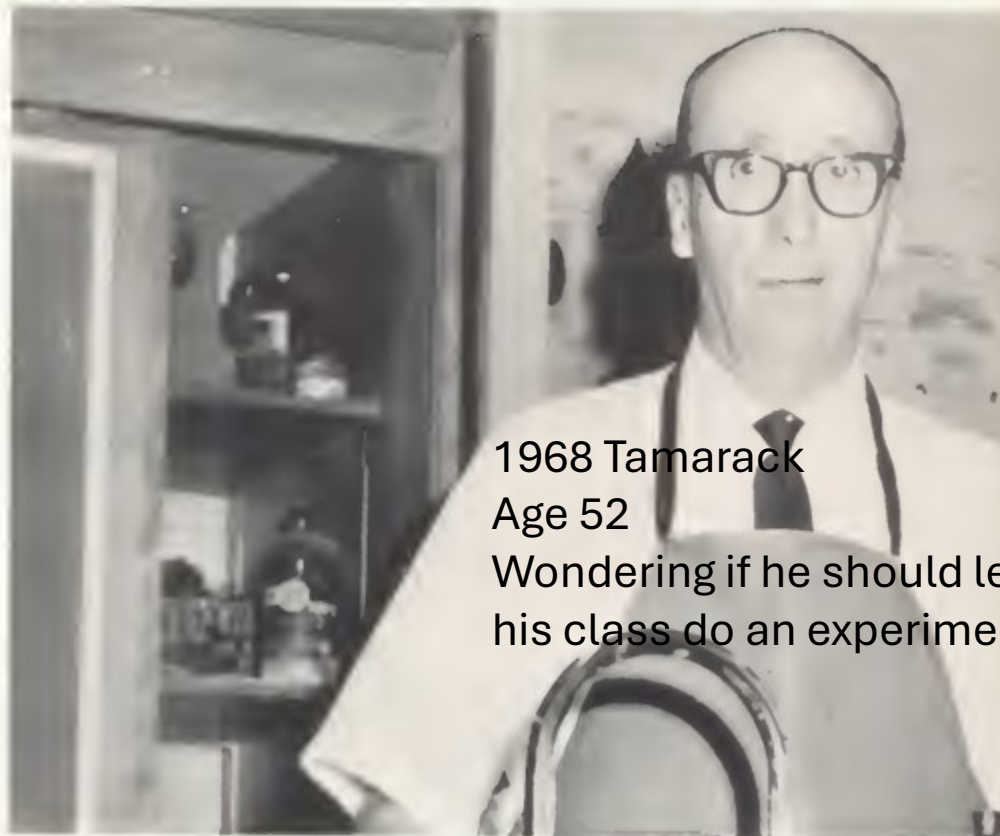
1956 Tamarack
Age 40



1958 Tamarack
Age 42



1963 Tamarack Age 47



1968 Tamarack
Age 52
Wondering if he should let
his class do an experiment.

1960 Tamarack

Age 44

Demonstrating
centrifugal
force with a
Hula Hoop.





1976
Tamarack

Age 60

The 1958 *Tamarack* lists “**Orval Theisen, physics**” in the science faculty, alongside Walter Spangenburg in biology and Donald Bonamy in biology. The 1959 *Tamarack* likewise lists “**Orval Theisen, physics**” in the science department. He remains visible in later *Tamarack* records: 1964 includes a caption referring to “**Orval Theisen, physics teacher,**” 1965 indexes him in the North Central yearbook, 1968 lists him among faculty, and 1976 indexes “**Theisen, Orval**” on page 30.

One nice professional detail: **Orval P. Theisen** published a letter titled “**Help Wanted!**” in *The Physics Teacher*, Volume 10, Issue 6, September 1972, page 301. That is a useful detail for your slide because it shows him not just as a local teacher, but as someone engaged with the national physics-teaching community.

I found a reasonably strong biographical outline for **Orval N. P. Theisen**, though I did **not** find a full newspaper obituary in open access.

Orval N. P. Theisen was born **January 14, 1916**, in **Erwin, Kingsbury County, South Dakota**, and died **August 7, 2007**, in **Spokane, Washington**, at age 91. FamilySearch gives his full indexed life span as **1916–2007**.

Your earlier NC Teachers notes summarize him as a longtime **physics and science teacher at North Central High School**, born in South Dakota, deceased in Spokane in August 2007, and associated with both physics teaching and *The Physics Teacher* journal.

Before his teaching career, he served in the U.S. military during World War II. The notes identify his service as **January 1943 to October 1945**, including Army Air Corps / Air Force service as a **radio operator and gunner on B-17s**, with **35 bombing missions over central Europe**. He married **Anna Aileene Cantlon** in Spokane on **January 5, 1946**.

Explosion in the Physics Lab

Which of our teachers started at NC in 1956, before any of us were born?



Age 31



Age <30

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1956/mode/2up>



Age 27



Age 40

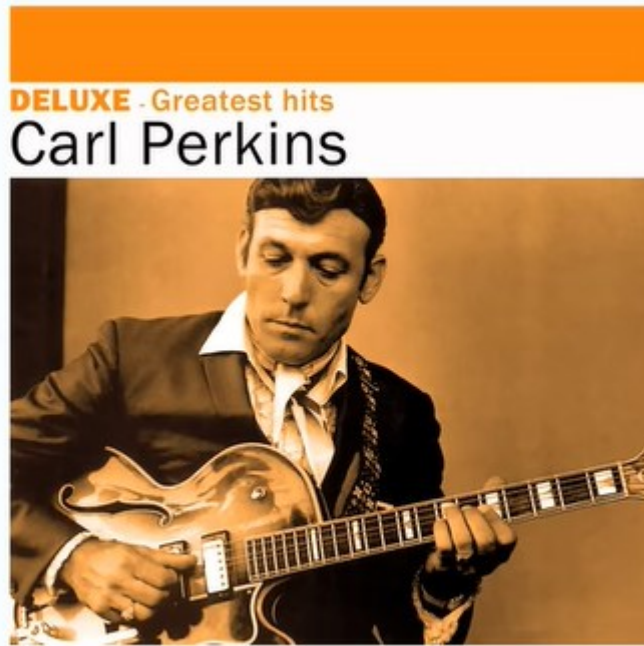


Age 39

1956
Tamarack

Who started at NC in 1956, before any of us were born, and was theoretical?

Theme Song: Blue Suede Shoes



Blue Suede Shoes

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mvsYRAc-BWA&list=RDmvsYRAc-BWA&start_radio=1



The most common offense was battery – oops, loitering – in the halls. Others included smoking on the school grounds, lunchroom offenses, and disobeying hall guards.



**1966 - 1967
Tamaracks**



1970 Tamarack

1971 Tamarack

1976 Tamarack



1969 Tamarack



**1963 - 1965
Tamaracks**

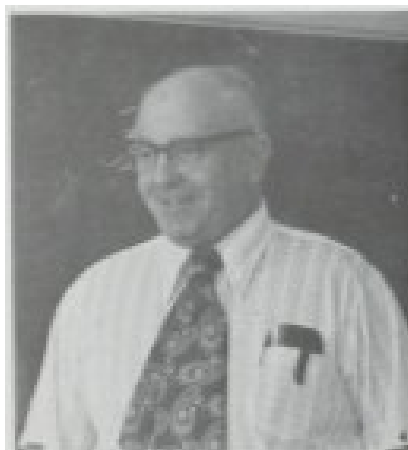


1973

Tamarack



1974 Tamarack



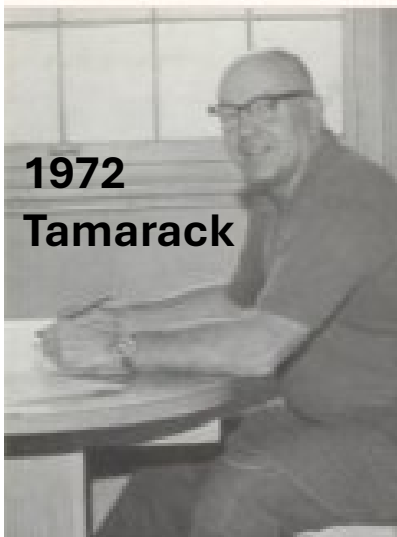
1975 Tamarack

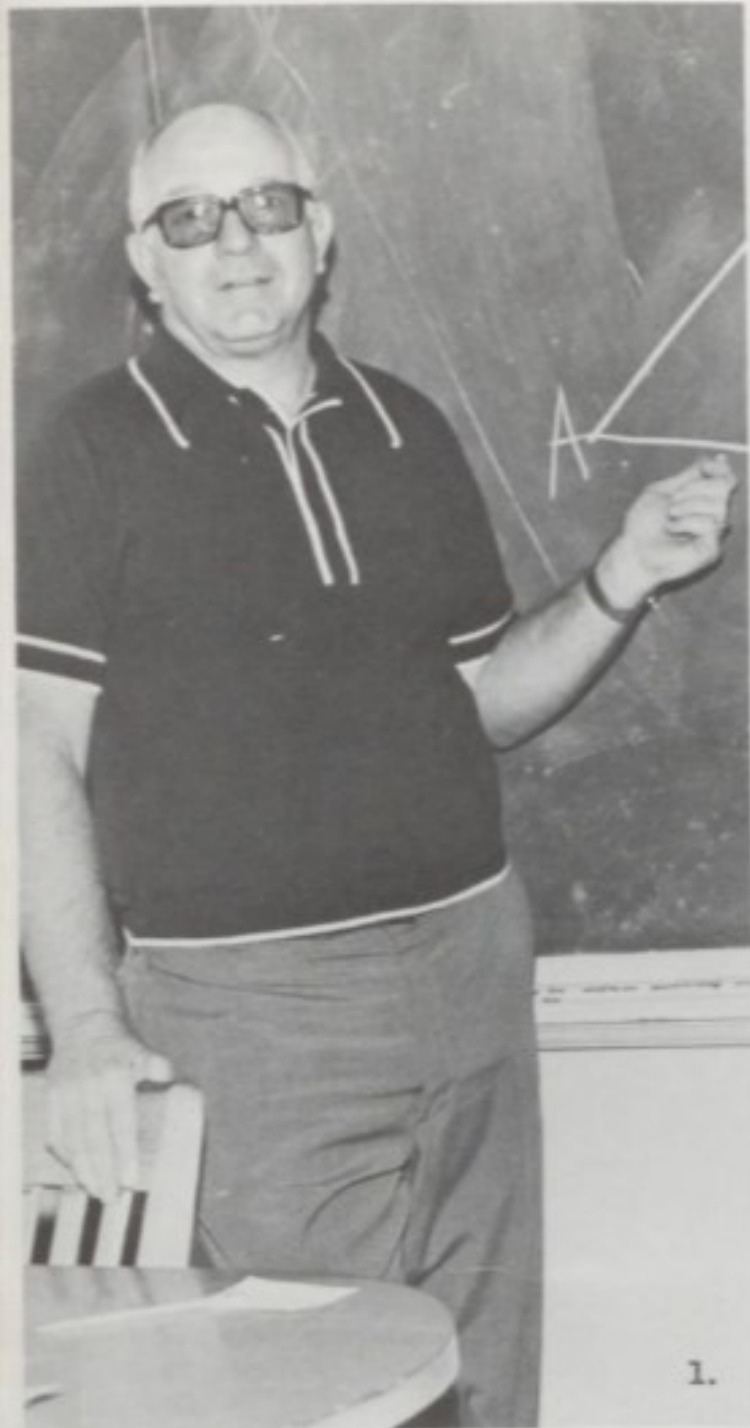


1972 Tamarack



**1972
Tamarack**





I found a good **North Central yearbook trail**, but **not a reliable public obituary** for this older NC mathematics teacher in this pass. There are newer Spokane Public Schools records for a different/current **William Nye**, so I would keep the biographical claims conservative.

William Nye appears in the North Central *Tamarack* by **1956**, where the OCR places him in the mathematics faculty group: “Standing: Robert F. Barnard, algebra: William Nye...” By **1958**, he is clearly listed as “**William Nye, algebra**” in the mathematics department, alongside P. H. Nygaard, Mack Saunders, Robert Barnard, Dorothy Congdon, and Burrill Exley.

In the early 1960s he is listed with **general mathematics**. The 1961 *Tamarack* page text identifies him in the faculty group as “**William Nye, general mathematics.**” The 1963 yearbook also places him in the math department context, with a nearby caption involving Burrill Exley explaining an algebra equation.

He also appears to have coached or supervised **tennis**. The 1969 *Tamarack* says North Central’s tennis team was “**led by Mr. William Nye.**” The 1970 *Tamarack* similarly reports that the tennis team, under **William Nye**, ended in a tie for third place.

The 1975 *Tamarack* lists **William Nye** in the faculty material near Gene Rostvold, Burrill Exley, Gilbert Baker, and others.



1956 Tamarack Age >30?



1957 Tamarack Age >31?

Assuming he was 30 in his first year at NC in 1956, that would make him a centarian if with us.

Who was at NC in 1956, before any of us were born, and meant business?

Theme Song: Honky Tonk (Parts 1 & 2)" by Bill Doggett



Bill Doggett - Honky Tonk (Part 1 & 2)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-fa2ZKzfIP0&list=RD-fa2ZKzfIP0&start_radio=1



Commercial Club

The key to success, according to the girls in the Commercial Club, is found on the keyboard of a typewriter. Although the club was organized to stimulate a creative interest in commercial courses, the group also enjoys various social activities.



1956-1968 Age 40-52
Tamaracks



Age
50



1966 Tamarack

1971 Tamarack

Age
55



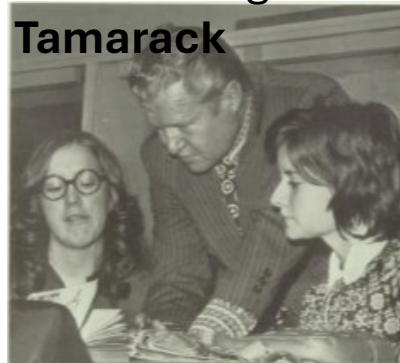
Age 53



1969 Tamarack



1973 Age 57
Tamarack



Age 54
Age 54

1970 Tamarack

1972 Age 56
Tamarack

1976 Age 59
Tamarack

1974 Tamarack

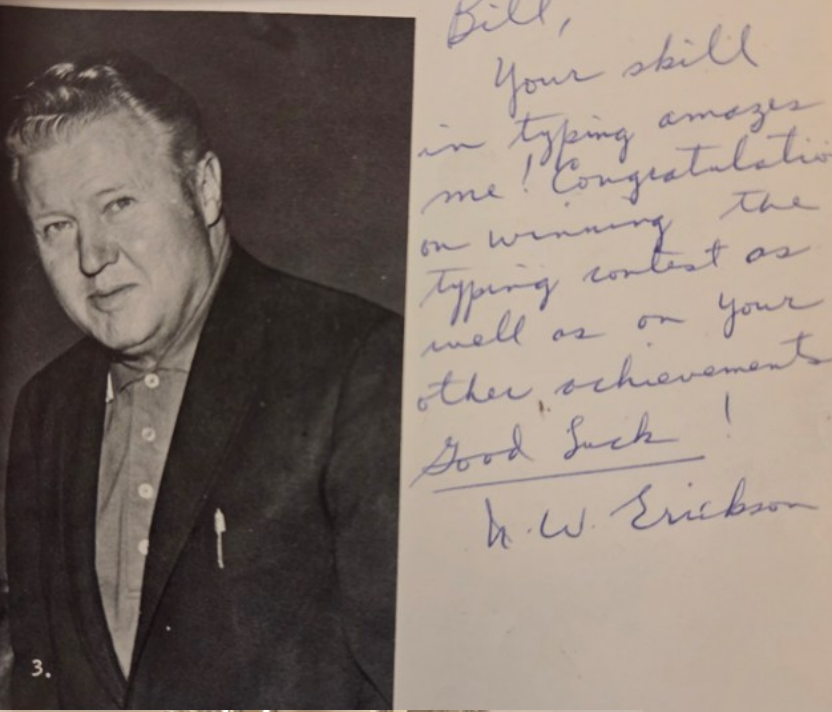


Age 58



1975 Tamarack Age 5





Bill,
Your skill in typing
amazes me!
Congratulations
on winning the
typing contest as
well as your other
achievements.
Good Luck!
N. W. Erickson

Norman W. "Norm" Erickson died **July 8, 1999**, at age **81**. His memorial service was held at Sunset Chapel at Fairmount Memorial Park, and *The Spokesman-Review* obituary identifies him as a **52-year Spokane resident** born in **Oakes, North Dakota**.

His education and early career make a nice story arc. He graduated from **Fargo High School in 1935**, attended **Concordia College** and the **University of Minnesota**, served as a **lieutenant in the Navy during World War II**, and after discharge in 1946 completed a bachelor's degree in business at the University of Minnesota. He moved into Spokane work first with **Madison Lumber** in 1948 and then as an accountant for **Watson Management** in 1950.

He married **Marjorie Henniger** in **1949**. He later returned to college, attending **Washington State University** and then graduating from **Eastern Washington University with a teaching degree in 1956**.

The key North Central fact is explicit in the obituary: Erickson was a **business and mathematics teacher at North Central High School from 1956 until his retirement in 1979**. Your own NC Teachers notes also summarize him as a business/math teacher at NC from 1956 to 1979, with death in July 1999 and survival by his wife, children, and grandchildren.

North Central's *Tamarack* records place him in **typing / business education** contexts: the 1961 OCR lists "**Norman Erickson, typing**," the 1964 page places him in business education near bookkeeping and office-practice material, and the 1969 *Tamarack* discusses typing contest awards in the business-education setting.

His obituary lists memberships in the **Retired Teachers, Spokane Education Association, Washington Education Association**, and the **Moose Lodge**. He was survived by his wife, two sons, two daughters, and five grandchildren.



I may have lettered in Wrestling, but in Typing I was an actual champion. 84 words per minute, and that was on a manual typewriter. My secret was that I had been playing piano since first grade when my sister taught me since she had had lessons. It built great dexterity and finger strength. Later it got me a job at Harvard in the Geology Library, where they called me "Whiz".

Who could read Latin poetry to you in the original and understand it, and started at NC in 1957?



Mr. Theisen- Physics



Mr. Simonson - Biology



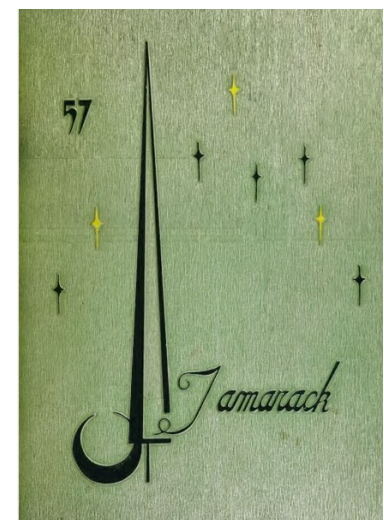
Mr. Exley - Geometry



Mr. Nye- Algebra



Mr. Erickson –
General Math

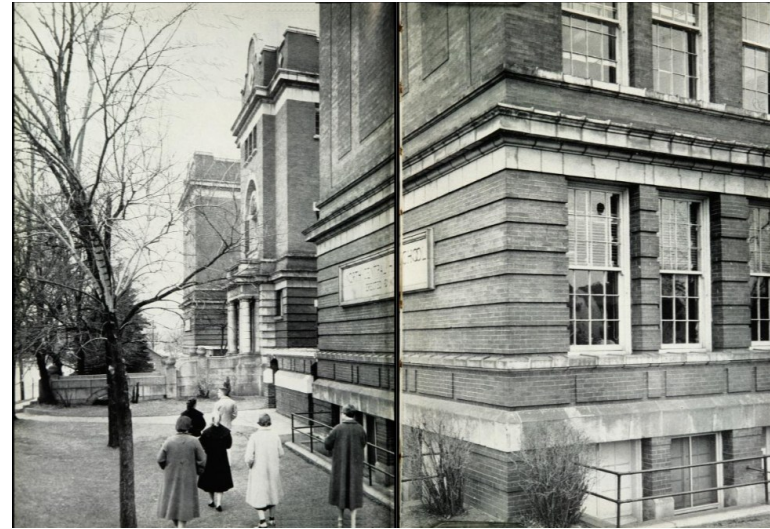


Who could read Latin poetry to you in the original and understand it, and started at NC in 1957?

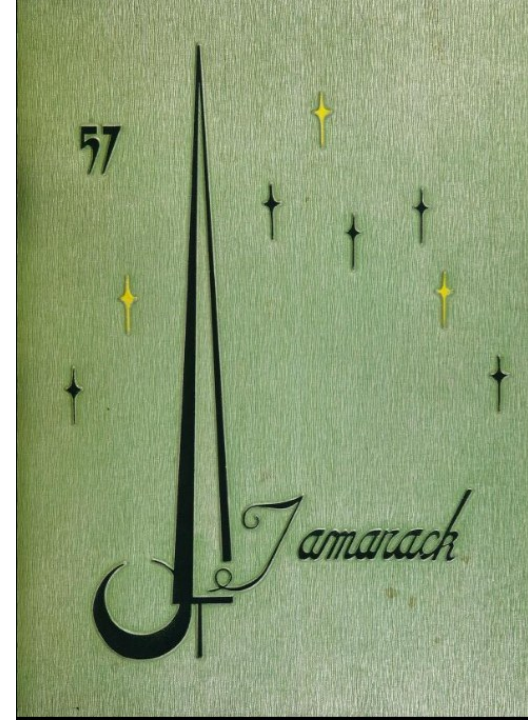
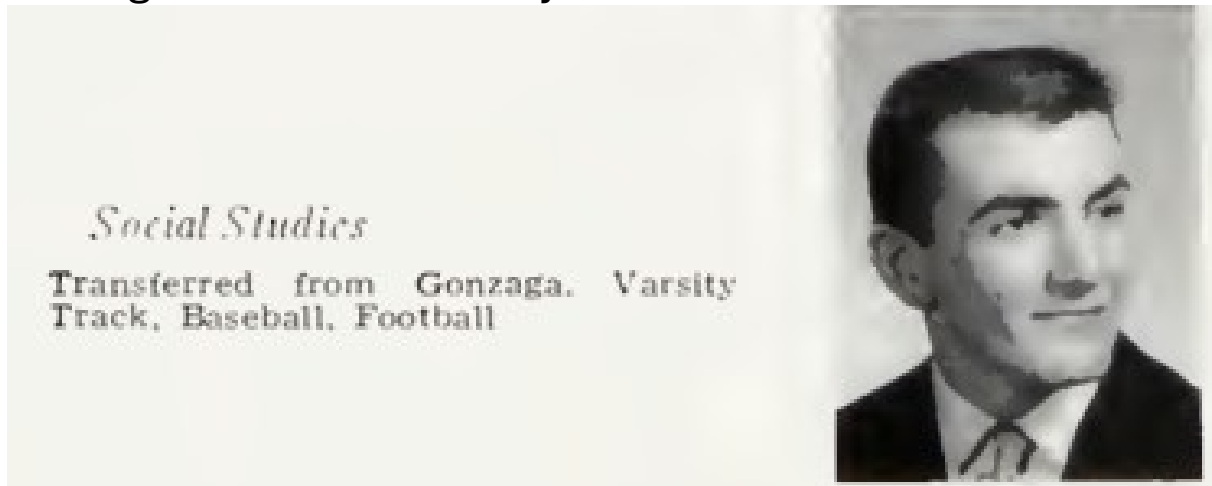
Theme Song: Gaudeamus igitur



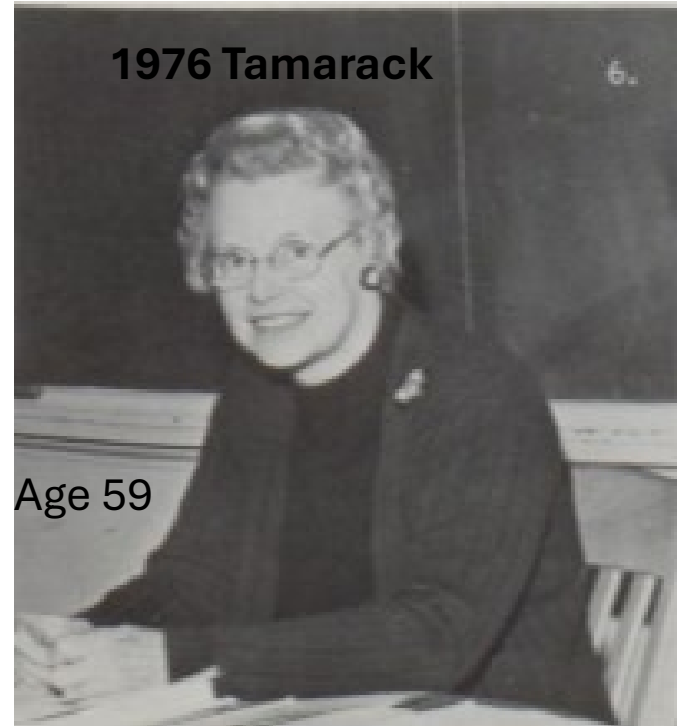
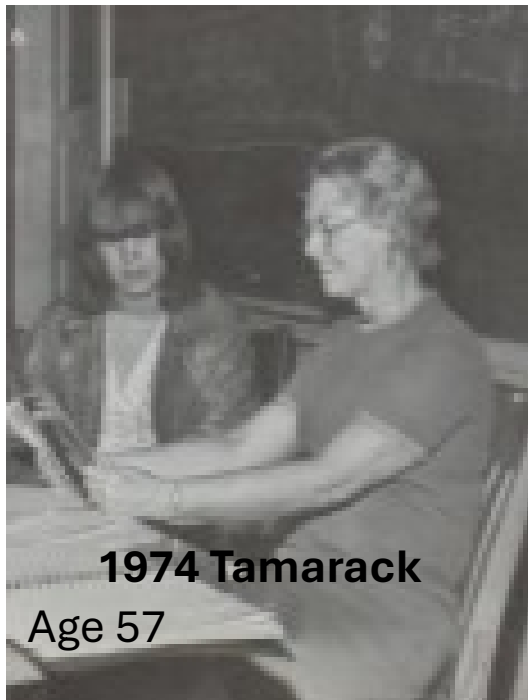
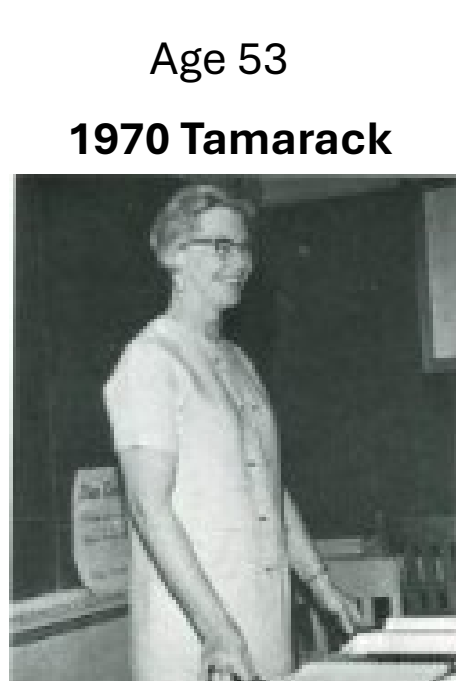
Gaudeamus Igitur - recorded June 2021

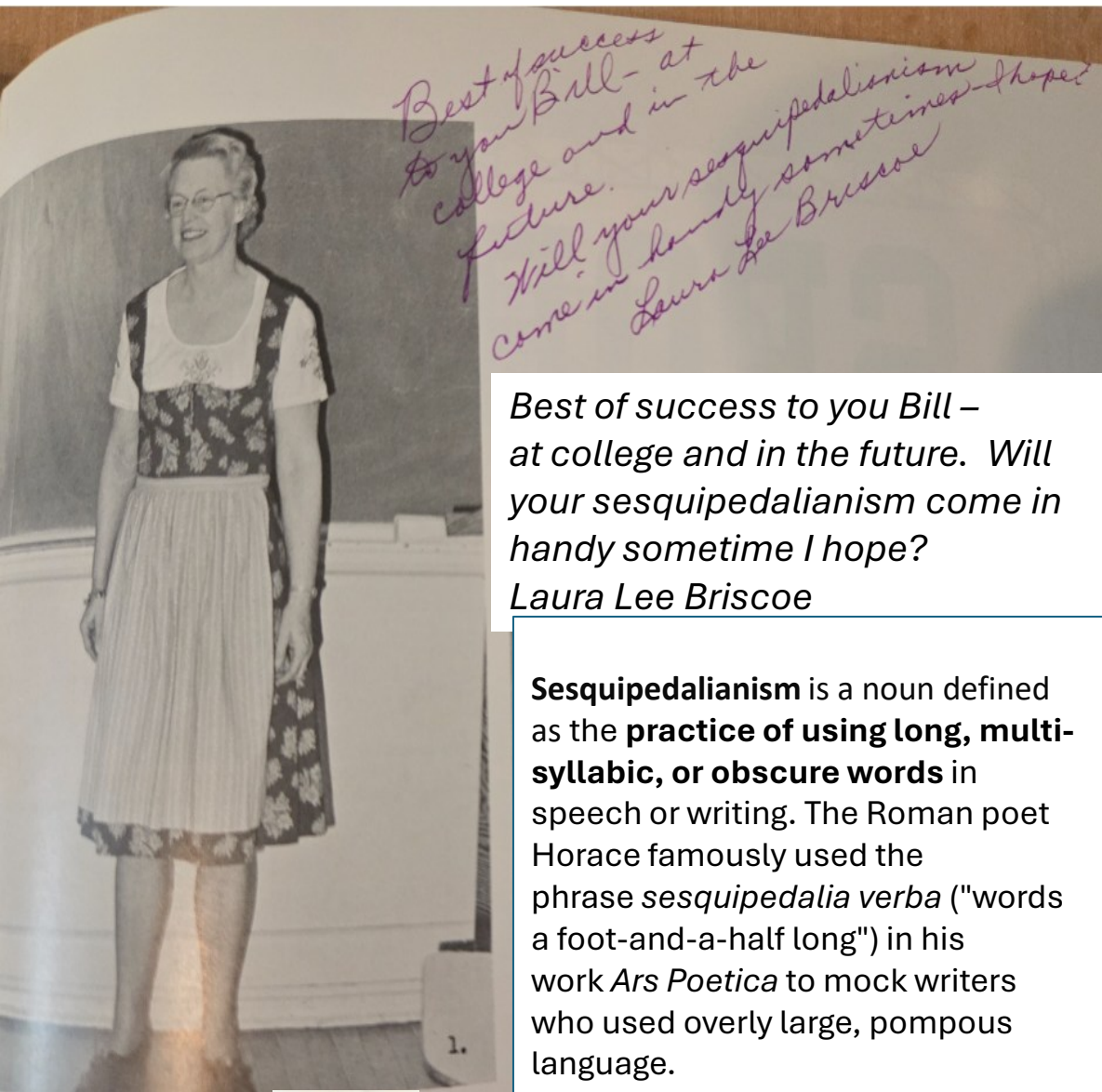


Which of our Class of 1976 teachers was an NC Senior during this teacher's first year?



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ha6pGK6ZnXE&list=RDha6pGK6ZnXE&start_radio=1





Best of success to you Bill -
at college and in the future. Will
your sesquipedalianism come in
handy sometime I hope?
Laura Lee Briscoe

Sesquipedalianism is a noun defined as the **practice of using long, multi-syllabic, or obscure words** in speech or writing. The Roman poet Horace famously used the phrase *sesquipedalia verba* ("words a foot-and-a-half long") in his work *Ars Poetica* to mock writers who used overly large, pompous language.



1957
Age
40



1964
Age
47



1966
Age
49



1976
Age
59

Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe appears to have been born in **1917** and died in **1999**. FamilySearch indexes her as "Laura Lee Mohn (1917–1999)" and connects her records to the names **Laura Lee Briscoe**, the 1950 Census, Washington county marriage records, and Find A Grave.

She married **Robert Herman Briscoe** in Spokane in **1939**. A newspaper marriage notice indexed by Newspapers.com lists "Miss Laura Lee Mohn" and "Mr. Robert Herman Briscoe," with Spokane as the marriage place.

She was teaching **Latin at North Central High School** by at least **1957**. The 1957 *Tamarack* OCR lists "Laura Lee Briscoe. Latin" among faculty. The 1959 *Tamarack* likewise lists "Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin."

By the mid-1960s she was still part of the foreign language faculty. The 1965 *Tamarack* page identifies **Laura Briscoe** with **Latin** and **Latin Club**, in a Foreign Languages section headed by Helen Oscarson. The 1968 *Tamarack* says that under Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin Club worked on increasing members' knowledge of Latin and its origins.

By the early 1970s she appears in the **English** department rather than foreign languages. The 1971 North Central yearbook OCR lists "Laura Lee Briscoe" in an English-related faculty list. The 1975 *Tamarack* also indexes "Laura Lee Briscoe," consistent with your statement that she was still at NC into the 1970s. The 1976 yearbook OCR includes a caption: "Laura Lee Briscoe wears a costume from Germany for International Week," matching the attached photo context.

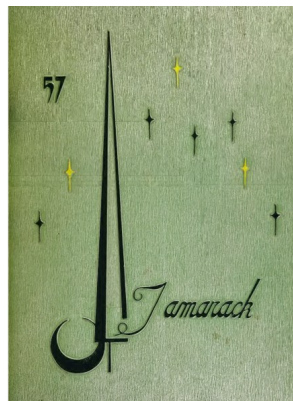
Her husband, **Robert H. Briscoe**, died in 1995. His Spokesman-Review obituary says he was a former Spokane resident, a WSU graduate in mathematics and physics, a former Whitworth teacher, later connected with Expo '74 and Eastern Washington University, and that after retirement he and his wife **Laura Lee** spent summers at Priest Lake and winters in San Diego before moving to La Mesa, California in 1987. Their son Barry Don Briscoe's obituary also identifies him as one of five children born to **Robert and Laura Lee (Mohn) Briscoe** in Spokane.

Which teacher of ours had a half dozen of our other teachers as teachers when he graduated from NC in 1957?

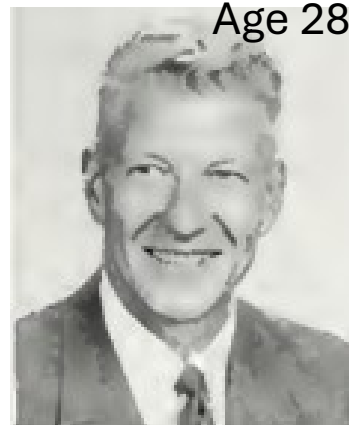


Mr. Exley -
Geometry

Mr. Nye-
Algebra



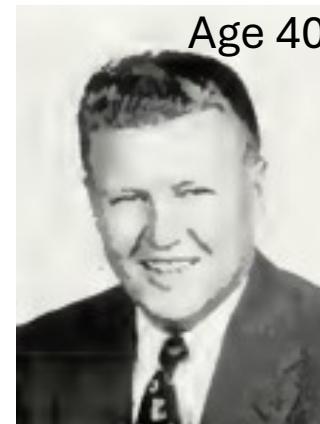
Mrs. Briscoe -
Latin



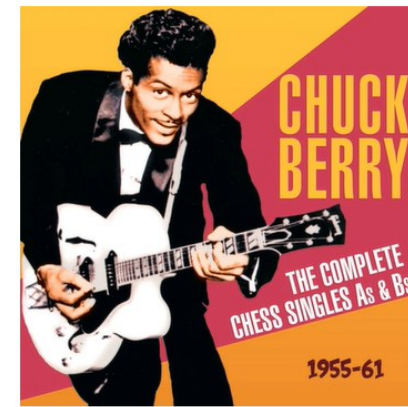
Mr. Simonson -
Biology



Mr. Theisen-
Physics



Mr. Erickson –
General Math



School Day (Ring! Ring! Goes the Bell)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vNrfXJ-WnE0&list=RDvNrfXJ-WnE0&start_radio=1



Chuck Berry "School Days"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6d1mZJsZGXg>

1958: The Mid-Century Boom and Post-Sputnik Science

By the year of my birth in 1958, the educational landscape had been completely upended by the **1944 G.I. Bill**, the post-war Baby Boom, and the dawn of the Space Age. The Soviet Union's launch of Sputnik in late 1957 sent shockwaves through American education, prompting the **National Defense Education Act of 1958**.

•The Educational Philosophy:

High schools pivoted violently toward rigorous math, engineering, and foreign languages to compete globally. Concurrently, the "comprehensive high school" model took root, designed to offer both college-prep tracking and vocational training.

The Environment:

The iconic old collegiate-Gothic building was bursting at the seams with the first wave of Baby Boomers. The environment was highly structured, defined by mid-century social conformity, traditional gender roles (such as home economics for girls and industrial arts for boys), and a booming subculture of high school athletics, pep clubs, and marching bands.

“Our educational thinkers in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries saw the schools as the central and main hope for the preservation of democratic ideals and the endurance of the nation as a republic,” writes education scholar E. D. Hirsch.

<https://www.city-journal.org/article/when-high-schools-shaped-americas-destiny>



WIKIPEDIA 25 years of the free encyclopedia

History of education in the United States

Article Talk Read Edit View history Tools

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

For broader coverage of this topic, see *History of education* and *Education in the United States*.

The **history of education in the United States** covers the trends in formal education in America from the 17th century to the early 21st century.

Colonial era [edit]

See also: *Education in the Thirteen Colonies*, *Latin school* § *Latin schools in colonial North America and the USA*, and *Literacy in the United States*

Schooling was a high priority in Puritan *New England*, which set up strong systems, especially in the colonial-era *Province of Massachusetts Bay*. It was a lower priority elsewhere, with many short-lived small local private academies and some schools for pauper children.^[1]

This article is part of a series on **Education in the United States**

Summary

By state and in insular areas
By subject area

History

California · Chicago · Kentucky · Massachusetts (Dedham) · Missouri · New York City · Southern United States · Texas

Curriculum topics

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/History_of_education_in_the_United_States



A 1768 depiction of **Harvard College** engraved by **Paul Revere**

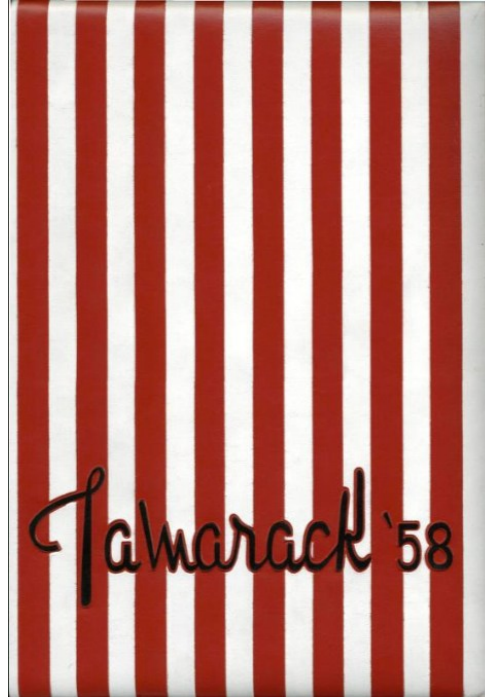


Age 33



Age <32

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1958/mode/2up>



Age 41



Age 29



Age 42



Age 41

1958
Tamarack

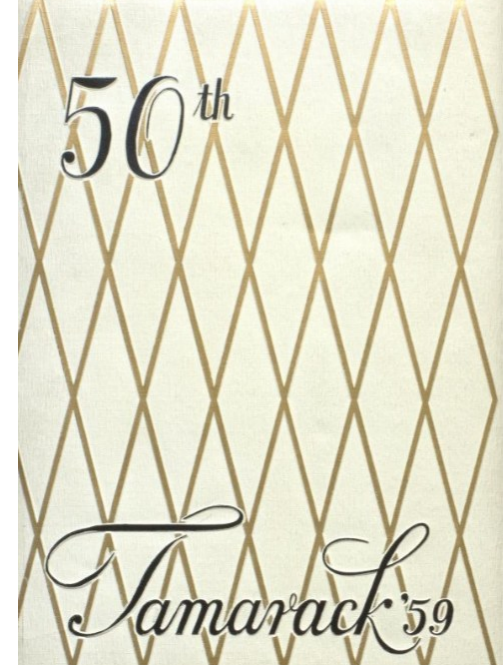


Age 34



Age <33

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1959/mode/2up>



Age 42



Age 30



Age 43



Age 42

1959
Tamarack



Age 39

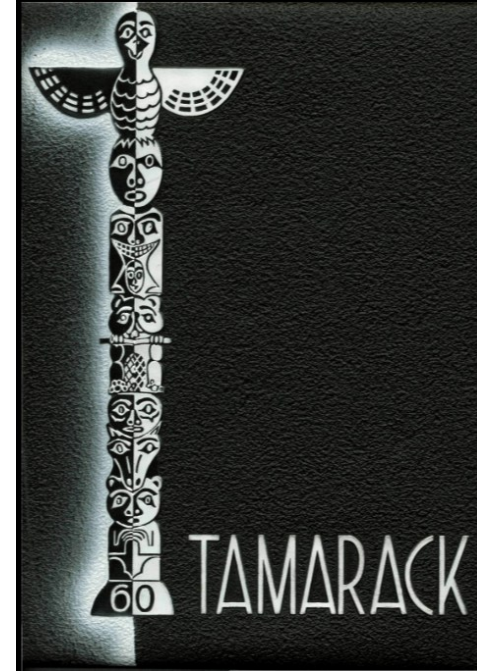


Age 35



Age <34

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1960/mode/2up>



Age 43



Age 31



Age 44



Age 43

1960
Tamarack



Age 40



Age 38



Age <35

1961
Tamarack

Age 38



Age 44



Age 32



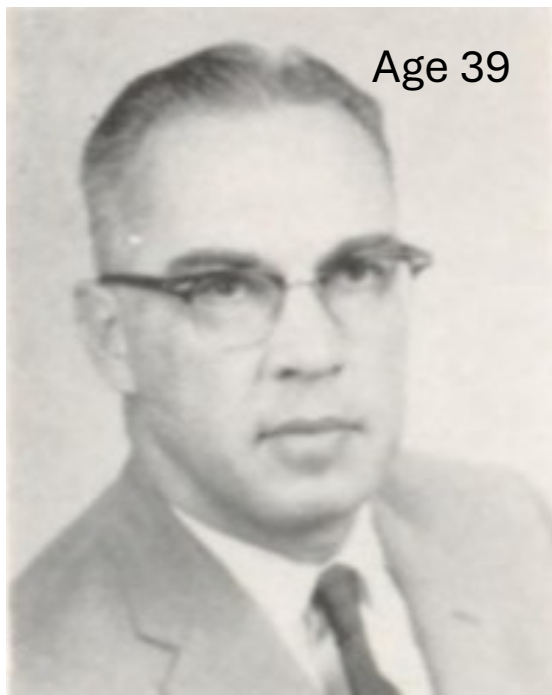
Age 45



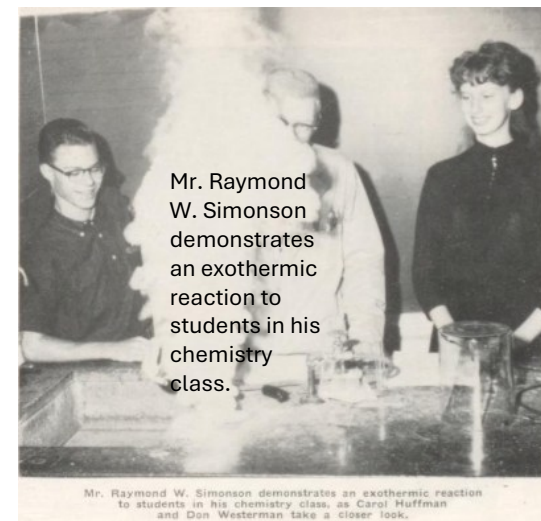
Age 44



Age 41

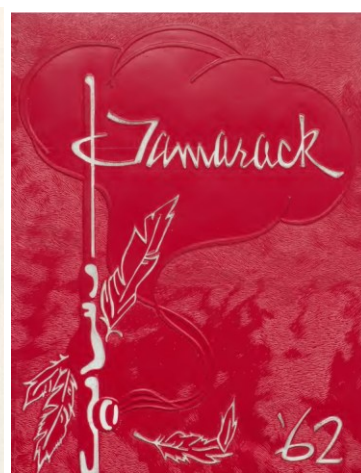


Age 39



Mr. Raymond W. Simonson demonstrates an exothermic reaction to students in his chemistry class.

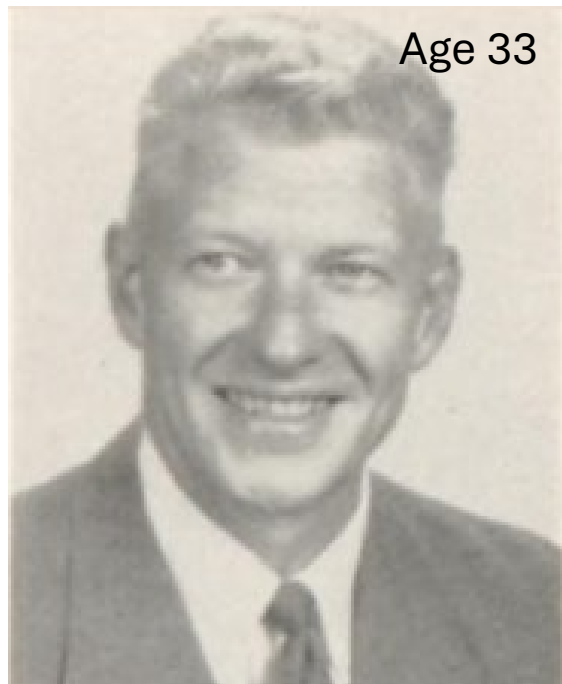
Mr. Raymond W. Simonson demonstrates an exothermic reaction to students in his chemistry class, as Carol Huffman and Don Westerman take a closer look.



1962
Tamarack



Age 45



Age 33



Age 46



Age 45



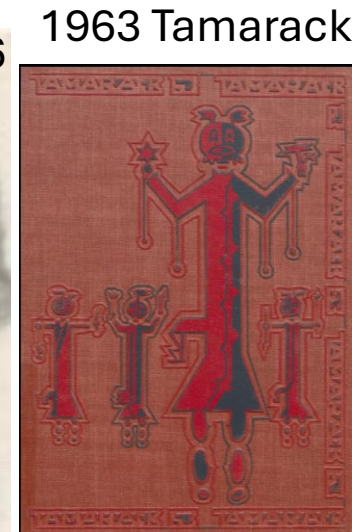
Age 40



Age <37



Age 46



1963 Tamarack



Age 34



Age 47



Age 46



Age 43

1964 Tamarack



Age 41



Age <38



Age 47



Age 35



Age 48

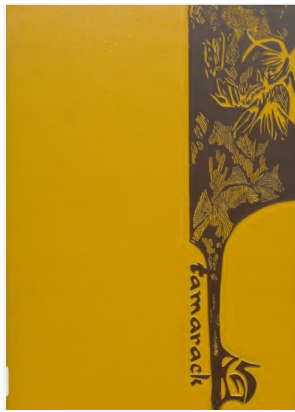


Age 47



It's the **1965 Tamarack** and a seventh has joined our stalwart six!

Mrs. Briscoe waits for a class response from the students in a question and answer period.



One of my Math teachers from Salk Junior High School, Mr. O'Leary, makes a guest appearance teaching Freshmen.



Who performed at Carnegie Hall?

Theme Song: “I Hear a Symphony”
by the Supremes



I Hear A Symphony

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aKG89jm79kc&list=RD aKG89jm79kc&start_radio=1





1965-1969 Tamaracks

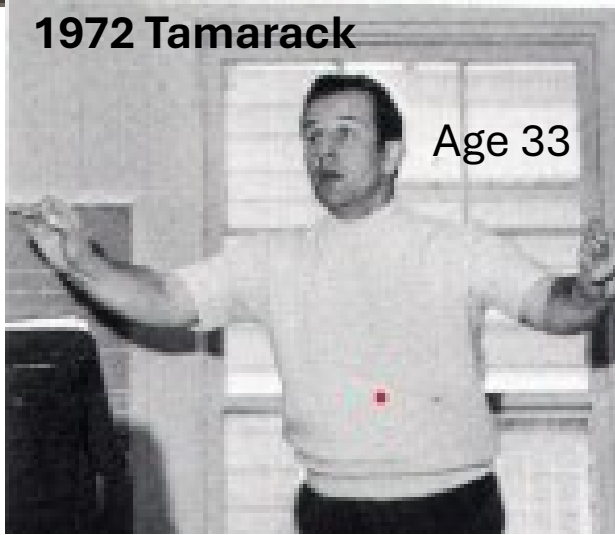
Age 26-30

Who performed at Carnegie Hall?

1974 Tamarack



Age 35



1972 Tamarack

Age 33



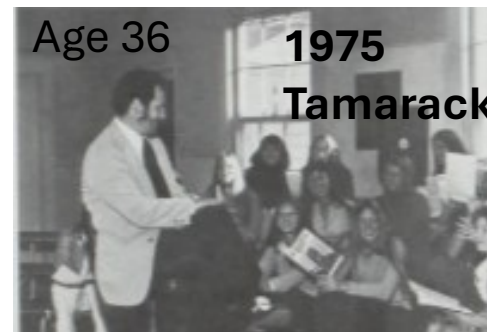
1970 Tamarack

Age 31



**1973
Tamarack**

Age 34



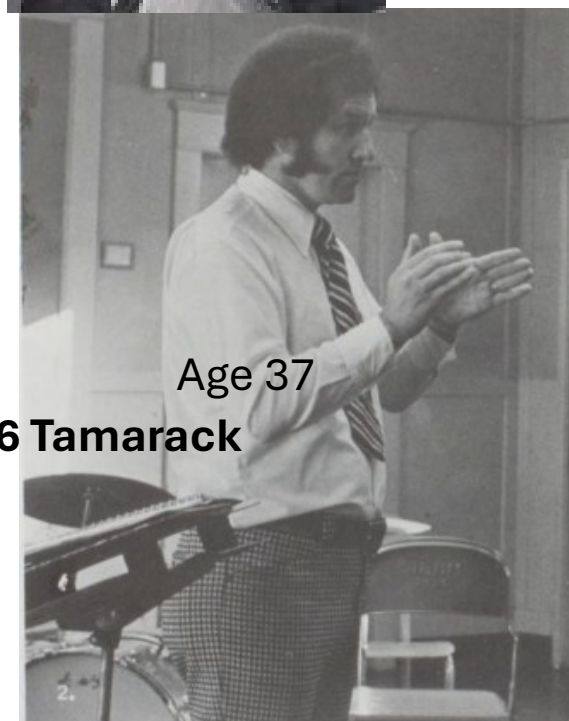
Age 36

**1975
Tamarack**



**1971
Tamarack**

Age 32



Age 37

1976 Tamarack



Michael W. Caldwell was born **June 6, 1939**, in **Wenatchee, Washington**, and died **May 14, 2018**, in Spokane at age 77. His obituary says he graduated from **Wenatchee High School in 1957** and from **Washington State University in 1962**, where he studied music and was active in Theta Xi fraternity; he later earned a master's degree from **Eastern Washington University**.

His teaching career began at **Sumner High School**, but he spent the bulk of his career at **North Central High School**, where he taught **choir and singing for more than 30 years**.

He was also a major presence in Spokane's broader musical life. His obituary says he directed church choirs, directed the **American German Society Choir**, sang with the **Spokane Chorale for 50 years**, performed with the **Spokane Civic Light Opera** and **Spokane City Theater**, helped direct a joint American/Canadian choir for **Expo '74**, and performed at **Carnegie Hall**.

A 1976 University of Idaho Jazz Festival program lists **North Central High School, Spokane, WA — Mike Caldwell** in the vocal jazz ensemble schedule. Later records show that his work continued: a 1991 University of Idaho Jazz Festival program again lists **North Central High School — Mike Caldwell**, and a 1995 *Spokesman-Review* article identifies **music teacher Mike Caldwell of North Central High School** as coordinating the mixed choir for an All-Northwest student performance event.

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/michael-caldwell-obituary?id=16901545>

Who performed at Carnegie Hall?



1. The Primetime Choice (1965): "I Hear a Symphony" by The Supremes

Released in October 1965 on Motown Records, this masterfully structured pop-soul song shot straight to #1 on the Billboard Hot 100.

- The Vibe:** Written by Holland–Dozier–Holland, the track moves away from standard verse-chorus formulas, instead structurally building like a classical symphony with shifting key modulations and multi-layered, intricate backing vocals.

- The Choir Connection:** The song's literal lyrics—associating the overwhelming feeling of love with complex musical arrangements, symphonies, and rhapsodies—makes it a perfect, high-energy homage to a lifelong choir director and classical vocalist.



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OEZ6CwPSy9s&list=RD0EZ6CwPSy9s&start_radio=1

2. The Great Choral Crossover: "Amen" by The Impressions

If you want a 1965 track that leans directly into the rich, traditional vocal blending that Mr. Caldwell taught his students every day, look to Curtis Mayfield and The Impressions' massive hit "**Amen**" (which peaked on the charts in early 1965).

- Why it works:** Styled precisely like a traditional gospel choral piece, it features a solo lead vocalist trading lines with a swelling, layered backing choir. It became a unifying, uplifting anthem across the country that year.



Ives: Symphony No. 4: III. Fugue. Andante moderato con moto

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s31b8zXc_o0&list=RDs31b8zXc_o0&start_radio=1

3. The Classical Debut Nod: "Symphony No. 4" / The Leopold Stokowski Vibe

For a fun historical crossover, April 26, 1965 marked one of the most famous avant-garde events in Carnegie Hall's history: the world premiere of Charles Ives's incredibly complex *Symphony No. 4*, performed by Leopold Stokowski and the American Symphony Orchestra. Including a stylistic nod to mid-60s orchestral or chamber vocal recordings captures the high-caliber academic classical world Mr. Caldwell operated in.



Age 45

Mr. Rodkey, Principal,

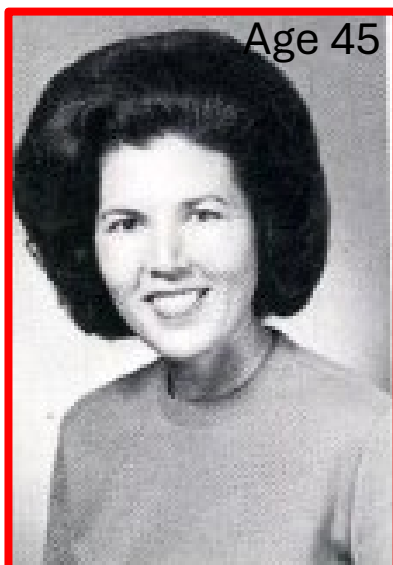


Age 27

Michael Caldwell
Music Production

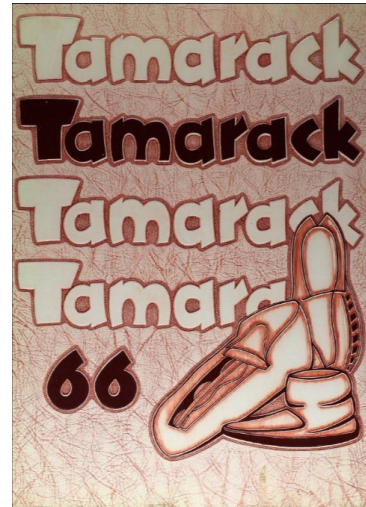


Age 28



Age 45

It's the **1966 Tamarack** and two new faces have joined the team! Mr. Ericksen helps out his substitute while he convalesces.



Age 43



Burrill Exley
Department Head

Age 37



Raymond Simonson
Boys' Golf Coach

Raymond Simonson

Age <40



William Nye
After-school Bowling

Age 50



Orval Theisen
Senior Class Advisor
S.E.A. Representative

Age 49



Laura Briscoe
Latin Club



Age 49

Mrs. Evans confers with Mr. Erickson on the material she is teaching for him while he convalesces.

1966

Tamarack

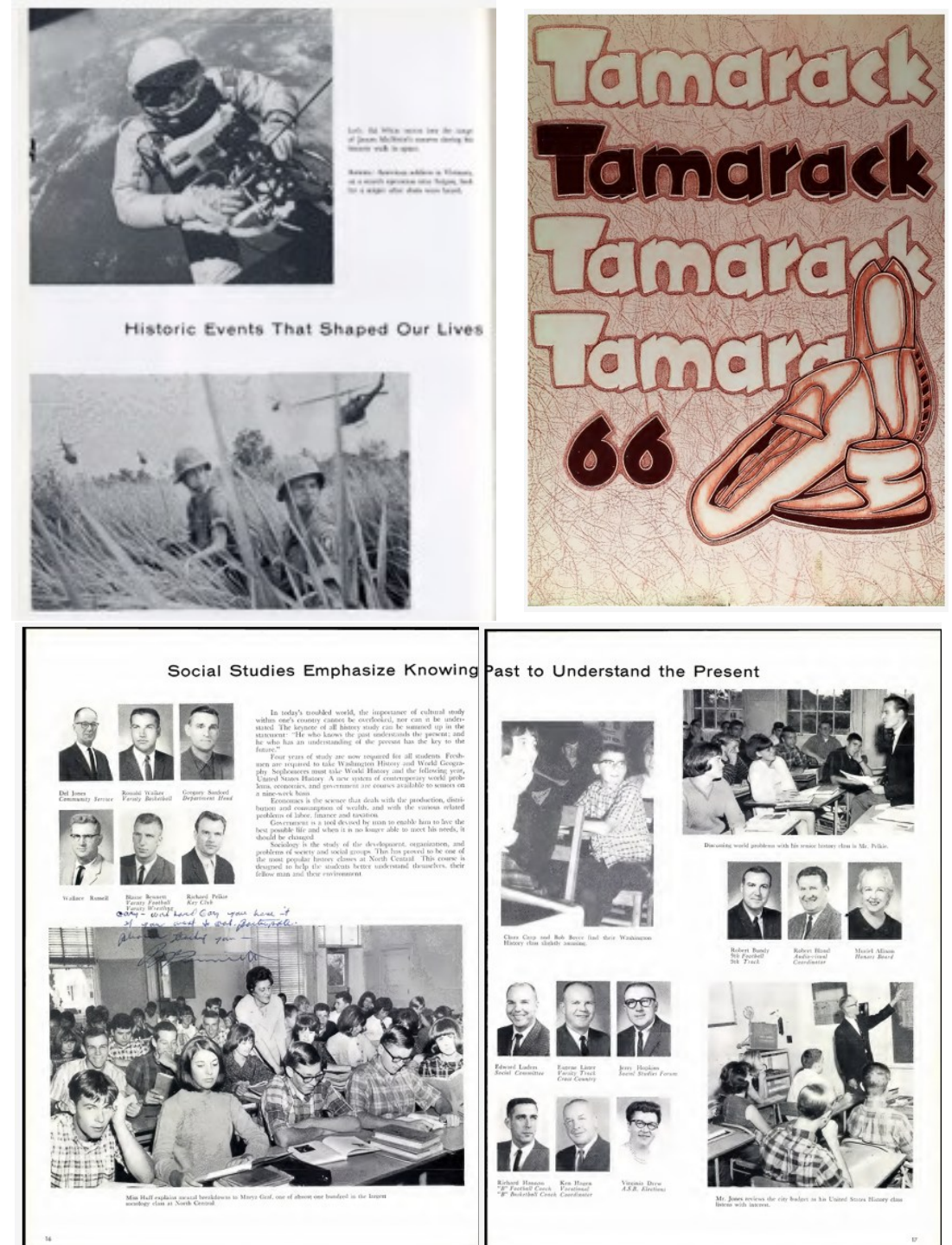
Who was president of the Spokane Education Association, and ran for the State Legislature?

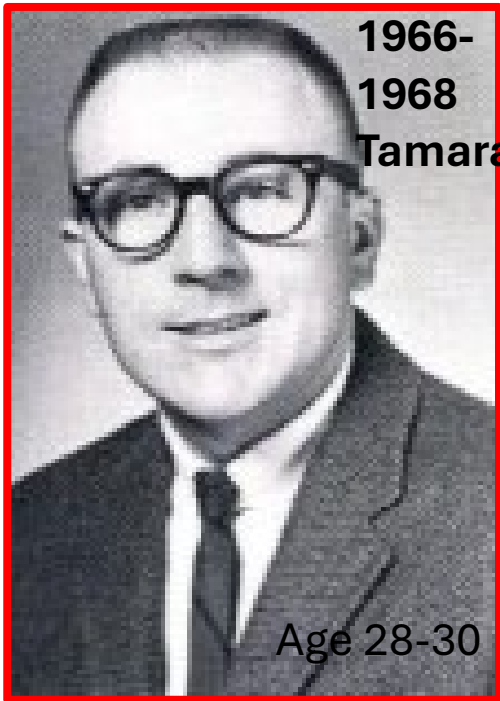
Theme Song: “A Change is Gonna Come” sung by Aretha Franklin, written by Sam Cooke 1964



Aretha Franklin - A Change Is Gonna Come

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k6YCxXQ6Scw>





**1966-
1968
Tamarack**

Age 28-30



Age 31

**1969
Tamarack**

**1970
Tamarack**
Age 32



**1974
Tamarack**

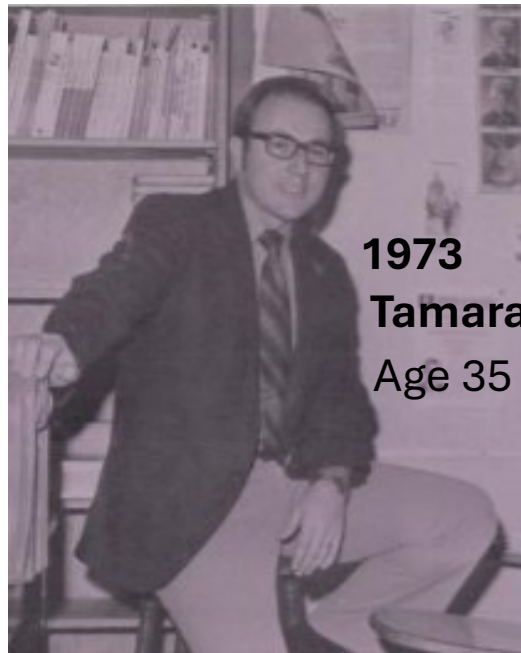
Age 36
Age 36



1971 Tamarack
Age 33



1972 Tamarack Age 34



**1973
Tamarack**
Age 35



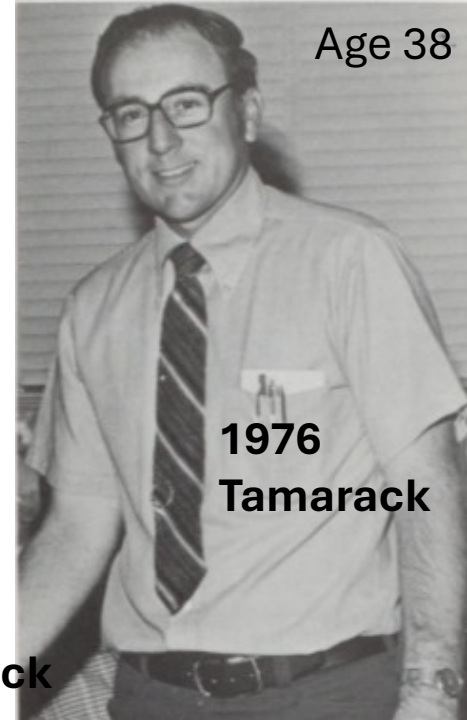
**1974
Tamarack**

Age 36
Age 36



Age 37

**1975
Tamarack**

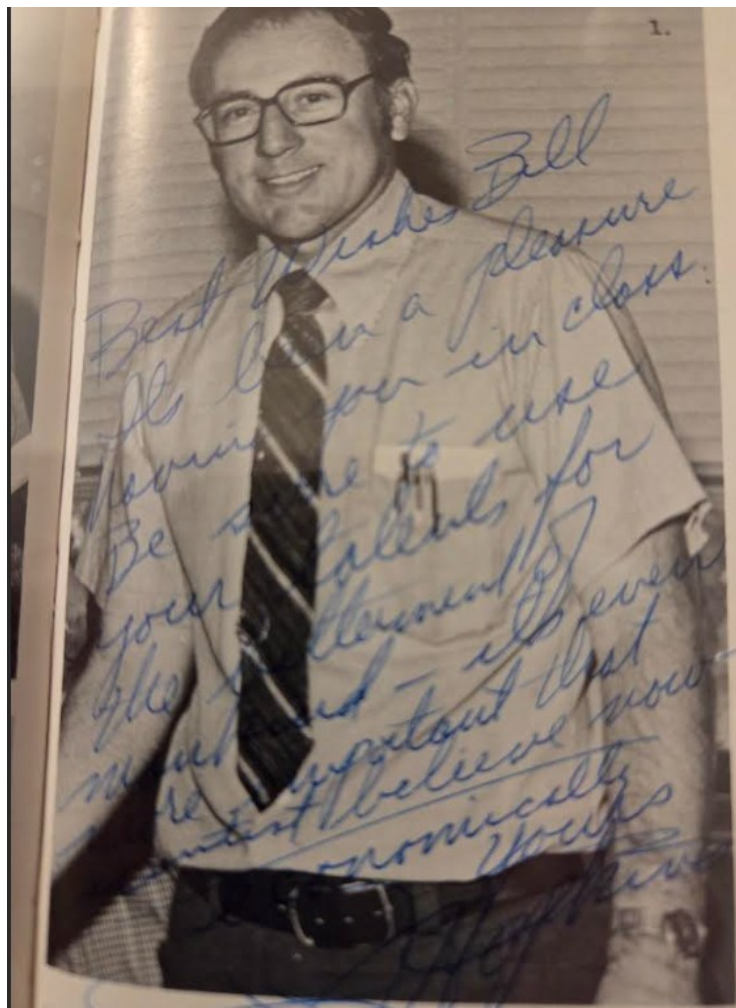


Age 38

**1976
Tamarack**



Jerry Hopkins
Social Studies Forum



Jerry Hopkins was a longtime North Central social studies teacher. In 1996, *The Spokesman-Review* described him as age **58**, raised on a farm in Eastern Washington, and having moved to Spokane in **1965**. That same profile says he taught **economics, world affairs, and social studies at North Central High School for 27 years. Current Age 88?**

His later public résumé adds that he had **bachelor's and master's degrees in education from Eastern Washington University**, administrative credentials from **Whitworth College**, and six years in the **Air Force Reserve**. It also says he had recently retired as president of the **Spokane Education Association**, had served **10 years on the Spokane City Park Board**, and was a member of the **Spokane Area Empowerment Committee**. <https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/oct/27/jerry-hopkins-d>

The 1967 *Tamarack* confirms him in the North Central faculty record as **Jerry Hopkins — Social Studies**, associated with **Social Studies Forum** and **ASB Committee**. A 1996 letter to the editor describes him as having “recently retired after **30 years as a teacher and social studies department chairman at North Central High School**” and as president of the Spokane Education Association for the previous year. That slightly differs from the newspaper candidate profiles’ “27 years,” but both agree on a long NC career ending around 1996.

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/sep/12/letters-to-the-editor>

He also ran for the Washington State Legislature in **1996** as a Democrat in the **6th District, Position 2**. *The Spokesman-Review* covered the primary and general election; the general election report described him as the former president of the Spokane Education Association and showed him trailing Republican Duane Sommers.

https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/sep/19/lets-shoestring-caign-appears-to-have-won/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Best Wishes Bill,
It's been a pleasure
having you in class.
Be sure to use your
talents for the
betterment of
mankind – it's ever
more important that
a scientist believe
now.
Economically yours,
J. Hopkins

Who was a head of the NC Drama Department, back when it had one?

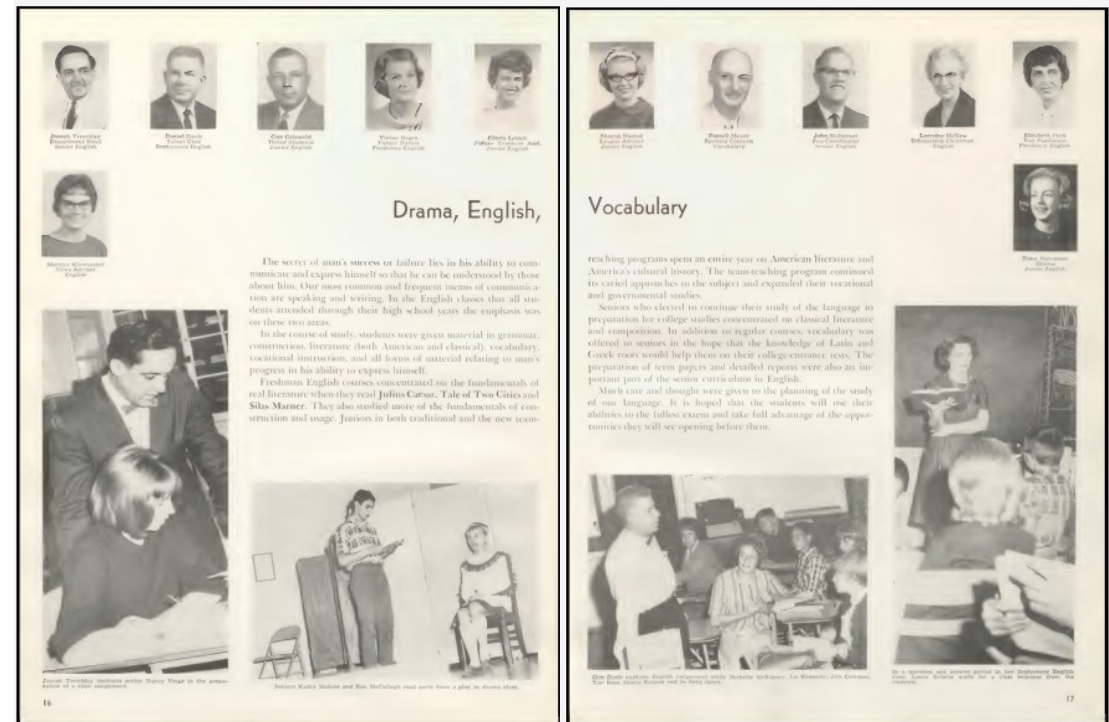
Theme
Song:
“Wouldn’t
It Be Nice”
by the
Beach
Boys

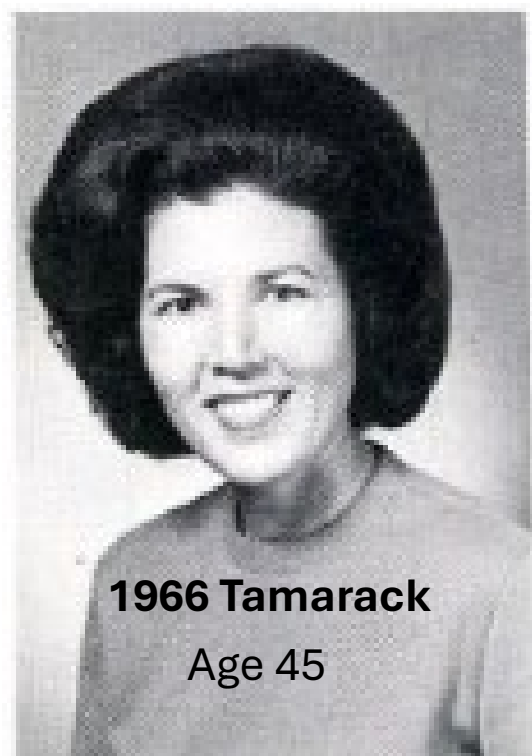


Play K

Wouldn't It Be Nice

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6Vv_dkDwZeQ&list=RD6Vv_dkDwZeQ&start_radio=1

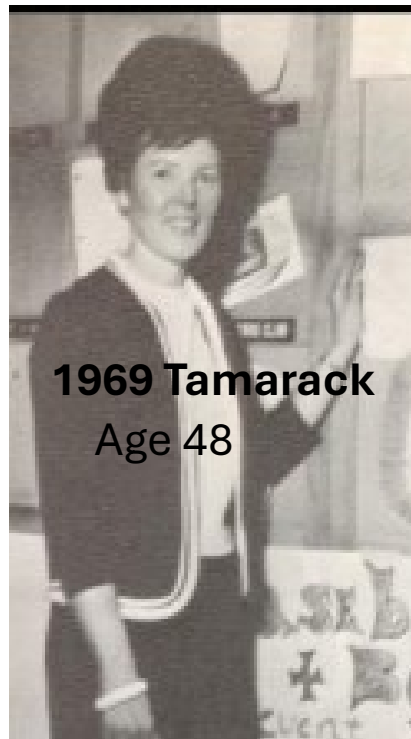




1966 Tamarack
Age 45



Age 46-47
1967- 1968
Tamarack



1969 Tamarack
Age 48



1970 Tamarack

Age 49

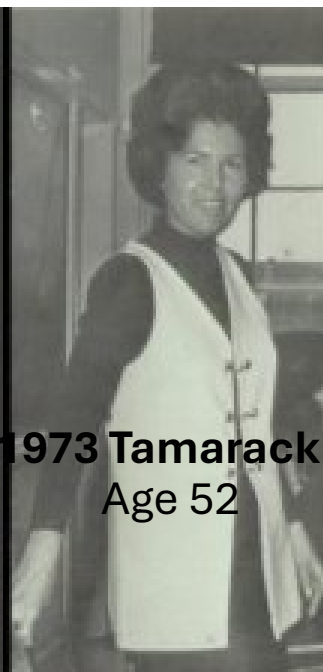


1971
Tamarack

Age 50



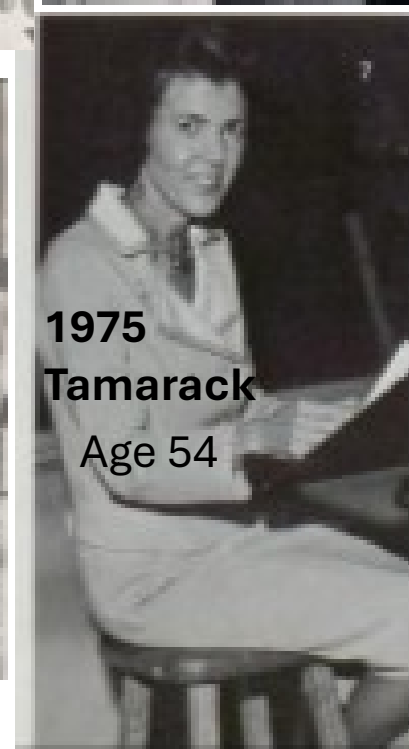
1972 Tamarack
Age 51



1973 Tamarack
Age 52



1974 Tamarack Age 53



1975
Tamarack
Age 54



1976 Tamarack
Age 55



Dorothy Murray
Girls' League

Age 44 in 1965



Age 55 in 1976



[https://obits.oregonlive.com/us/obituaries/oregon/name/donald-howard-and-dorothy-elliott-murray-
obituary?id=19666674](https://obits.oregonlive.com/us/obituaries/oregon/name/donald-howard-and-dorothy-elliott-murray-obituary?id=19666674)

Dorothy Mae Elliott Murray died on **March 2, 2004**, at age **83**, the same day as her husband, **Donald Howard Murray**, who was 84. Your notes correctly capture the striking shared obituary: Donald had been his wife's primary caregiver during her later health difficulties, and the couple had been married for about 60 years. Her obituary says she grew up in **Colfax, Washington**, began musical training at age 8, and graduated from **Washington State University** with a degree in **music**. She was classically trained as a **concert pianist** and later earned teaching credentials. During World War II, while Donald was away, she taught **music appreciation**; after the war the couple moved to Spokane to raise their family.

Her North Central connection is very well documented in the obituary: she taught **English at North Central High School for many years** and was also **head of the drama department**. The obituary gives a lovely classroom detail: every Monday, Donald had a flower delivered to her classroom. It also describes her as a teacher with a "fierce love of language" and a passion for teaching, remembered warmly by peers and students.

In the **1965 *Tamarack***, she is shown as **Dorothy Murray — Girls' League**, and by the **1976 *Tamarack*** she appears in the English department context. The 1976 North Central yearbook OCR also includes "**Dorothy Murray-advisor**" in a club/adviser listing.

Her obituary also emphasizes her lifelong intellectual and artistic life: she continued to read, play piano, and write letters to children, grandchildren, and friends despite serious physical difficulties later in life. It lists affiliations including **Rainbow, Beta Beta Chapter of Chi Omega**, and **Mu Phi Epsilon**, the honorary music society.

Homeroom,
Vocabulary,
and Reader's Theater



Age 46

Dorothy Murray
English
Vox Puellarum



Age 29

Jerry Hopkins
Social Studies
Social Studies
Forum
ASB Committee



Age 44

Burrill Exley
Mathematics
Department Head
Scholarship
Committee



Age 33

It's the **1967 Tamarack** and a new face has joined the team! Mrs. Murray is rockin' the 1967 big hair.

Mr. Rodkey is entertaining guests from Japan, and Mr. Theisen is handling dangerous acid.



Age 46

Presenting Mr. Rodkey (center) with a gift from our Japanese sister city, Nishinomiya, are Mr. Kobayashi, vice chief supervisor of the Nishinomiya Educational Board, and Mr. Inuki, principal of our sister high school, who spent some time during October visiting Spokane schools.



Age <411

William Nye
Mathematics
Equipment
Manager



Age 38

Raymond Simonson
Science



Age 51

Orval Theisen
Science
Sr. Class Advisor
Scholarship
Committee



Age 50

Laura Lee
Briscoe
Language Arts
Latin Club



Age 50

Norman Erickson
Business
Education
Junior Homeroom
Chairman



Age 28

Michael Caldwell
Music
Music Productions
Ensembles



Age 51

"Now, how will this experiment turn out?" wonder Skip Garrett and Mike Albee, as Orval Theisen adds acid to the mixture.

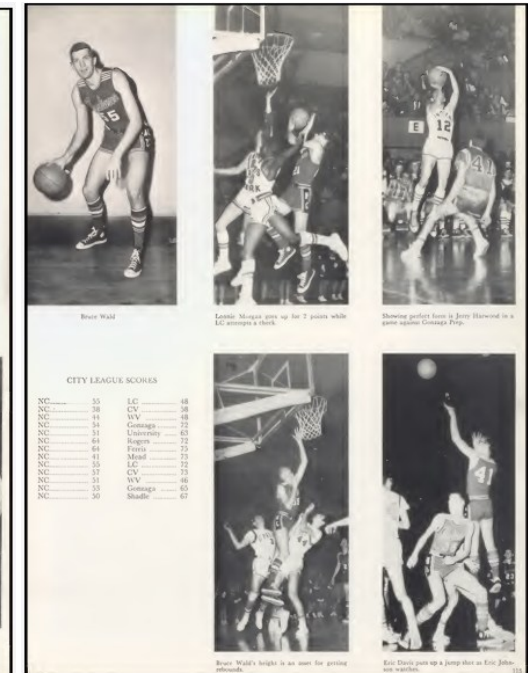
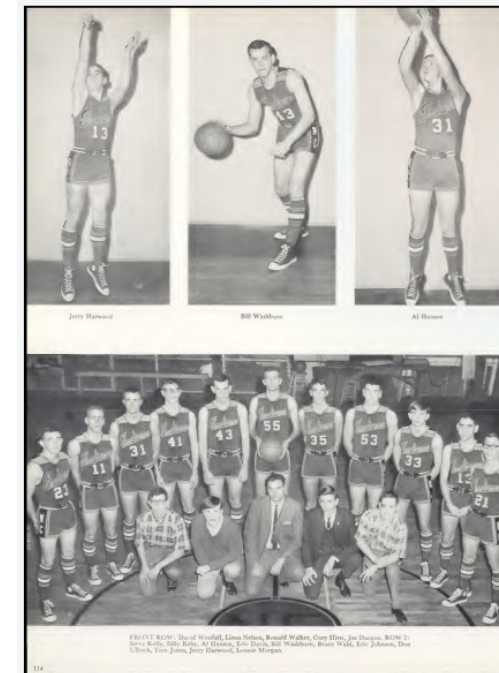
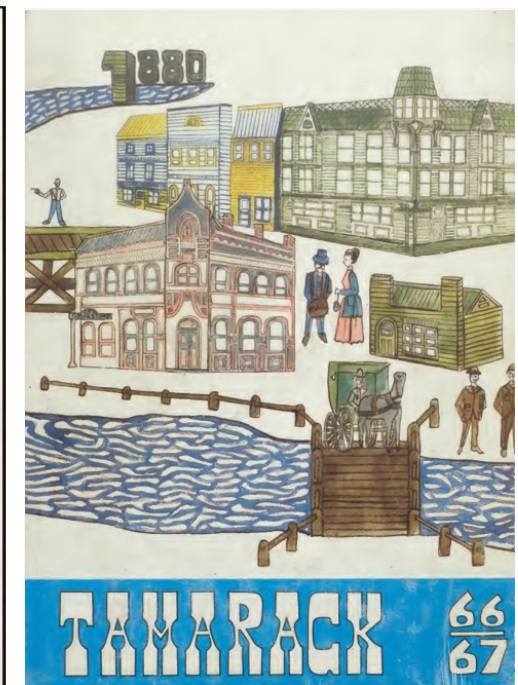
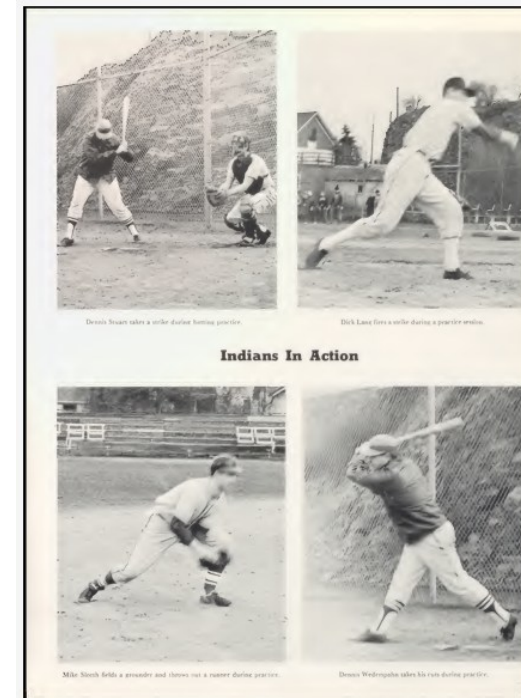
Who was one of the only set of three brothers to ever play basketball for the Zags, and he also played baseball for four years at Gonzaga?

Theme Song: “Sweet Soul Music”
by Arthur Conley



Sweet Soul Music

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SaphQafq3NQ&list=RD_SaphQafq3NQ&start_radio=1



1969 Tamarack



Age 35



**1967-1968
Tamaracks**

Age
33-34



Age 36

1970 Tamarack



Age 37

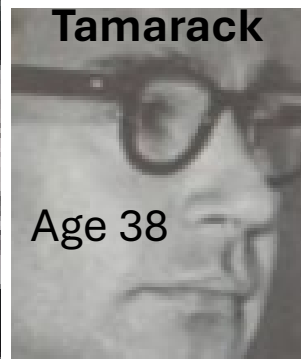
1971 Tamarack



1972 Tamarack

Age 38

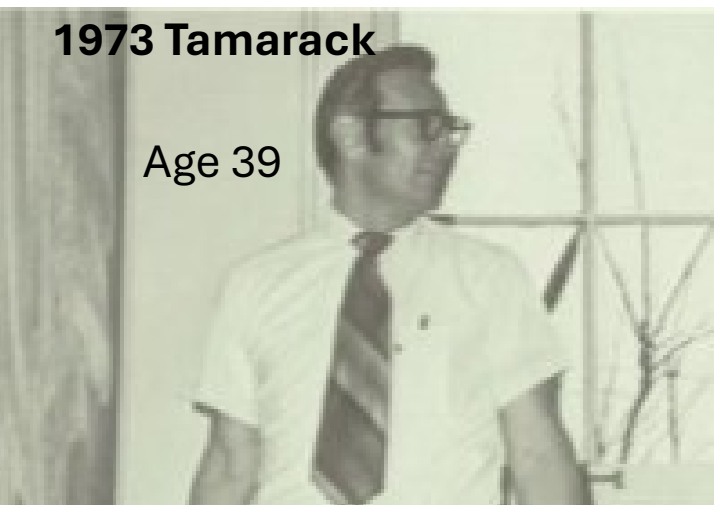
1972



Tamarack

Age 38

1973 Tamarack



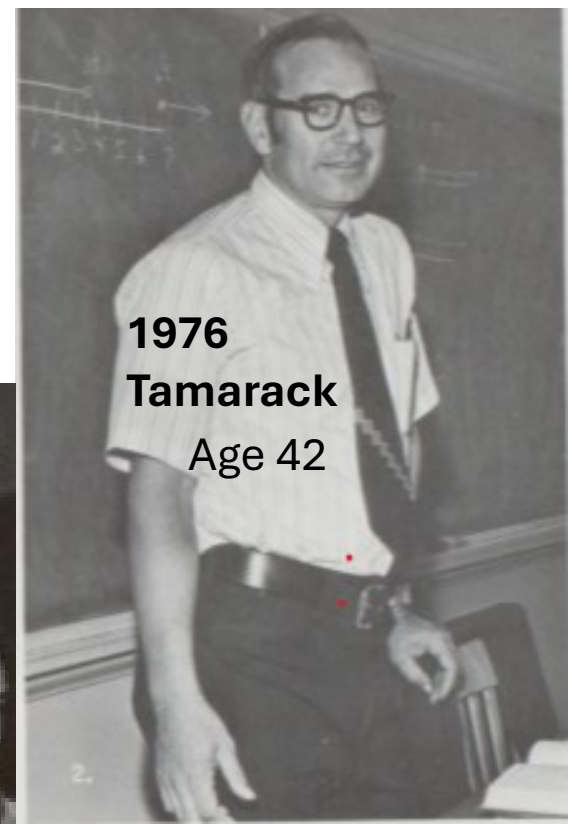
Age 39

**1974
Tamarack**

Age 40



1975 Tamarack
Age 41

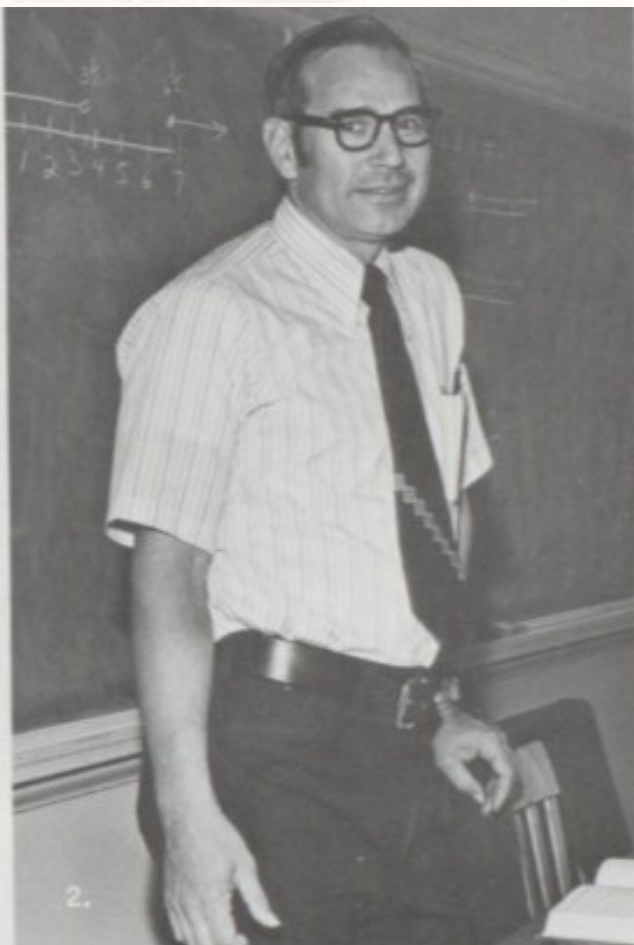


**1976
Tamarack**
Age 42



Age 33 in 1967

Joe Schauble
Mathematics
Fresh Football



Age 42
in 1976

Joseph J. / Joseph Juneau Schauble was born **June 14, 1934**, in **Killdeer, North Dakota**, and died peacefully at home on **February 7, 2024**, at age **89**. His family moved from North Dakota to **St. John, Washington**, in 1937, where he grew up. https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/joseph-schauble-obituary?id=54344483&utm_source=chatgpt.com

He attended **Gonzaga University** on a partial basketball scholarship and graduated in **1956**. His obituary notes that he and his older brothers **Bill** and **Rollin** were the only set of three brothers to play basketball for the Zags, and that Joe also played baseball for four years.

Professionally, he was both a **math teacher and coach**. His obituary says he taught for **38 years**, with the final **30 years at North Central High School**, retiring in **1996**. He earned a master's degree in school administration, but apparently preferred the classroom and court to administration.

His coaching career was unusually broad. A 1996 *Spokesman-Review* retirement article says that after **43 years of coaching**, Schauble had reached “the finish line” of that career. The same article describes him as versatile, noting that he coached across multiple sports and levels, served as co-director of Gonzaga summer sports camps for eight years, and worked for 11 years as a Spokane Parks Department recreational leader coaching baseball teams. https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/jul/04/north-central-coach-retires-after-varied-career/?utm_source=chatgpt.com



Age 51

Briscoe, Laura Lee
Language Arts
Foreign Language
Latin Club



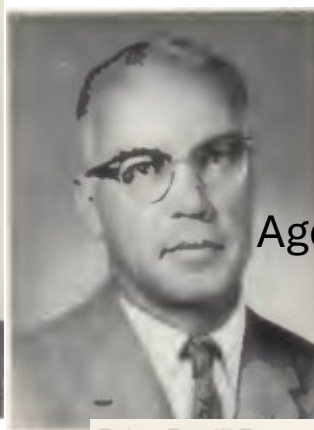
Age 29

Caldwell, Michael
Music
Music Productions
Ensembles



Age 51

Erickson, Norman W.
Business Education



Age 45

Exley, Burrill D.
Mathematics
Department Head



Age 37



Age 38



Age 30

Hopkins, Jerry
Social Studies
ASB



Age 47

Murray, Dorothy
Language Arts
Vox Puellarum



Age 39

Schauble, Joseph J.
Mathematics
Frosh Football



Simonson, Raymond W.
Science
Junior Class



Theisen, Orval P.
Science
Senior Class
Advisor



Age 29

It's the **1968 Tamarack** and our team has three new additions! Can you guess who?



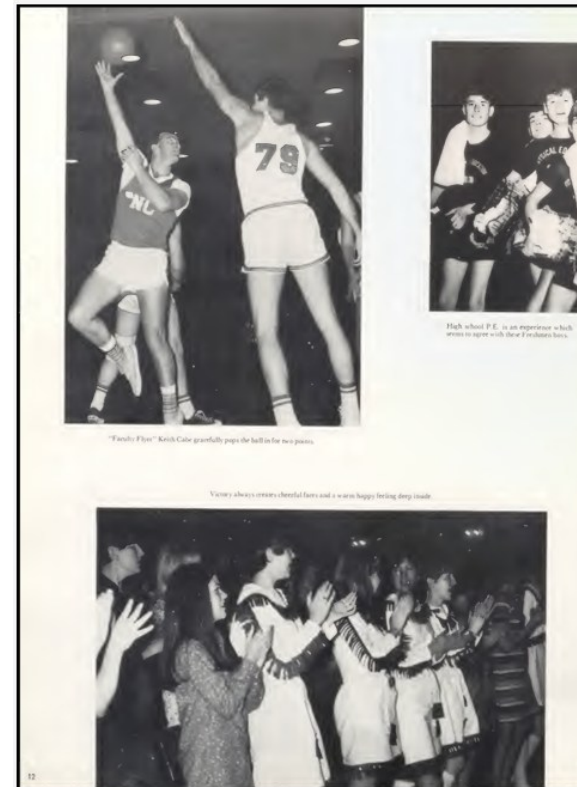
Who played college basketball at both the University of Washington and at Gonzaga?

Theme Song: “Born to be Wild” by Steppenwolf



Steppenwolf - Born to Be Wild (2023 Remaster)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVvidKyTwB8&list=RDKVvidKyTwB8&start_radio=1



1968 Tamarack



Age 38

1969 Tamarack



Age 39

1970 Tamarack



Age 40

1971 Tamarack



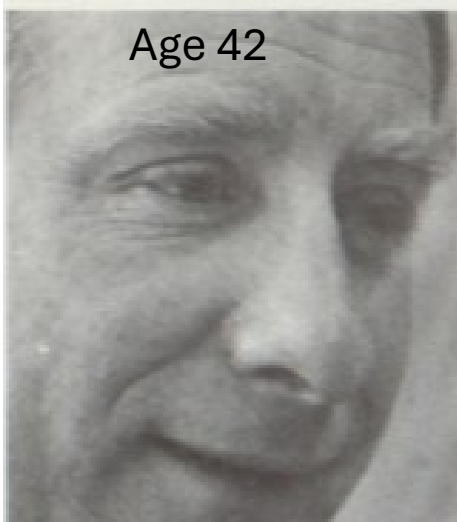
Age 41

1972 Tamarack



Age 42

1972 Tamarack



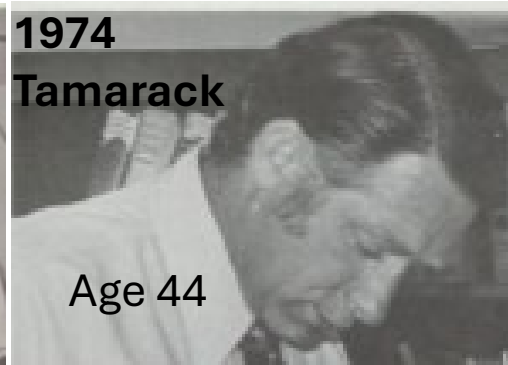
Age 42

1973 Tamarack



Age 43

1974 Tamarack

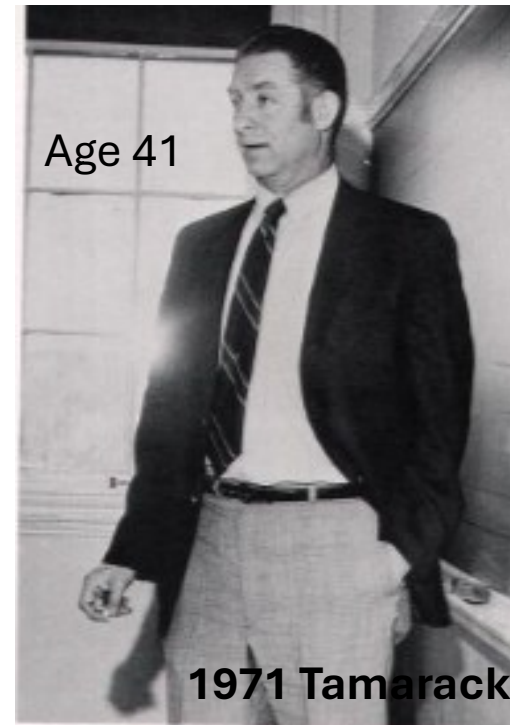


Age 44



Age 45

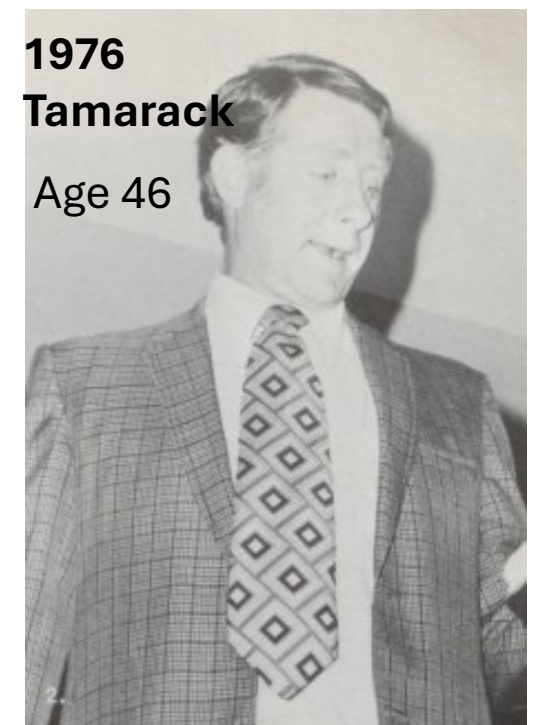
1975 Tamarack



Age 41

1971 Tamarack

1976 Tamarack



Age 46



Age 38
in 1968

https://www.pnwcremation.com/obituaries/George-Chalich?obId=2912317&utm_source=chatgpt.com

Who played college basketball at both the University of Washington and at Gonzaga?

George Chalich was born **March 23, 1930**, in **Butte, Montana**, and died **January 15, 2017**, in **Spokane Valley, Washington**, at age 86. His family moved to the Spokane Valley in 1938, and he attended Vera Grade School and **Central Valley High School**, where he competed in football, basketball, track, and baseball.

He was an outstanding athlete. His obituary says he was a first-team all-league basketball player as a sophomore, junior, and senior, led the league in scoring twice, and later played college basketball at both the **University of Washington** and **Gonzaga University**. He also walked on to the University of Washington baseball team and was offered a professional contract with the Seattle Rainiers, but chose to finish his degree.

Professionally, he taught and coached for **28 years** at **Oakesdale, Mead, and North Central High Schools**. His obituary includes the memorable line that he said he “**taught life**,” which would make a very good reunion-slide phrase. The 1968 North Central *Tamarack* confirms him in the NC faculty record as **George Chalich — Social Studies, with B-Squad Football and B-Squad Basketball**.



Age 46
in 1976

https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2012/sep/11/mom-had-their-backs/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

His sports life continued well beyond school coaching. He officiated college-level baseball and basketball, including Pac-8 basketball, and officiated throughout the Inland Northwest at high-school and youth levels for about **40 years**. He also played AAU basketball and softball with the Spokane Diesel team and remained active in golf. A 2017 *Spokesman-Review* column by John Blanchette remembered him as one of Spokane’s “heart-and-soul” sports figures, someone widely known in the local athletic community even if not always formally labeled an icon. Another *Spokesman-Review* piece from 2012, when he was being recognized on Central Valley’s Wall of Fame, described the Chalich siblings as a major athletic family in the Valley and noted that George had been a four-year, four-sport letter winner at Central Valley.

Coach Chalich ran US History fact drills like they were wind sprints, and it was good preparation for High School Bowl as it turned out – Harvard too.

Who taught Humanities as one of a set of new classes introduced in 1970 at NC?

Theme Song: "Classical Gas" by Mason Williams



Mason Williams - Classical Gas - ORIGINAL STEREO VERSION

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVvidKyTwB8&list=RDKVvidKyTwB8&start_radio=1

Mrs. Yvonne Carter and Mr. Edward Luders are seen teaching Humanities, one of the new classes introduced this year to North Central.



From Row: Pat Duth, Gail Luns, Kathy Carmon, Janet Pish, Melba Carpenter, Laura Wills, Row 2: Debbie Pash, Debbie Larkin, Karen Propp, Janet Phillips, Paul Pish, Susan Lunsford, John Wright, Tim Carmon, Row 3: Lynn Nelson, Ray Bessner, Kathy Callery, Gary Fierro, Clark Harrison, Fred Carmon, Jim Wright, Alan Jensen in Latin Club's advisor Mrs. Bessner.

"Ideas of March" Highlights Year

The proper name for what is commonly known as Little Club is *Senatus Populorum Romanus*, or the Senate and the Roman People.

To become a senator, a student must have a year or more of Latin and a GPA of 2.5.

The club's annual "Ideas of March" luncheon consisted of the Senate members dressing in togas, a dinner of Roman food and a

Spring officers were Tim Carmon, Karen Propp, Melba Carpenter, Debbie Larkin, Clay Jones.



From Row: Judy Louie, Joan Lusk, Fay Albert, Brenda Sherr, Donna Thompson, Susan Wilson, Loretta Rose, Row 2: Lynn Nelson, Ray Bessner, Paul Bessner, Steve Johnson, Marla Fries, Janet Nelson, Joanne Bessner, Row 3: Randy Schuler, Dick Lewis, Pat McCoy, Davis Adair, Sharon Gwin, Charles Rose, Vanessa Bessner, Carter Bess, Kathy Sherr, Jack Bessner, Doug West, Don Jones.

Art Club Holds Joint Installation

This year, Art Club, carried out their installation in a new way; making it a dinner meeting with the Shadle Park Club. This gave both schools a chance to exchange their artistic ideas and get acquainted.

The main project for Art Club is the production of the mural on the side of the band room.

Spring officers were: From Row: Brenda Sherr, president, Sarah Schuler, secretary, Row 2: Pat McCoy, vice president, Steve Johnson, treasurer, Dick Lewis, historian.



"Mollie Morgan" Produced by Thespians

At the first of the year Thespians produced the play "Mollie Morgan" by John Steinbeck.

After the play many new members were added. In February, an inter-city pot luck dinner formal initiation was held for the new members at Shadle Park. Following the initiation everyone went to see the play "Antony and Cleopatra" at the Civic Theatre.

Kathy Schuler, Carol McGick, and Susan Bessner plan for their next meeting.



1968 Tamarack



Age 37

1969 Tamarack



Age 38

1970 Tamarack



Age 39

1971 Tamarack



Age 40

1972 Tamarack



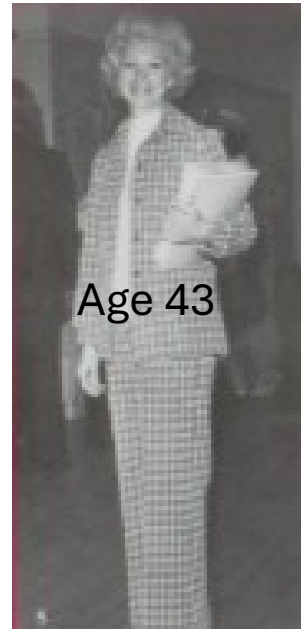
Age 41

1973 Tamarack



Age 42

1974 Tamarack



Age 43

1975 Tamarack



Age 44

1976 Tamarack



Age 45

Who taught Humanities as one of a set of new classes introduced in 1970 at NC?



Age 37
in 1968

<https://www.dignitymemorial.com/obituaries/spokane-wa/yvonne-edmunds-4509346>



Age 45
in 1976

She got remarried during our graduation year of 1976...

Yvonne L. Edmunds, formerly **Yvonne Carter**, was born **November 19, 1931**, in **Eugene, Oregon**, and died **January 4, 2011**, in Spokane at age 79. Her obituary says her family moved to Spokane shortly before she entered high school at **Lewis and Clark High School**. She attended **Washington State University** for one year before marrying her first husband, **Vernon Carter**.

After time on a farm in **Spangle, Washington**, and then back in Spokane, she resumed college studies at **Eastern Washington University** in 1964 and was the **outstanding graduate in the English department** three years later. She then taught **English and Humanities at North Central High School for 18 years**.

The 1970 *Tamarack* identifies **Mrs. Yvonne Carter** and **Mr. Edward Luders** as teaching **Humanities**, described as one of the new classes introduced that year at North Central. Her obituary also notes that she was active in both the **Spokane Education Association** and **Washington Education Association** during her teaching career.

She divorced in 1970 and, in 1976, married **Allan C. “Ace” Edmunds**, a retired Air Force brigadier general and Spokane civic figure. Alan Edmunds’s obituary also confirms that he and **Yvonne Carter** married in Spokane in 1976 and lived there for 34 years. After retiring from teaching, Yvonne had a second career in **real estate**.

Who visited every continent except Antarctica, and introduced International Week as an NC Tradition?

Theme Song: “Oye Como Va” by Carlos Santana



Santana - Oye Como Va (Official Audio)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J7ATTjg7tpE&list=RDJ7ATTjg7tpE&start_radio=1



From Row: Doug Thompson, Cheryl Wunderlich, Russ Bensch, Sue Saling, David Waddell, Shirley Brown, Larry Ross, Sue Blum, Walter Cane, Row 2: Karl Ford, Duane Mitchell, Denise Wroble, Jose Vaughn, Carlos Cane, Jill Fink, Nanci Kelle, Trudi Larson, Merry Simpson, Thelma Gaudin, Row 3: Cheryl Strong, Jackie Lindner, Sally Burns, Pat White, Jackie Becker, Nadine

Nancy, Vivian Houser, Jackie Baldwin, Diane Dillon, Connie Becker, Karen Gillette, Cheryl Smith, Row 4: Christine Baker, Jon Brown, Judy Byland, Linda Matlack, Jeannette Davis, Jane Johnson, Cherie Mickel, Sharon Summers, Candy Hens

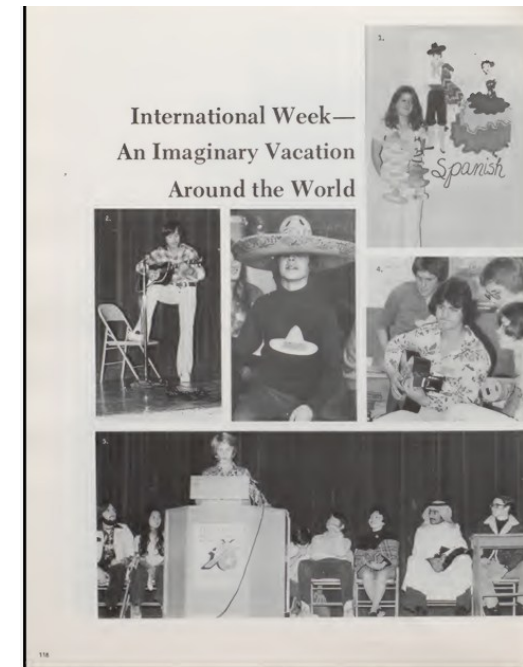
International Club

International Club is composed of the German, French and Spanish components of our foreign languages. The club was organized in 1962 to promote further interest in the foreign language field and was guided throughout the year by Mrs. Lynette McGarry, faculty adviser.

Officers were, Front Row: David Waddell, Back Row: Vivian Houser, Christine Baker and Carlos Cane



Cheryl Wunderlich gives important instructions to new members



From our 1976 Tamarack ->



1968 Tamarack

Age 29

1970 Tamarack



Age 31

1974 Tamarack



Age 35

1971 Tamarack



Age 32

1972 Tamarack Age 33



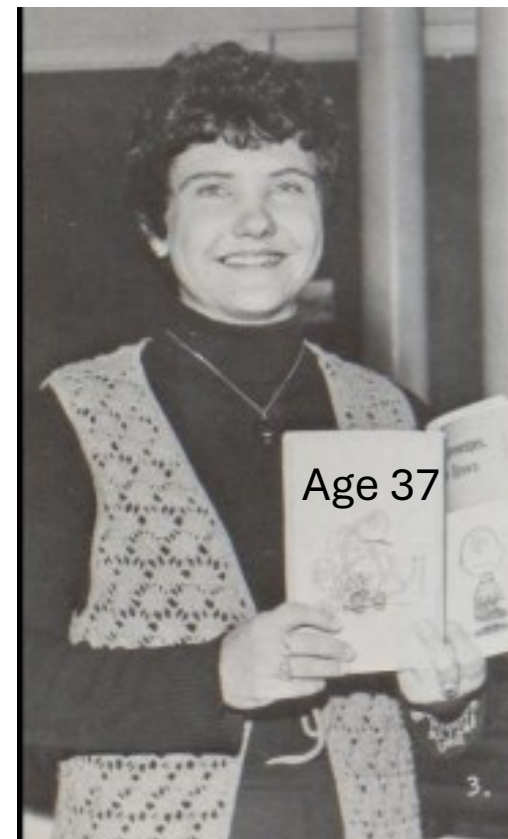
1973 Tamarack
Age 34



1975 Tamarack Age 36



**1976
Tamarack**



Age 37



Age 29
in 1968

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/zoe-mcgarry-obituary?id=28474323>

The full name appears to be **Zoe Lynette McGarry**, born **Zoe Lynette Squires**. She seems to have gone professionally by **Lynette McGarry**, which matches the *Tamarack* captions.

Zoe Lynette McGarry (Squires) died on **October 29, 2009**, after a brief illness, at age **70**. Her obituary describes her as a Spanish and French teacher whose love of travel helped shape her career. It says she taught for many years in Spokane at **Lewis & Clark, North Central, and Shadle Park High Schools**, and also taught abroad in **Liberia** and **Singapore**.

Her education record appears to include a **1961 University of Idaho degree**, where the commencement program lists **Zoe Lynette Squires, Buhl, cum laude**. A 1963 LSU thesis record lists **Zoe Lynette Squires** as author of *An Analysis of the Psychological Novels of Augustin Yáñez*, which fits a Spanish-language/literature teacher.



Age 37
in 1976

https://books.google.com/books/about/An_Analysis_of_the_Psychological_Novels.html?id=_65BzwEACAAJ&utm_source=chatgpt.com

The 1967 *Tamarack* lists **Lynette McGarry** in **Language Arts / International Club** contexts, and the 1968 *Tamarack* identifies her as a **faculty adviser** in yearbook/*Tamarack* material. The 1970 *Tamarack* says “Juniors on *Tamarack* listen as advisor Mrs. Lynette McGarry explains layout design,” showing her role with the yearbook staff as well as language teaching. The 1976 *Tamarack* refers to her as **“Lynette McGarry — creator of International Week,”** which is a wonderful detail for your reunion slide.

Her obituary strongly emphasizes travel and cultural engagement. It says she visited every continent except Antarctica, had a gift for treating strangers as friends, and remained active in civic, cultural, and social activities. It also says she was remembered by “thousands of students whose lives she enriched.” Guestbook comments specifically remember her as a Spanish teacher at NC in the early 1970s an



The 1973-74 Tamarack Staff would like to dedicate this year's Tamarack to our advisor, Mrs. Lynette McGarry, in tribute of our appreciation for the hard work, overtime hours, and dedication with which she has helped us all.

Not only has she been invaluable as an advisor, but also to many of us she has been a dear friend, who many a time doubled as a mother.

"I welcome this opportunity to pay tribute to Mrs. McGarry and her dedicated spirit toward the Tamarack. She assumed the responsibility for production without training, but willingly put her shoulder to the wheel and has directed some fine yearbooks. In fact, according to my conversations with her, she has literally fallen in love with the assignment. I extend my congratulations to Mrs. McGarry and this year's staff."

John B. Koller

"With deepest sincerity, thank you, Mrs. McGarry for all your great efforts; without them this publication would not have been possible."

Your Tamarack Staff

1974 Tamarack

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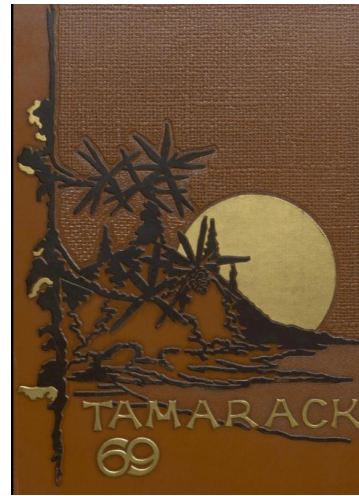
John B. Koller

"With deepest sincerity, thank you, Mrs. McGarry for all your great efforts; without them this publication would not have been possible."

Your Tamarack Staff

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1969

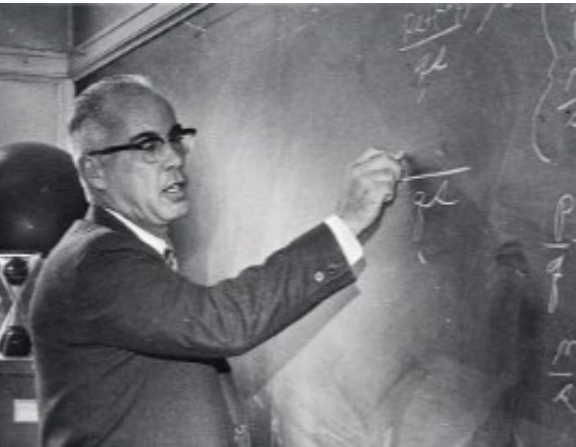
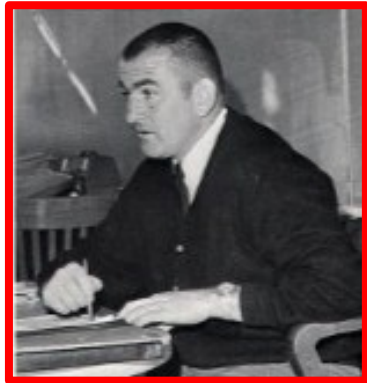
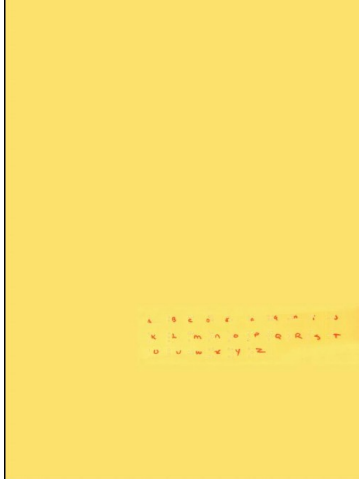
<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1974/page/n47/mode/2up>



It's 1970, and can you
Guess the four new
additions to the team?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1970

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1970/mode/2up>



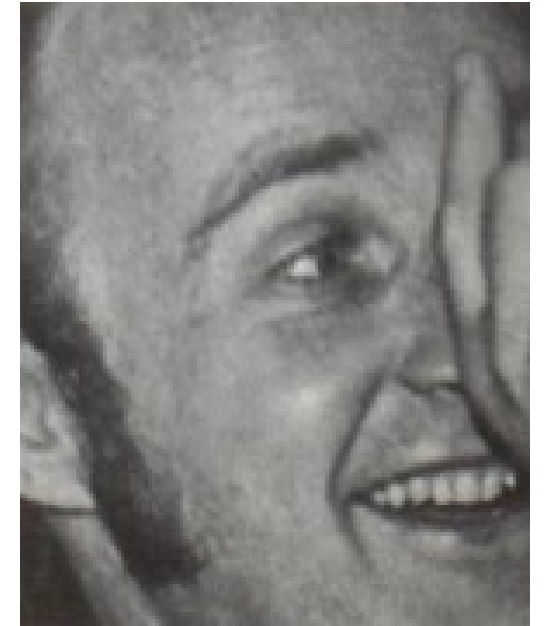
1970 Tamarack Age 26



1971 Tamarack Age 27



1972 Tamarack Age 28



1973 Tamarack



Age 29

1974 Tamarack



Age 30

1975 Tamarack Age 31



1976 Tamarack Age 32



Who served in the Washington State Legislature as first a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990?

**1970
Tamarack**

Age 26



1976 Tamarack Age 32



Gerard "Jerry" Eamon de Valera Hughes passed away in Santa Rosa, California, on August 9, 2022, at the age of 78. He was an elected member of the Washington State Legislature representing Spokane before retiring to raise his children and later became a beloved public high school teacher.

Life & Career Timeline:

- **Early Life:** Born in New York on February 16, 1944, to Irish immigrant parents, Jerry grew up in Rockaway Beach and later relocated with his family to San Francisco, where he excelled at baseball at St. Ignatius High School.
 - **Education & Inspiration:** He attended Gonzaga University in Spokane, where a speech by President Kennedy inspired him to pursue public service.
 - **Political Career:** He entered the Washington State Legislature and served two terms representing Spokane.
 - **Teaching & Legacy:** After stepping away from state politics, he went on to teach history and become a beloved public high school educator (such as at North Central High School) before moving back to California in his later years.
- You can read more about his life and leave messages for the family on his official [Legacy.com Obituary Page](https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/sfgate/name/gerard-hughes-obituary?id=36249010) or view the registry of condolences on the [Spokesman-Review Obituary Page](#).

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/sfgate/name/gerard-hughes-obituary?id=36249010>

Jerry Hughes served in the Washington State Legislature as a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990. Prior to his political career, he taught history at North Central High School in Spokane, Washington.

Biographical Details

- **Early Career & Teaching:** Before entering state politics, Jerry Hughes worked as a public high school history teacher at North Central High School in Spokane, WA.
- **Political Run:** Although he made an unsuccessful run for State Representative in 1976, he successfully ran for the State House representing Spokane in 1978.
- **Legislative Service:** He served in the Washington House of Representatives before moving to the Washington State Senate, serving from 1983 through 1990.
- **Later Life:** After stepping down from the legislature, Hughes went on to teach political science at Gonzaga University in Spokane.

Because he served in office decades ago and is a private citizen, comprehensive biographical archives or an obituary for him are not widely published online. To track down further specific details or verify public records, you can review his legislative profile via the Washington State Legislature or research past Spokane news archives.

Who served in the Washington State Legislature as first a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990?



16. HIGH SCHOOL BOWL: John Robertson, Bill Worstell, Bob Lenius, Marco Barbanli, Mark Robertson, Doug Buckley, Jerry Hughes, Coach.

Mr. Hughes Anecdotes

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

1976: The Bicentennial, Student Autonomy, and Social Shift

The year of your graduation—1976—marked the **U.S. Bicentennial** and arrived on the heels of massive social upheavals, including the Vietnam War, the Civil Rights Movement, and Title IX (passed in 1972).

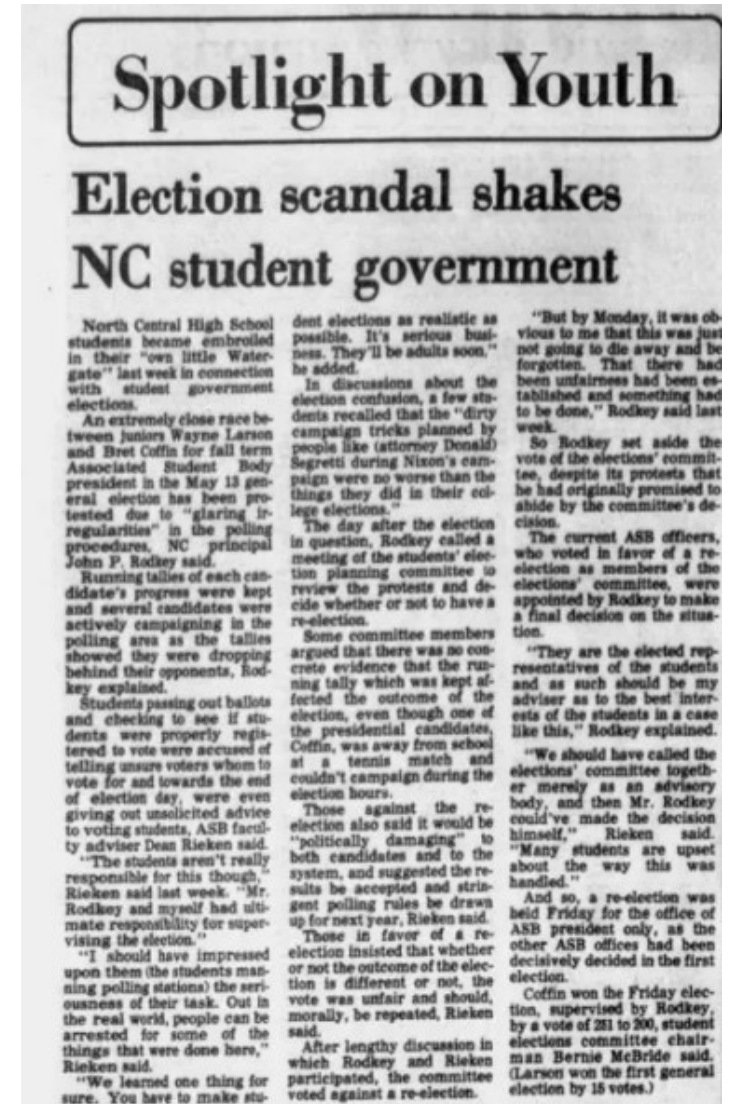
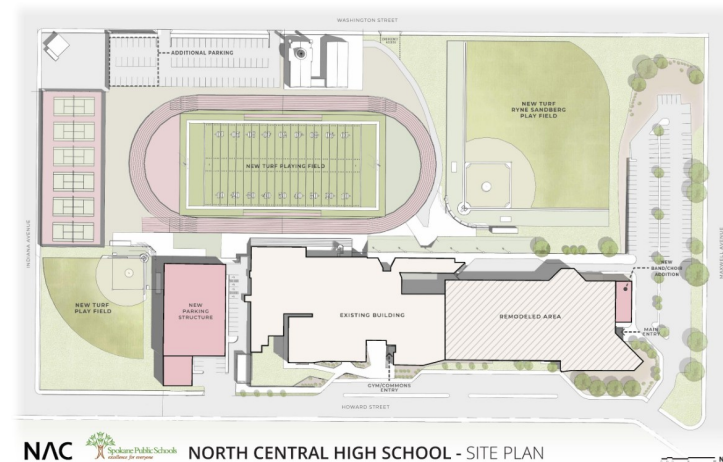
- The Educational Philosophy:** The rigid structures of the 1950s gave way to student-centered learning, elective-heavy curricula, and a massive push for gender equity in sports and academics.

- The Environment:** The atmosphere at NC was alive with the expressive, independent energy of the 1970s. Students exercised a level of political autonomy and social awareness unseen in previous generations—even mirroring real-world complexities, such as the [historic student body election controversy](#) that rocked the school in May 1976 over active campaigning and registry irregularities. This era marked the final years of the fabled original building, which was razed shortly after in 1981 to make way for a more functional, modern facility.



Alice Cooper - "School's Out" (Lyric Video)

<https://www.togetherspokane.org/nc-modernization>



Theme song from 1970: “School’s Out”, by Alice Cooper
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rcEbSkaAqkg&list=RDrcEbSkaAqkg&start_radio=1

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/may/23/his-day-in-history-north-central-high-school-rock/>

1970 Tamarack Age 30



1971 Tamarack Age 31



1973 Tamarack Age 33
Age 33



1972 Tamarack Age 32



1974 Tamarack Age 34 **1975 Tamarack** Age 35



1976 Tamarack Age 36



Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

Yes — I found one likely educational-history clue, and it makes your “he looks young in 1970” impression very plausible.

The likely match is **Melvin Dean “Dean” Rieken/Ricken**, born **September 1, 1940**, in Red Oak, Iowa. A genealogy/newspaper-index page gives a 1962 notice saying he had graduated from **Emmett High School in 1958** and was then a **senior at Idaho State College**, majoring in **English education**. It also says he was a member of **Blue Key**, a national honor fraternity, and **Sigma Nu**. The same page has later records under **M. D. Rieken**, so I think this is probably your Dean Rieken, though the page uses the spelling “Ricken” in places. ([Miller Family Genes](#))

That gives a very reasonable age estimate:

If born September 1940, Dean Rieken would have been 29 during most of the 1969–70 school year, turning 30 in September 1970.

He would have been about **34–35** during the 1975–76 school year.

That fits the attached 1970 image very well. It also fits a path like:

Emmett High School, 1958 → Idaho State College English Education, likely class of 1962/63 → teaching career by the late 1960s → North Central English / Senior Composition / ASB adviser by the 1970s.

The public North Central trail is consistent: the 1970 *Tamarack* indexes **Dean Rieken** on several pages, and the 1975 *Tamarack* indexes **Rieken, Dean** on pages 34 and 92. ([Internet Archive](#)) Later public payroll records list **M. Dean Rieken** as a Spokane teacher from **1999 through 2002**, which suggests a long Spokane Public Schools career. ([OpenPayrolls](#))

For your slide or notes, I’d phrase it cautiously:

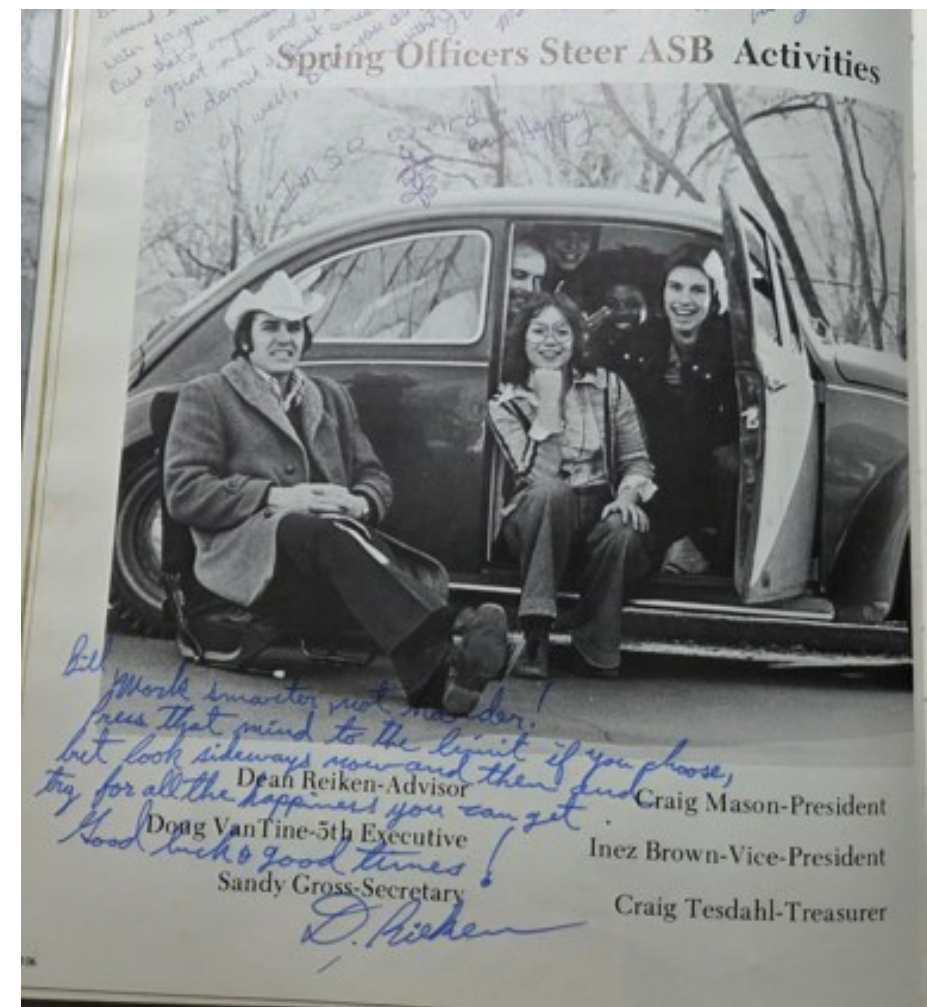
Dean Rieken — English / Senior Composition

Likely Melvin Dean Rieken, born 1940; Emmett High School graduate, 1958; Idaho State College English Education major, early 1960s. If this identification is correct, he was only about 29–30 in the 1970 *Tamarack* photo and about 35 during Bill’s senior year. He appears in North Central *Tamarack* records by 1970 and later served as English teacher, Senior Composition teacher, and ASB faculty adviser.

I would mark the birthdate/college detail as **probable but not fully school-confirmed** until verified from an Idaho State yearbook, alumni record, or Spokane Public Schools personnel source.

Theme song from 1970: “School’s Out”, by Alice Cooper

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rcEbSkaAqkg&list=RDrcEbSkaAqkg&start_radio=1



Bill, Work smarter not harder! Press that mind to the limit if you choose, but look sideways now and then and try for all the happiness you can get. Good luck & good times! D. Rieken

It's Mr. Rieken!

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

The name appears to be **M. Dean Rieken**, usually shown in school contexts simply as **Dean Rieken**. I found **good public documentation of his North Central role**, but **no confirmed obituary or death record**. Your earlier research notes say public records show **M. Dean Rieken** still working as a Spokane teacher through at least **2002**, and explicitly note that no official obituary or conclusive online death record had been found.

The North Central yearbook trail places him there before your senior year. The **1970 *Tamarack*** OCR lists **Dean Rieken** in the faculty material near Lynette McGarry and other NC teachers. ([Internet Archive](#)) By **1976**, he was prominent enough in student government to be quoted as **ASB faculty adviser** in a *Spokesman-Review* account of the disputed North Central student-body-president election. The article says the election was invalidated after alleged voting irregularities, and quotes Rieken saying that in the outside world people could be arrested for some of what had happened; he also took some responsibility for not impressing on students the seriousness of the process. ([Spokesman-Review](#)) A public payroll index also lists **M. Dean Rieken** as a **Spokane teacher** from **1999 through 2002**, so his Spokane Public Schools career appears to have continued long after the 1970s. ([OpenPayrolls](#)) I would avoid using private-address/background-check material in a public reunion deck, but the name and age clues suggest this may be **Melvin Dean Rieken**, born around **1940**; I would treat that as tentative unless confirmed from a school, alumni, or obituary source.

A careful slide-ready caption:

<https://www.classmates.com/siteui/yearbooks/4182717980>

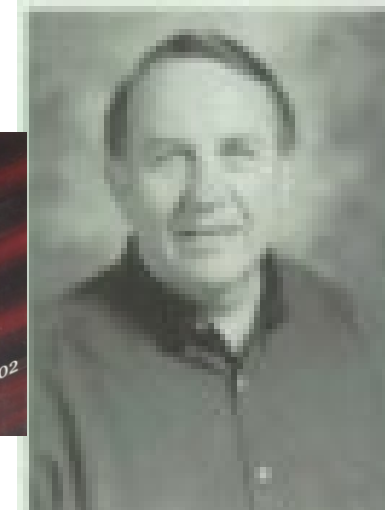
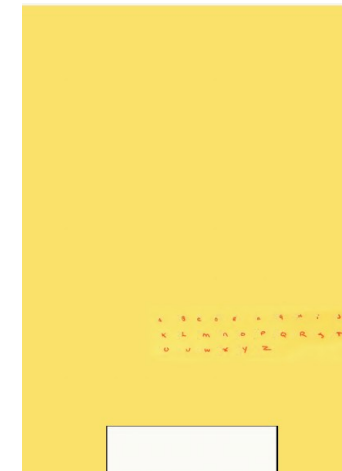
Dean Rieken — English / Senior Composition / ASB Adviser

North Central High School English teacher, documented in the *Tamarack* record by 1970 and remembered by 1976 students for Senior Composition. In May 1976, he was quoted in *The Spokesman-Review* as the ASB faculty adviser during a disputed student-body election, a small but vivid glimpse of his role in NC civic life. Public payroll records suggest M. Dean Rieken continued as a Spokane teacher through at least 2002. No confirmed obituary has been found, so birth and death dates should be left blank unless verified from school archives or family sources.

Short version for the presentation:

Dean Rieken — English & Senior Composition

NC English teacher and ASB faculty adviser, documented in the 1970s *Tamarack* record and still listed as a Spokane teacher decades later. A confirmed obituary has not yet been found.



Dean Rieken, Language Arts



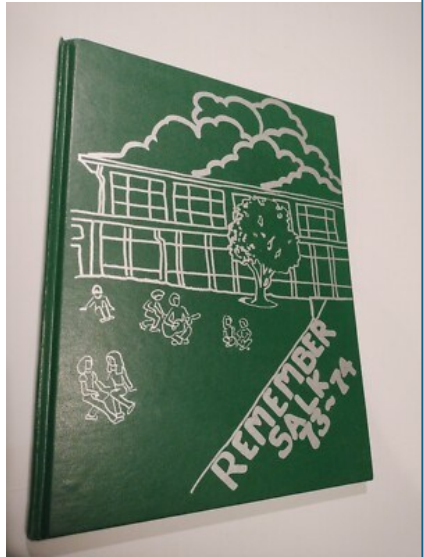
Kim Rieken, Social Studies

In the outside world people could be arrested for some of what had happened...
We've come along way from the student courts of the early 1950s in a quarter century...

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

Mr. Rieken Anecdotes

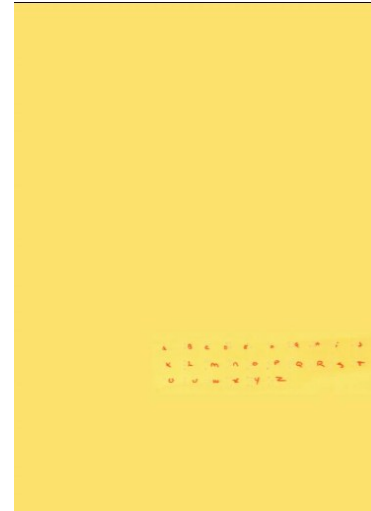
Who went on later to be a principal at Salk Middle School?



I attended Salk for 7th-9th grades from 1970-1973

The Math Department there was great, among other things. I broke my left arm (Ulna) there twice – first time on the playfield in a lunchtime mob playing “Smear the Queer”. Second time I was receiving an illegal body slam on the mats in Wrestling practice. We just kept going. I had a paper route back then – next to Jim Stratton’s one – and I could take it.

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1970>



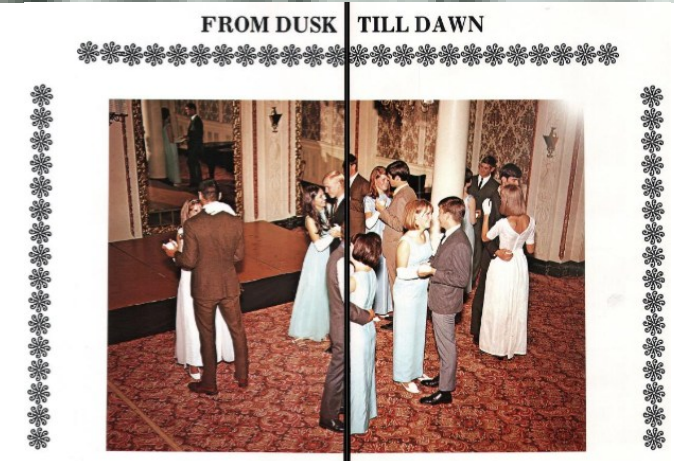
Carpenters "We've Only Just Begun" on The Ed Sullivan Show

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9hJCr9cq5co&list=RD9hJCr9cq5co&start_radio=1

Theme song from 1970: “We’ve Only Just Begun”, by the Carpenters



Supplying music for a dance and mixer is our own band, The General Delivery, consisting of guitarist Richard Coleman and Paul Barclay and drummer Mark Seibert.



1970 Tamarack Age<32



1971 Tamarack Age<33



1972 Tamarack Age<34



1973 Tamarack Age<35



1974 Tamarack Age<36



1975 Tamarack Age<37



1976 Tamarack



Who went
on later to
be a
principal
at Salk
Middle
School?

Who went on later to be a principal at Salk Middle School?



Mary Haugen was an English/theater teacher at **North Central High School** in the mid-1970s. She began at NC as an English and drama teacher in **1975/1976**, later moved into administration, served as principal of **Salk Middle School**, received the **Washington Award for Excellence in Education**, and retired in 2000.

The Salk record is strong. A 2000 *Spokesman-Review* article says Pam Scott took over for **Salk Principal Mary Haugen**, who had “retired last year after **13 years at the helm**” of the North Side middle school. That places Haugen as Salk principal roughly **1986/1987–1999**.

Her recognition is also documented. In 1999, the state superintendent’s office recognized **Salk Middle School principal Mary Haugen** in the **Washington Award for Excellence in Education**, and she was the **only nominee from Spokane School District 81**. <https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1999/may/06/finch-plans-dance-performance/>

Several *Spokesman-Review* articles show the character of her Salk leadership. In 1996, after the Moses Lake school shootings, Haugen and Assistant Principal Les Johnson visited every class to discuss bullying and safety; the article describes Salk as having a well-established program to address teasing, taunting, and fighting. In 1999, she praised Salk’s peer-mediation program, saying students often resolve problems better when peers help them find their own solutions.

Who went on to later be a principal at Salk Middle School?

I would **tighten Mrs. Haugen's NC tenure** this way:

Mary Haugen — English / Drama

Earliest public *Tamarack* evidence I found: **1970**.

Present in NC *Tamarack* indexes through at least **1976**.

Later principal of Salk Middle School, where she served about **13 years**, retiring around **1999/2000**, and was recognized in 1999 in the Washington Award for Excellence in Education program. ([Internet Archive](#))

For **where to find her in the yearbooks**, the searchable yearbook OCR gives these index locations:

I would not say “began career at NC in 1975” anymore. Your own yearbook search has now pushed her back to **1970**, and the Salk-principal material still works as her later career arc. A cleaner version:

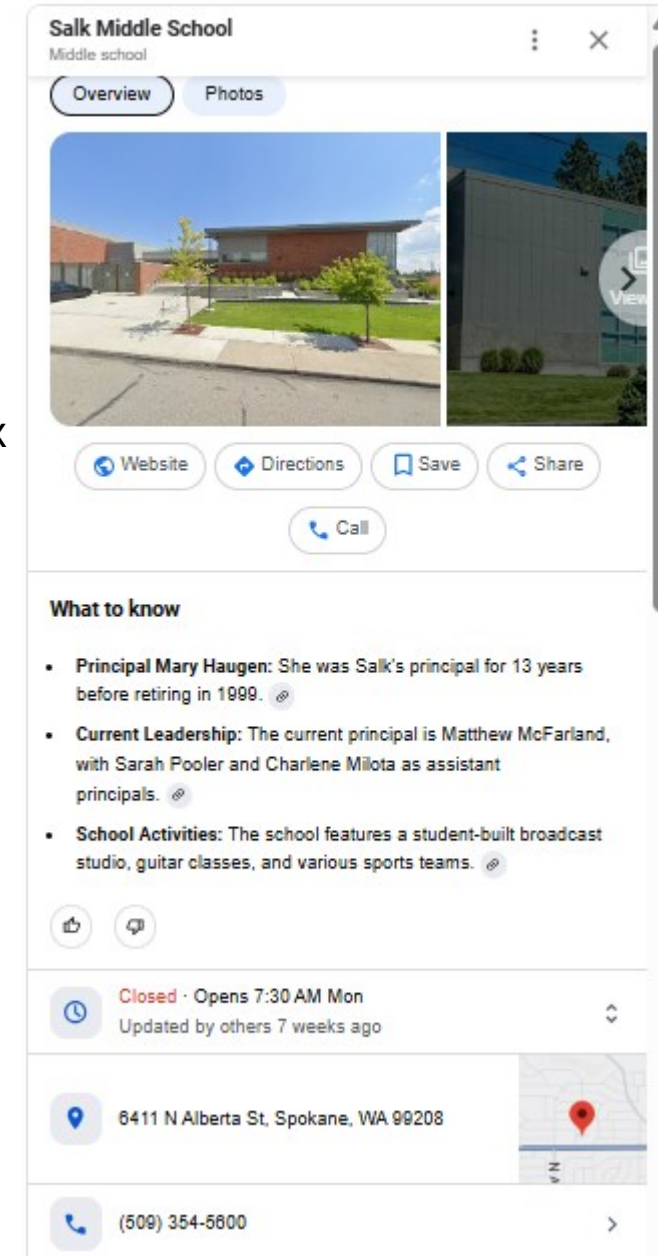
Mary Haugen taught English and drama at North Central by **1970** and remained there through at least **1976**. She later became principal of Salk Middle School, serving roughly 13 years and retiring around 1999/2000. In 1999 she was Spokane School District 81's sole nominee for the Washington Award for Excellence in Education. Her later work at Salk emphasized student safety, peer mediation, and direct attention to student life.

For a **theme song as she joined the NC faculty**, my first choice would be:

“We’ve Only Just Begun” — The Carpenters, 1970.

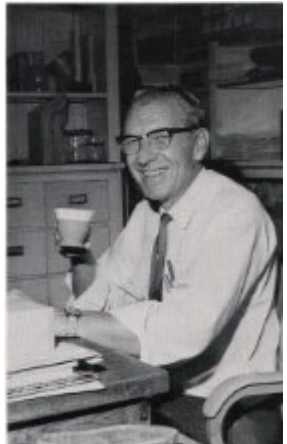
That one fits the handwritten message in your slide — “What an exciting four years you have ahead...” — almost perfectly. It was released as a Carpenters single in 1970.

([Wikipedia](#))



SPL Yearbooks North Central 1971

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1971/mode/2up>

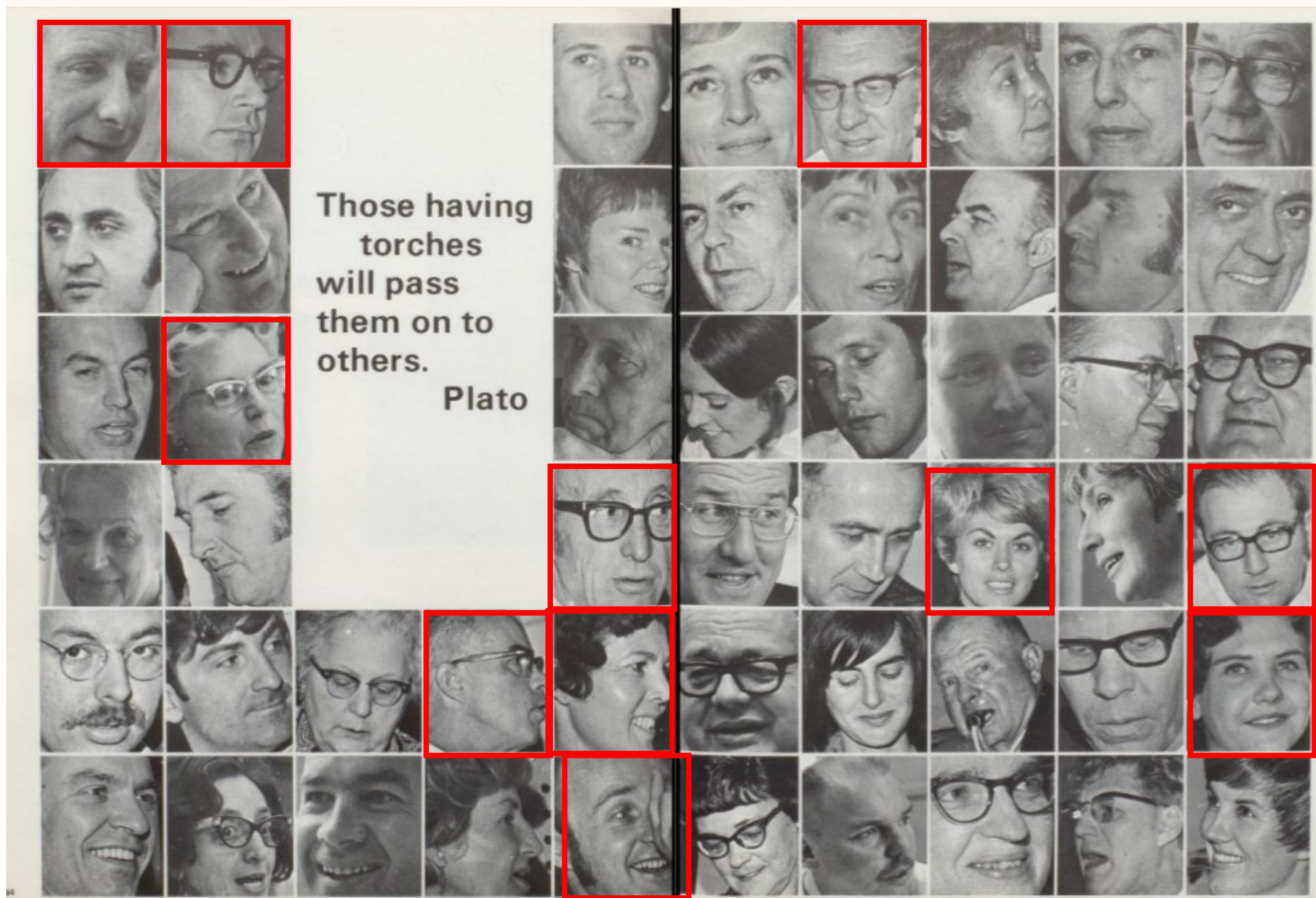




SPL Yearbooks North Central 1972

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1972/mode/2up>





Those having
torches
will pass
them on to
others.
Plato



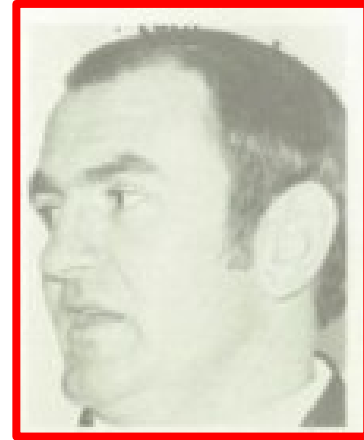
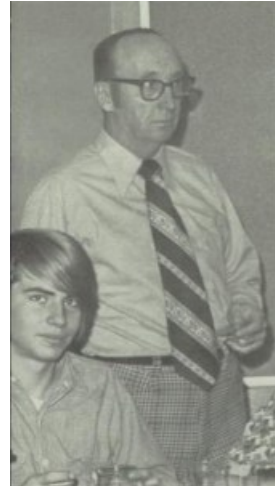
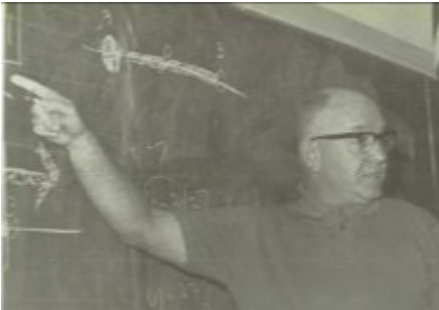
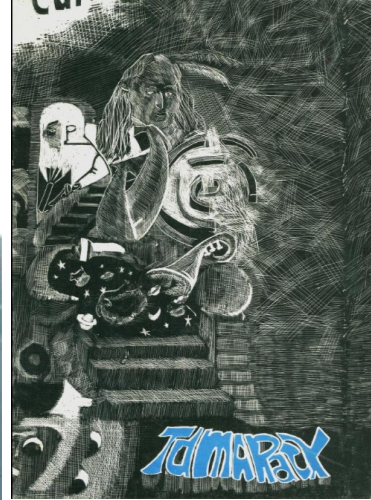
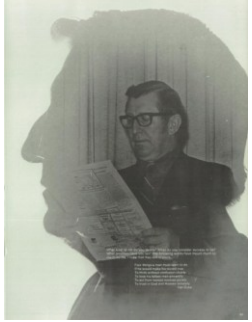
<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1972/mode/2up>

**Can you find familiar
faces in the crowd?
Any I missed?**

Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1973

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1973/page/n105/mode/2u>



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?



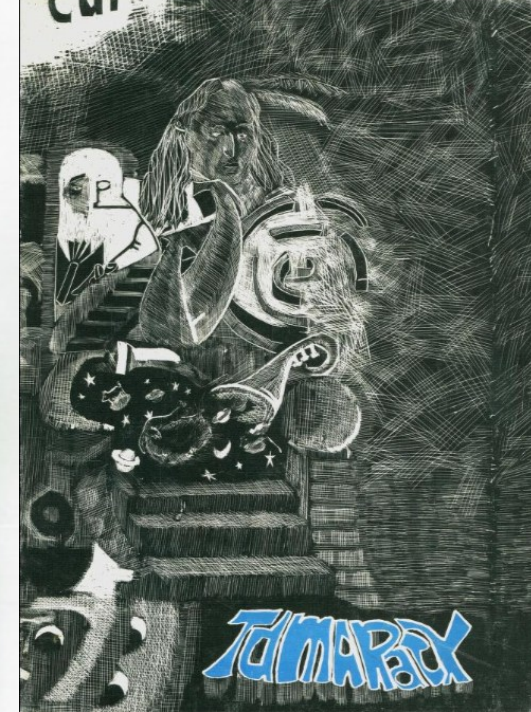
Black Sabbath - Iron Man

Theme song: “Iron Man” by Black Sabbath

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fKbvkUtvFzk&list=RDfKbvkUtvFzk&start_radio=1



"We have a saying which characterizes our team's efforts this past season. 'Rejoice in our hardships for hardships produce endurance and endurance produces character and character produces Hope and Hope does not disappoint us.' —Jim Upchurch



2.V. and "B" liquid needles are 2000m row, left to right: Robert Jorloff, M. Meier, Ben Robinson, Lance Reid, Steve Hargreaves, Don York, Paul Co. Mark Kowarsky, Joe Thompson, Larry Givens, Joe Brown, Top row: manager Dr. Jorloff, Ted DeWitt, Joe Thompson, Kevin Zwick, Pam Shaw, Mark H. Hargreaves, Joe Schuler, Mark Thompson, Brad Brundage, Doug Gumbert, B. Simmons, Dave Hargreaves, and Gerald Brundage. Not pictured are: Mike Perry, Henry Frank, Raul, Joe Hargreaves, Ben Robinson, and Don York.



Guest speakers are: Greg Whigg, Terry Burford, Steve Knight, Ross Gibb, Gary Cohen, Jane Rensing, Fred Morrison, Jan Tomerka, Keith App, Doreen Larkin.



Enthusiastic Crowds Gather To See Wrestling Thrills

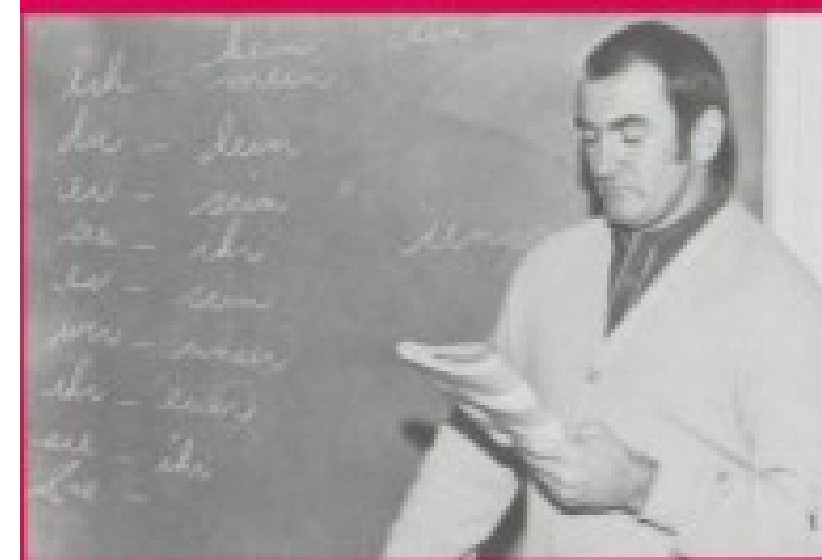


Miguel Brown, Larry Bush, Rob Pappier, manager Tim Wink, manager Steve Dineen, Jim Lippert, Pat Pickett, Jim Smith, Mike West, Tim Yablonski, Ray Elliott, and Scott Marshall.



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

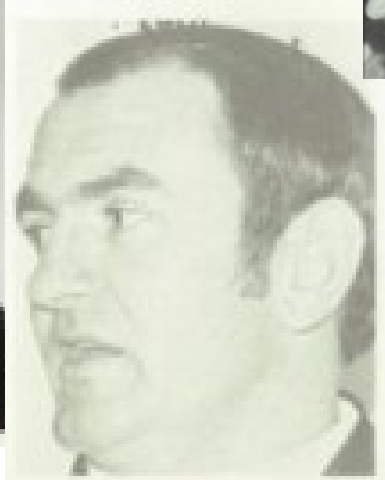
1974 Tamarack



1976 Tamarack



**1973
Tamarack**



1975 Tamarack



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

Age 37 in 1976 (NC Class of 1957)

Michael WEIR Obituary

Michael (Mike) Weir was born February 20, 1939, to Ralph and Mary Weir in [Spokane, WA](#), and passed away on February 9, 2023, at the age of 83 from complications of surgery/septic shock. He was raised in Spokane and graduated from North Central High School in 1957. After high school, he served in the Army playing football and was stationed in Germany. Upon returning home to Spokane, he was a heavy machine operator on construction projects. He later went to college on the GI Bill and got his teaching degree from Eastern Washington University and his master's degree from Whitworth University. He had a long career teaching German and English at North Central High School as well as coaching many kids in football, wrestling, and softball. He had a positive influence on so many high schoolers who would stop him as adults and share the impact he made on them. He spent his summers off from teaching by working at Murphy Brothers and Inland Asphalt and was excellent and skilled at operating heavy machinery for road construction projects. In addition to these jobs, he was also an administrator for night school for continuing education for adults. He retired from teaching in 1997.

He married Sharon (Holt) in 1965 and they celebrated 57 years of marriage before her death last March. They had two daughters, Teri and Molly. Mike was a hardworking family man who enjoyed many hobbies and pursuits. He loved restoring classic cars into beautiful showpieces. Through the years he enjoyed snow skiing, hunting, racquetball, golf, working out, watching all the sports, and keeping his yard and cars immaculate. After retirement, he became a master woodworker and built many beautiful things that we will always treasure. It felt like there wasn't anything he couldn't do or fix or build.

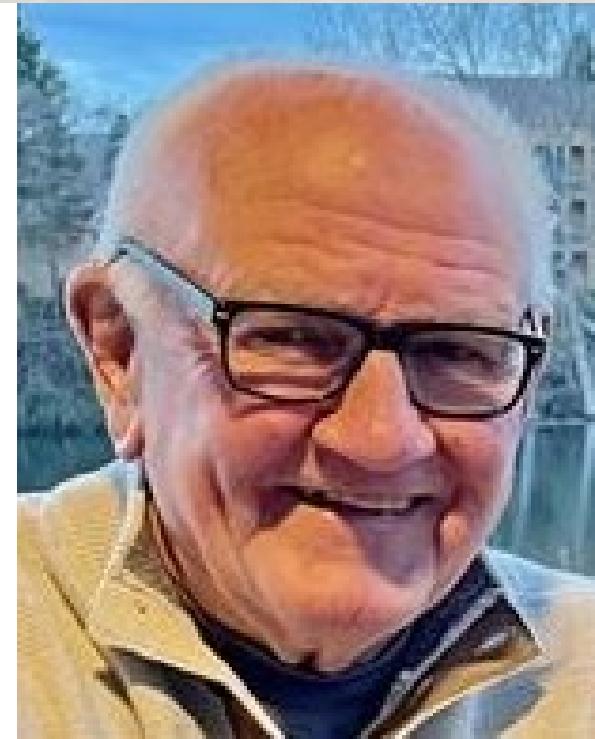
It was so fun to see Mike as a Papa and he had a very special relationship with each of his grandchildren. He could be seen at many a dance recital, baseball game, cheer competition, school program, Hoopfest, football game, and all the other things his grandkids were involved in. So many of his grandkids' friends also called him Papa, and he was the fun grandpa who would bring treats and support all the kids. Mike truly had a heart of service and would do anything for his family and friends. He was constantly helping others with home, yard, and car repairs, driving friends to the airport, shoveling driveways for neighbors, and just being available for anyone who needed help. He was the hardest-working man we knew. He was gracious and appreciative and the kind of man that had so many friends that you couldn't go anywhere without him running into people he knew. He loved the Lord and was a lifelong Christian who attended mass regularly and was always interested in others and how he could pray for them.

Mike is survived by his two daughters and their families who adored him: Teri (Fulton) and husband Bob and their kids Courtney and Blake; and Molly (Bergan) and her husband Jason and their kids Abby, Luke, and Lexi. He is also survived by his siblings Mary Ann Scott, Judy Lennemann, and Ralph Weir. He is preceded in death by his wife of 57 years: Sharon Weir. He is also preceded in death by his siblings Joy Ruple and Larry Weir.

Please join us for a Funeral Mass at The Cathedral of Our Lady of Lourdes on Friday, March 3, 2023, at 10 am: 1115 West Riverside, [Spokane, WA](#), 99201. There will be a celebration of life reception at the church afterward. Please consider making a donation to Joya Child & Family Development, 1016 N Superior St, [Spokane, WA](#) 99202, in Mike's name for his granddaughter Lexi Bergan. Mike's online memorial page can be found at www.holycrossofspokane.org.

To plant trees in memory, please visit the [Sympathy Store](#).

Published by Spokesman-Review from Feb. 16 to Mar. 15, 2023.



Grandpa Coach Weir

Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

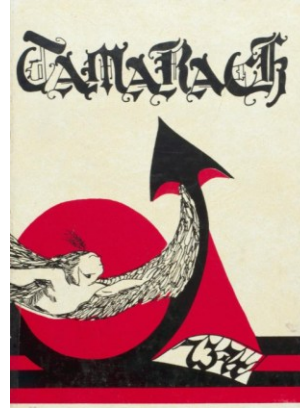
Coach Weir Bio

Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

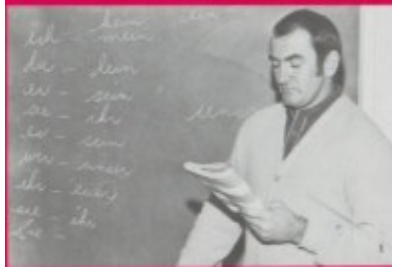
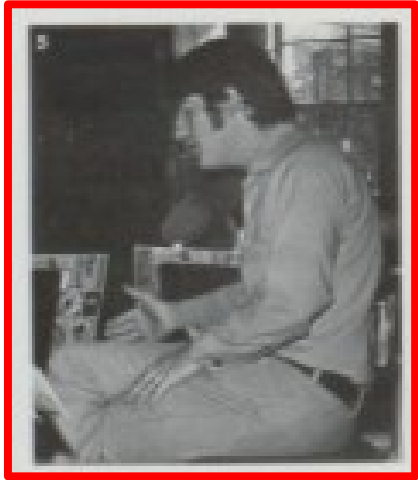
Coach Weir Anecdotes

Who met his future wife
in the All-City Band?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1974



<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1974/page/n47/mode/2up>



Who met his future wife in the All-City Band?



Theme song: "Old Days" by Chicago

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fKbvkUtvFzk&list=RDfKbvkUtvFzk&start_radio=1



Who met his future wife in the All-City Band?

A 2023 *Spokesman-Review* feature identifies **John Luppert** and **Nan Comeaux Luppert** as former Sacajawea Middle School music students from the school's first year, 1960. John said he originally attended Irving Elementary but wanted to attend Sacajawea because choir teacher Richard "Dick" Skok was becoming band director there. He and Nan met in the All-City band clarinet section, later attended Lewis and Clark High School, and married in 1968. ([Spokesman-Review](#))

The same article says both John and Nan graduated from **Eastern Washington University** with education degrees. Nan used music in teaching Spanish, French, and English for 17 years. John **taught band and orchestra for 11 years** before moving into another career, but he remained active musically as an early member of the **Spokane Jazz Society**, now the Spokane Jazz Orchestra, for about **25 years**. ([Spokesman-Review](#))

The North Central yearbook trail supports his NC role. The 1975 *Tamarack* OCR includes **John Luppert**, matching your attached 1975 image, and the 1976 *Tamarack* OCR includes **"Band Photos — John Luppert"** in the music/yearbook context. ([Internet Archive](#))

A slide-ready caption:

John Luppert — Band & Orchestra

North Central High School band/orchestra teacher in the mid-1970s. A Spokane music student himself, he attended Sacajawea Middle School in its first year, met his future wife Nan Comeaux in the All-City band clarinet section, and later earned an education degree from Eastern Washington University. He taught band and orchestra for 11 years, including at North Central, then moved into another career while remaining active in Spokane music as an early Spokane Jazz Society / Spokane Jazz Orchestra member for about 25 years.

Short version:

John Luppert — Instrumental Music

NC band/orchestra teacher, Eastern Washington University education graduate, Sacajawea music alumnus, and longtime Spokane Jazz Society / Spokane Jazz Orchestra musician.

Theme song: "Old Days" by Chicago
Recorded in 1975.

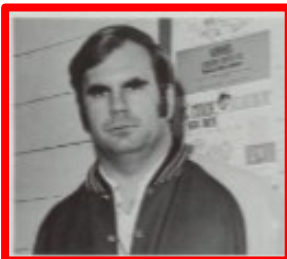
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pmz6BqBsk9w&list=RDPmz6BqBsk9w&start_radio=1
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pmz6BqBsk9w&list=RDPmz6BqBsk9w&start_radio=1



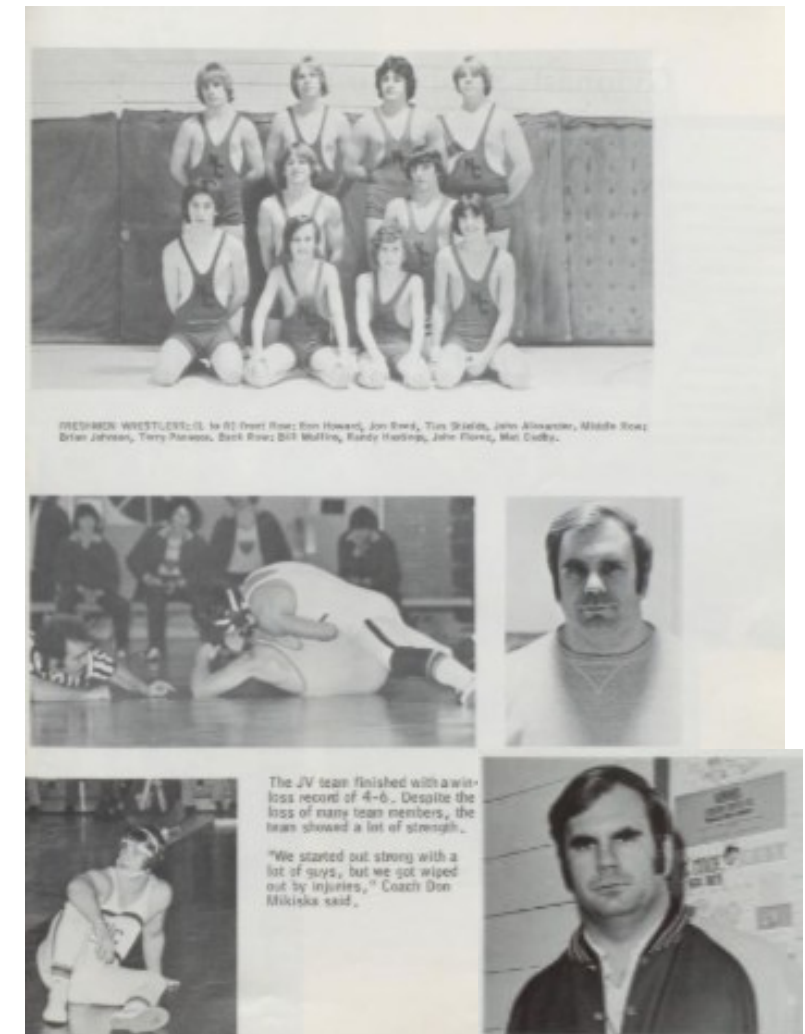
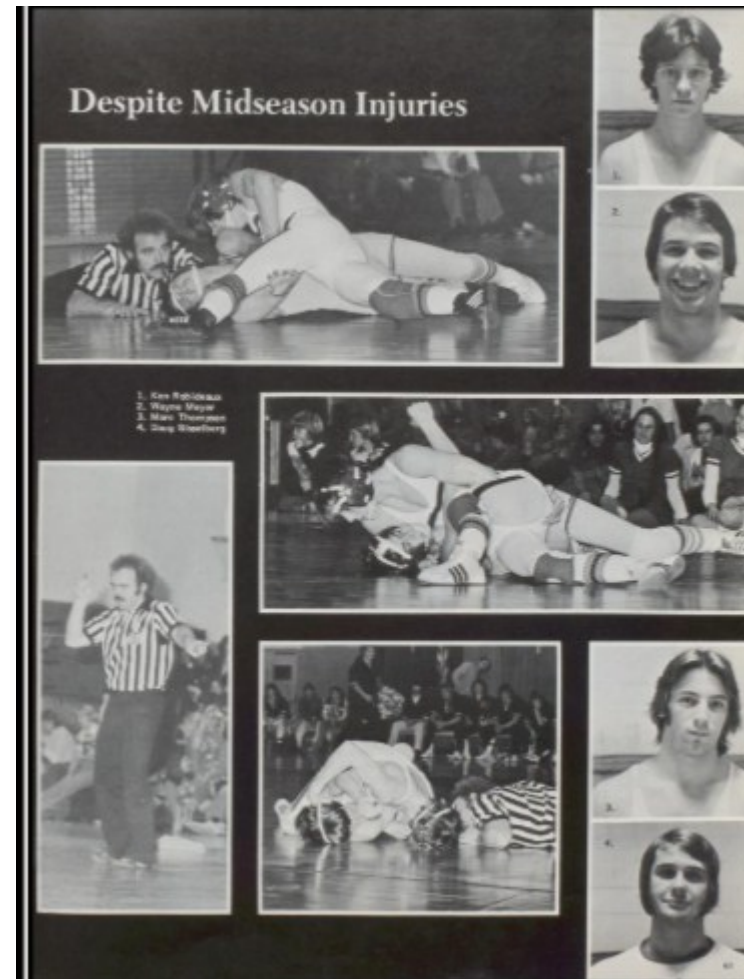
Who coached wrestling at
Othello and Ferris as well as
NC, and coached AA Othello to
a state championship?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1975

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1975/mode/2up>



Who coached wrestling at Othello and Ferris as well as NC, and coached AA Othello to a state championship?



I remember pressing on and being pressed from below by JV wrestlers looking to take my weight class

Theme song: "Pick up the Pieces" by The Average White Band

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xpflST8xWm8&list=RDxpflST8xWm8&start_radio=1

Who coached wrestling at Othello and Ferris as well as NC, and coached AA Othello to a state championship?

Deceased Classmate: Mikiska, Don (Teacher)

Date Of Birth:

Date Deceased: 5-2004

Age at Death: 59

Cause of Death:

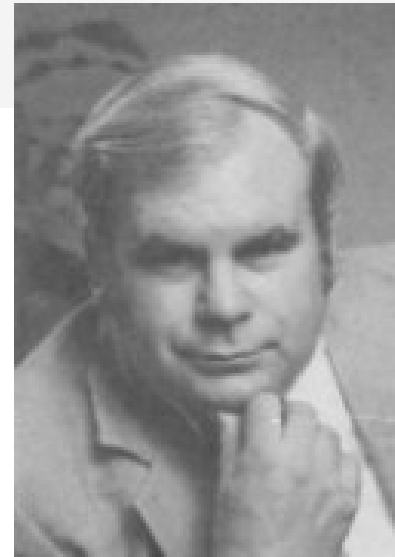
Classmate City: Spokane

Classmate State: WA

Classmate Country: USA

Was a Veteran: No

https://www.classcreator.com/Spokane-Washington-Joel-E-Ferris-1963-2016/class_profile.cfm?member_id=5002215&utm_source=chatgpt.com



Joel E Ferris High School Classes of 1966 - Present

Ferris is using “classcreator” software www.classcreator.com



24,357 Classes now online!

Featured Class Sites

Coach Mikiska's first year at NC was 1975

Survived By: His wife died in 2001. Survivors include two sons, Bob and Mike Mikiska; his companion, Marcia, and her two daughters, Jenny and Laura; and four grandchildren.

Donald V.E. Mikiska, 59, who was born in San Jose, Calif., died Tuesday. He graduated from Whitworth College in 1967 with a degree in social studies and received his Master of Arts degree in teaching the following year. Mr. Mikiska taught in Washington for 31 years, the last 26 in Spokane, mostly at Ferris High School. While the wrestling coach in Othello, Wash., he was named Washington's Coach of the Year for AA schools in 1970. He led the school to a state championship in 1974. He married Christine Castle in 1975, and the couple made their home in Spokane. Mr. Mikiska enjoyed the outdoors, hunting and fishing and was involved at Fourth Memorial Bible Church. Published on 5/17/2004

1976: The Bicentennial, Student Autonomy, and Social Shift

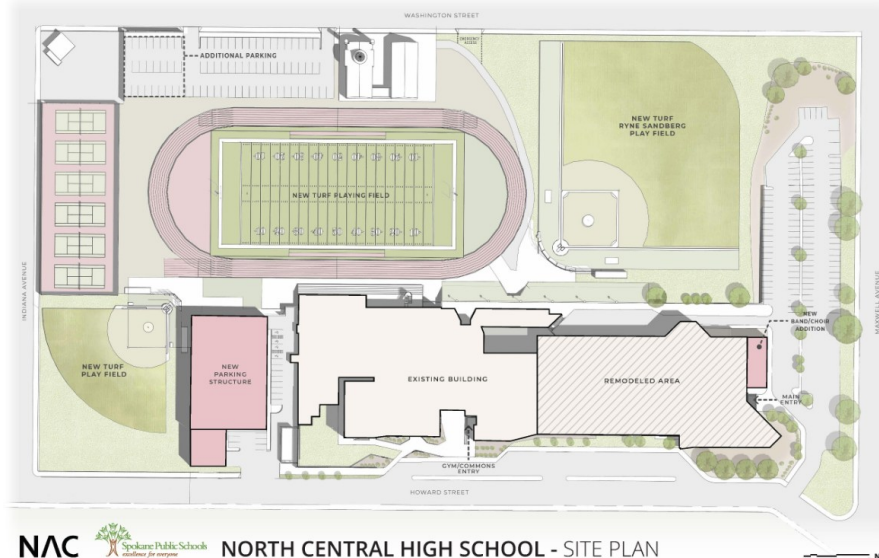
The year of your graduation—1976—marked the **U.S. Bicentennial** and arrived on the heels of massive social upheavals, including the Vietnam War, the Civil Rights Movement, and Title IX (passed in 1972).

- The Educational Philosophy:** The rigid structures of the 1950s gave way to student-centered learning, elective-heavy curricula, and a massive push for gender equity in sports and academics.

- The Environment:** The atmosphere at NC was alive with the expressive, independent energy of the 1970s. Students exercised a level of political autonomy and social awareness unseen in previous generations—even mirroring real-world complexities, such as the [historic student body election controversy](https://www.togetherspokane.org/nc-modernization) that rocked the school in May 1976 over active campaigning and registry irregularities.

This era marked the final years of the fabled original building, which was razed shortly after in 1981 to make way for a more functional, modern facility.

<https://www.togetherspokane.org/nc-modernization>



NAC Spokane Public Schools NORTH CENTRAL HIGH SCHOOL - SITE PLAN

Spotlight on Youth

Election scandal shakes NC student government

North Central High School students became embroiled in their "own little Watergate" last week in connection with student government elections.

An extremely close race between Juniors Wayne Larson and Bret Coffin for fall term Associated Student Body president in the May 13 general election has been protested due to "glaring irregularities" in the polling procedures, NC principal John P. Rodkey said.

Running tallies of each candidate's progress were kept and several candidates were actively campaigning in the polling area as the tallies showed they were dropping behind their opponents, Rodkey explained.

Students passing out ballots and checking to see if students were properly registered to vote were accused of telling unsure voters whom to vote for and towards the end of election day, were even giving out unsolicited advice to voting students, ASB faculty adviser Dean Rieken said.

"The students aren't really responsible for this though," Rieken said last week. "Mr. Rodkey and myself had ultimate responsibility for supervising the election."

"I should have impressed upon them (the students manning polling stations) the seriousness of their task. Out in the real world, people can be arrested for some of the things that were done here," Rieken said.

"We learned one thing for sure. You have to make stu-

dent elections as realistic as possible. It's serious business. They'll be adults soon," he added.

In discussions about the election confusion, a few students recalled that the "dirty campaign tricks planned by people like (attorney Donald) Segretti during Nixon's campaign were no worse than the things they did in their college elections."

The day after the election in question, Rodkey called a meeting of the students' election planning committee to review the protests and decide whether or not to have a re-election.

Some committee members argued that there was no concrete evidence that the running tally which was kept affected the outcome of the election, even though one of the presidential candidates, Coffin, was away from school at a tennis match and couldn't campaign during the election hours.

Those against the re-election also said it would be "politically damaging" to both candidates and to the system, and suggested the results be accepted and stringent polling rules be drawn up for next year, Rieken said.

Those in favor of a re-election insisted that whether or not the outcome of the election is different or not, the vote was unfair and should, morally, be repeated, Rieken said.

After lengthy discussion in which Rodkey and Rieken participated, the committee voted against a re-election.

"But by Monday, it was obvious to me that this was just not going to die away and be forgotten. That there had been unfairness had been established and something had to be done," Rodkey said last week.

So Rodkey set aside the vote of the elections' committee, despite its protests that he had originally promised to abide by the committee's decision.

The current ASB officers, who voted in favor of a re-election as members of the elections' committee, were appointed by Rodkey to make a final decision on the situation.

"They are the elected representatives of the students and as such should be my adviser as to the best interests of the students in a case like this," Rodkey explained.

"We should have called the elections' committee together merely as an advisory body, and then Mr. Rodkey could've made the decision himself," Rieken said. "Many students are upset about the way this was handled."

And so, a re-election was held Friday for the office of ASB president only, as the other ASB offices had been decisively decided in the first election.

Coffin won the Friday election, supervised by Rodkey, by a vote of 281 to 200, student elections committee chairman Bernie McBride said. (Larson won the first general election by 18 votes.)

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/may/23/this-day-in-history-north-central-high-school-rock/>

So this is how history remembers us ...

"The students aren't really responsible for this though ..." - Mr. Rieken takes the hit

[Name,Birth,NC Start, NCEnd,Death,Department]

Sorted by NC Start Year

This is a sparse “point cloud” in a 5-dimensional space.

One dimension is identity = Teacher.

The next 4 are integer years,

and the final is a text description of Department (and primary scope); a vector in meaning space for an AI LLM Large Language Model.

Teacher	Birth	NC Start	NC End	Death	Department
John P. Rodkey	1921	1948	1979	2012	Principal
Burrill Dean Exley	1923	1950	1978	1997	Math
Raymond Simonson	1929	1954	>1976	NA	Science, Biology, Chemistry
Orval N. P. Theisen	1916	1955	>1976	2007	Science, Physics
Norman W. Erickson	1917	1956	1979	1999	Business
William Nye	>1926	1956	>1976	NA	Math
Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe	1917	1957	>1976	1999	English, Latin
Jerry Hopkins	1938	1965	1996	NA	Social Studies, Economics
Dorothy Murray	1921	1965	>1976	2004	English, Drama
Michael W. Caldwell	1939	1966	>1997	2018	Music: Choir, Singing
Joe Schauble	1934	1967	1996	2024	Math
Yvonne Carter	1931	1968	1986	2011	English, Humanities
George Chalich	1930	1968	>1976	2017	Social Studies, US History
Lynette McGarry	1939	1968	>1976	2009	Foreign Languages, Spanish
Gerry Hughes	1944	1970	1978	2022	Social Studies
Dean Rieken	1940	1970	>1976	NA	English, Writing
Mary Haugen	>1948	1970	>1976	NA	English, Literature
Mike Weir	1939	1970	>1976	2023	Foreign Languages, German
Donald Makiska	1945	1975	>1976	2004	Physical Education
John Luppert	1948	1975	>1976	NA	Music: Band, Orchestra

THIS IS A BURRILL DEAL EXLEY MEMORIAL SLIDE

[Name,Birth,NC Start,
NCEnd,Death,Department]

Sorted by Department

This is a sparse
“point cloud” in a
5-dimensional
space.

One dimension is
identity =
Teacher.

The next 4 are
integer years,

and the final is a
text description
of Department
(and primary
scope); a vector
in meaning space
for an AI LLM
Large Language
Model.

Teacher	Birth	NC Start	NC End	Death	Department
Norman W. Erickson	1917	1956	1979	1999	Business
Dorothy Murray	1921	1965	>1976	2004	English, Drama
Yvonne Carter	1931	1968	1986	2011	English, Humanities
Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe	1917	1957	>1976	1999	English, Latin
Mary Haugen	>1948	1970	>1976	NA	English, Literature
Dean Rieken	1940	1970	>1976	NA	English, Writing
Mike Weir	1939	1970	>1976	2023	Foreign Languages, German
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Burrill Dean Exley	1923	1950	1978	1997	Math
Joe Schauble	1934	1967	1996	2024	Math
William Nye	>1926	1956	>1976	NA	Math
John Luppert	1948	1975	>1976	NA	Music: Band, Orchestra
Michael W. Caldwell	1939	1966	>1997	2018	Music: Choir, Singing
Donald Makiska	1945	1975	>1976	2004	Physical Education
John P. Rodkey	1921	1948	1979	2012	Principal
Raymond Simonson	1929	1954	>1976	NA	Science, Biology, Chemistry
Orval N. P. Theisen	1916	1955	>1976	2007	Science, Physics
Gerry Hughes	1944	1970	1978	2022	Social Studies
Jerry Hopkins	1938	1965	1996	NA	Social Studies, Economics
George Chalich	1930	1968	>1976	2017	Social Studies, US History

THIS IS A BURRILL DEAL EXLEY MEMORIAL SLIDE

[Name,Birth,NC Start,
NCEnd,Death,Department]

Sorted by Year of Birth

This is a sparse
“point cloud” in a
5-dimensional
space.

One dimension is
identity =
Teacher.

The next 4 are
integer years,

and the final is a
text description
of Department
(and primary
scope); a vector
in meaning space
for an AI LLM
Large Language
Model.

Teacher	Birth	NC Start	NC End	Death	Department
Orval N. P. Theisen	1916	1955	>1976	2007	Science, Physics
Norman W. Erickson	1917	1956	1979	1999	Business
Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe	1917	1957	>1976	1999	English, Latin
John P. Rodkey	1921	1948	1979	2012	Principal
Dorothy Murray	1921	1965	>1976	2004	English, Drama
Burrill Dean Exley	1923	1950	1978	1997	Math
William Nye	>1926	1956	>1976	NA	Math
Raymond Simonson	1929	1954	>1976	NA	Science, Biology, Chemistry
George Chalich	1930	1968	>1976	2017	Social Studies, US History
Yvonne Carter	1931	1968	1986	2011	English, Humanities
Joe Schauble	1934	1967	1996	2024	Math
Jerry Hopkins	1938	1965	1996	NA	Social Studies, Economics
Michael W. Caldwell	1939	1966	>1997	2018	Music: Choir, Singing
Lynette McGarry	1939	1968	>1976	2009	Foreign Languages, Spanish
Mike Weir	1939	1970	>1976	2023	Foreign Languages, German
Dean Rieken	1940	1970	>1976	NA	English, Writing
Gerry Hughes	1944	1970	1978	2022	Social Studies
Donald Makiska	1945	1975	>1976	2004	Physical Education
Mary Haugen	>1948	1970	>1976	NA	English, Literature
John Luppert	1948	1975	>1976	NA	Music: Band, Orchestra

THIS IS A BURRILL DEAN EXLEY MEMORIAL SLIDE

[Name,Birth,NC Start,
NCEnd,Death,Department]

Sorted by Year of Death

This is a sparse
“point cloud” in a
5-dimensional
space.

One dimension is
identity =
Teacher.

The next 4 are
integer years,

and the final is a
text description
of Department
(and primary
scope); a vector
in meaning space
for an AI LLM
Large Language
Model.

Teacher	Birth	NC Start	NC End	Death	Department
Burrill Dean Exley	1923	1950	1978	1997	Math
Norman W. Erickson	1917	1956	1979	1999	Business
Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe	1917	1957	>1976	1999	English, Latin
Dorothy Murray	1921	1965	>1976	2004	English, Drama
Donald Makiska	1945	1975	>1976	2004	Physical Education
Orval N. P. Theisen	1916	1955	>1976	2007	Science, Physics
Lynette McGarry	1939	1968	>1976	2009	Foreign Languages, Spanish
Yvonne Carter	1931	1968	1986	2011	English, Humanities
John P. Rodkey	1921	1948	1979	2012	Principal
George Chalich	1930	1968	>1976	2017	Social Studies, US History
Michael W. Caldwell	1939	1966	>1997	2018	Music: Choir, Singing
Gerry Hughes	1944	1970	1978	2022	Social Studies
Mike Weir	1939	1970	>1976	2023	Foreign Languages, German
Joe Schauble	1934	1967	1996	2024	Math
Raymond Simonson	1929	1954	>1976	NA	Science, Biology, Chemistry
William Nye	>1926	1956	>1976	NA	Math
Jerry Hopkins	1938	1965	1996	NA	Social Studies, Economics
Dean Rieken	1940	1970	>1976	NA	English, Writing
John Luppert	1948	1975	>1976	NA	Music: Band, Orchestra
Mary Haugen	>1948	1970	>1976	NA	English, Literature

THIS IS A BURRILL DEAN EXLEY MEMORIAL SLIDE

[Name,Birth,NC Start, NCEnd,Death,Age at Death, Department]

Sorted by Age at Death

This is a sparse “point cloud” in a 6-dimensional space.

One dimension is identity = Teacher.

The next 4 are integer years,

Age at Death is a derived integer dimension which is not fundamental

and the final is a text description of Department (and primary scope); a vector in meaning space for an AI LLM Large Language Model.

Teacher	Birth	NC Start	NC End	Death	Age at Death	Department
Donald Makiska	1945	1975	>1976	2004	59	Physical Education
Lynette McGarry	1939	1968	>1976	2009	70	Foreign Languages, Spanish
Burrill Dean Exley	1923	1950	1978	1997	74	Math
Gerry Hughes	1944	1970	1978	2022	78	Social Studies
Michael W. Caldwell	1939	1966	>1997	2018	79	Music: Choir, Singing
Yvonne Carter	1931	1968	1986	2011	80	English, Humanities
Norman W. Erickson	1917	1956	1979	1999	82	Business
Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe	1917	1957	>1976	1999	82	English, Latin
Dorothy Murray	1921	1965	>1976	2004	83	English, Drama
Mike Weir	1939	1970	>1976	2023	84	Foreign Languages, German
George Chalich	1930	1968	>1976	2017	87	Social Studies, US History
Joe Schauble	1934	1967	1996	2024	90	Math
Orval N. P. Theisen	1916	1955	>1976	2007	91	Science, Physics
John P. Rodkey	1921	1948	1979	2012	91	Principal
William Nye	>1926	1956	>1976	NA	Would be <100	Math
Raymond Simonson	1929	1954	>1976	NA	Would be 97	Science, Biology, Chemistry
Jerry Hopkins	1938	1965	1996	NA	Would be 88	Social Studies, Economics
Dean Rieken	1940	1970	>1976	NA	Would be 86	English, Writing
John Luppert	1948	1975	>1976	NA	Would be 78	Music: Band, Orchestra
Mary Haugen	>1948	1970	>1976	NA	Would be <78	English, Literature

THIS IS A BURRILL DEAN EXLEY MEMORIAL SLIDE

Mathematically, diversity is not just good, it is essential...

The Geometry of Meaning: From Linear Algebra to LLMs and Social Systems

Slide 1: Technical Foundation (Math & AI)

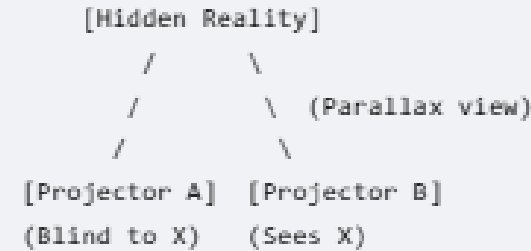
Physical & Mathematical Space

- **Vectors & Distance:** Data exists as points in space. Distance measures how different two points are.
- **Projection & Components:** Decomposing a vector into parallel (shared) and perpendicular (unique) components.
- **4D Homogeneous Coordinates:** Adding a dimension (w-scale) to 3D data. This creates a pinhole effect, allowing perspective projection along specific axes.

LLM "Conception Space" Analogs

- **Summary (Simplification):** Projecting a high-dimensional concept down to a lower-dimensional subspace. This retains the main parallel direction while discarding perpendicular noise.
- **Translation:** Mapping vectors between different language regions within the same semantic space. This aligns their parallel meaning components.
- **Cultural Bias:** A systemic shift where the projection axis favors one cultural viewpoint, squashing or erasing nuances perpendicular to that axis.

Slide 2: The Blindness & Diversity Argument



The Blindness of a Single Projector

Every single mathematical projector is completely blind along its own projection axis. Information moving directly along that line is flattened and lost.

The Diversity & Parallax Solution

- **Multi-View Recovery:** No single perspective can capture the full high-dimensional truth.
- **Parallax Advantage:** By combining multiple, diverse projectors, what is blind to one is visible to another.
- **Systemic Health:** True structural depth is only recovered through the intersection of different, non-parallel viewpoints.

THIS IS A WILLIAM NYE MEMORIAL SLIDE (whether he's still around or not)

Mathematically, diversity is not just good, it is essential...

Slide 3: Generalization to Social Systems & Teams

The Technocratic & Meritocratic Flaw

Technocratic systems often treat merit as a single, linear projection axis. This makes the system entirely blind to human value, effort, and context that lie perpendicular to that specific metric.

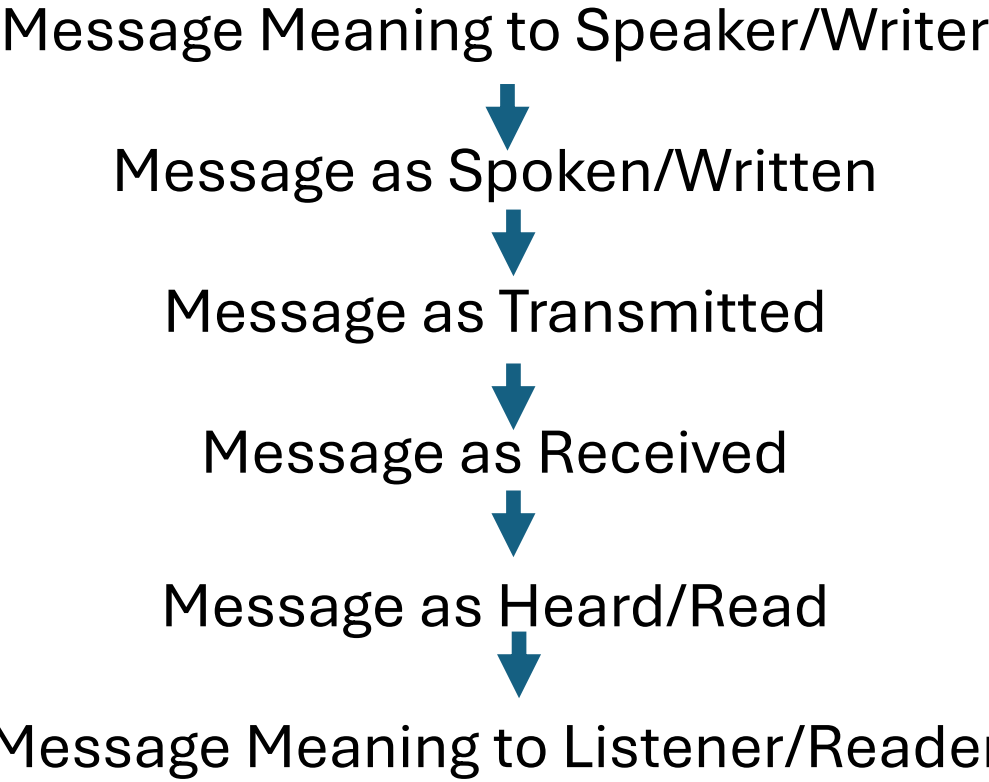
Communication & Motor Models

- World-Model Projection (Communication Channel):** Using empathy to project another agent's perceived ideas into your own space. This reconstructs their internal model despite channel noise.
- Intention Projection (Motor Action Model):** Projecting another agent's perceived intentions to understand how they plan to act on the real world.

Coherent Effort Through Sympathy

Coherent team action does not require absolute uniformity. It requires shared parallel alignment on goals, combined with enough diverse, empathetic parallax to cover each other's structural blind spots.

Communication in Information Theory



NC Language Arts Perspectives: Senior Lit & Senior Comp

The linear flow on the left represents the [Shannon-Weaver communication model](#). In our North Central High School curriculum, we can learn to examine how the "channel" is never completely clean. It is constantly shifted by perspective, culture, and technology. [1, 2, 3]

- Senior Comp (The Writer's Perspective):** "Message Meaning to Speaker/Writer" requires deliberate choices before the first word is ever transmitted. Students learn to manage their **intention, tone, voice, and target audience**. They must actively recognize how their own **worldviews and subconscious biases** shape the text. [2]
- Senior Lit (The Reader's Perspective):** "Message Meaning to Listener/Reader" introduces critical interpretation. Literary analysis relies on evaluating the **author's presumed historical bias** against the **reader's modern perspective**.
- Channel Modulation:** The transmission space between text and reception allows for heavy modulation. Translation, shifts in tone, stylistic complexity, and the reader's prior knowledge all change how a message is decoded.

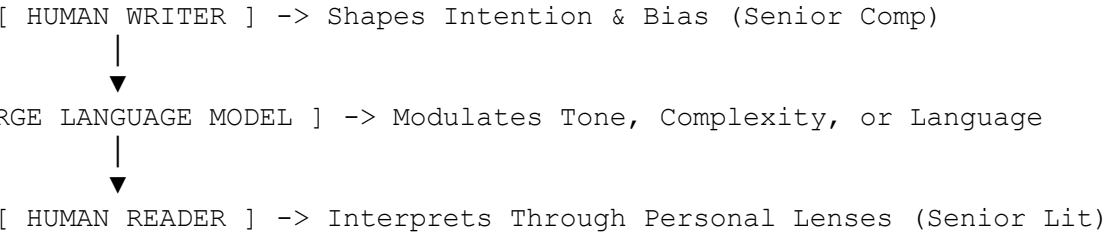
In 2026, [Large Language Models \(LLMs\)](#) act directly as artificial modulators inside this communication channel. They fundamentally alter the Shannon-Weaver framework by stepping into the middle of human-to-human transmission: [1, 4, 5]

- Algorithmic Encoding & Bias:** LLMs do not possess human "intention" or an active "worldview". Instead, they operate on mathematical probabilities trained on massive collections of human data. This text base injects its own deep layer of cultural and systemic background into the message. [4, 5, 6]
- Dynamic Channel Modulation:** AI acts as a fluid linguistic translator. A user can prompt an LLM to take an original meaning and instantaneously adjust the voice, modulate the complexity, or simplify the text for different audiences. [7]
- The Semantic Gap:** While an LLM perfectly processes the statistical transmission of symbols across a channel, it lacks conscious understanding. True "meaning" still rests entirely on both ends of the slide—the human sender's initial objective and the final human reader's critical interpretation. [4, 8]

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org>
- [2] <https://www.personio.com>
- [3] <https://www.vaia.com>
- [4] <https://papers.ssrn.com>
- [5] <https://www.splunk.com>
- [6] <https://papers.ssrn.com>
- [7] <https://www.mdpi.com>
- [8] <https://thecynfin.co>

**Language Arts,
AI Large Language Models,
and High School Education in 2026**

2026 Reference: AI & LLM Models in Communication



THIS IS A MARY HAUGEN MEMORIAL SLIDE (whether she's still around or not)

The Epistemological Divide: Math, Science, and Human Action

This slide framework contrasts the absolute certainty of pure logic with the messy, empirical reality of the natural world, linking both to how humans make moral choices.

1. Mathematics: The Domain of Absolute Certainty

- Pure Mathematics:** Operates entirely independent of context. Truth is established through **theorems** and **proof by logical equivalence** ($A \equiv B$). Once a mathematical statement is proven using strict deductive logic, it is universally and eternally true. It does not require real-world testing.
- Applied Mathematics:** Steps into the messy real world to clarify analysis and procedures. It deals in **signal-to-noise ratios, likelihoods, and inference in the presence of uncertainty**. It provides the formal framework to reason clearly when data is incomplete.

2. The Sciences: The Domain of Empirical Testing

- Pure Natural Science:** Spans from fundamental forces (**Physics**), molecular Interactions (**Chemistry**), and living systems (**Biology**) to deep-time systems (**Geology** and **Astronomy**). Unlike math, the **ultimate arbiter of truth is the comparison of experiment with theory**.
- The Element of Chance:** In historical sciences like evolutionary biology or geology, random chance plays a massive role. Because of this, scientific analysis and expectation are always **approximate**, leaving room for revision as new evidence emerges.
- Applied Science:** Fields like **Medicine** and **Diagnostic Imaging** bring these approximations to life. They use scientific theory for urgent, practical purposes, forcing professionals to act effectively despite imperfect data.

THE ARBITERS OF TRUTH	
MATHEMATICS (Logic & Equivalence)	SCIENCES (Empirical Observation)
PURE: Theorems & Proofs $A \equiv B$ (Context-Free)	PURE: Physics, Chem, Bio Theory vs. Experiment
APPLIED: Signal & Noise Inference & Likelihood	APPLIED: Medicine, Imaging Pragmatic Intervention

3. The Analogy to Human Ethics, Morals, and Action

The divide between math and science mirrors how humans navigate the world:

- Ideology (Pure Math):** Moral frameworks and ideologies operate like pure mathematics. They seek absolute, context-free principles of right and wrong, driven by internal logical consistency.
- Pragmatic Action (Applied Science):** Real-world ethical decision-making operates like applied science and medicine. We must act in the presence of uncertainty, balance "signal with noise," and constantly weigh the real-world consequences of our actions. The ultimate arbiter of an ethical choice is not its theoretical purity, but its actual impact on human lives.

1. Pure Math and Philosophy: Breaking the "Frontier" Barrier

[SCHOLARLY COMMUNICATION & EDUCATION FLOW]

SPECIALIST SCHOLARS	Generates proofs, verifies logic, shifts heavy lifting to conceptual design
GENERAL SCHOLARS/STUDENTS	Translates dense math into step-by-step lemmas, bridging philosophy & syntax
THE BROADER PUBLIC	Visualizes multi-dimensional concepts; strips away hostile jargon entirely

•**For Specialist Scholars (The Breakthroughs):** AI is no longer just checking human work; it is acting as a collaborative co-author. Instead of just running brute-force searches, these networks are generating creative, peer-reviewed mathematical insights. [1, 2, 3, 4]

•**For Philosophy & Theory of Knowledge (ToK):** AI forces us to rethink what "knowledge" actually means. It creates a playground for epistemic philosophy, for exploring the difference between *syntax* (processing symbols) and *semantics* (true conscious understanding).

•**For Students and the Public (The Great Translator):** Math can be incredibly hostile to outsiders due to its notation. AI bridges this gap by functioning as a dynamic channel modulator. It can ingest a dense, multi-syllabic proof and instantly output a clear, interactive visualization or a 4th-grade level breakdown, making elite concepts accessible to everyone.

2. Applied Math: Sifting Signal from Real-World Noise

applied math is where abstract logic collides with physical uncertainty. AI excels here by recognizing massive, hidden patterns inside chaotic data.

- Cracking the Unsolvable (Inverse PDEs):** A spectacular, vivid example you can reference is the recent breakthrough by Penn Engineers. They used an AI method called "Mollifier Layers" to solve **Inverse Partial Differential Equations (PDEs)**. Solving an inverse problem is mathematically brutal—it is like looking at the ripples in a pond and trying to calculate backward to find the exact spot, size, and shape of the pebble that fell. [5]
- Blossoming Near-Term: Smart Supply Logistics & Financial Volatility:** We are rapidly moving toward global, autonomous macro-economic forecasting.

3. Pure and Experimental Sciences: High-Energy Hide and Seek

- Sifting the Subatomic Noise:** At facilities like CERN, detectors record petabytes of data per second from particle collisions. Humans cannot possibly look at it all.
- Simulating the Unknown:** AI is also used to generate synthetic, ultra-precise quantum mechanical simulations.

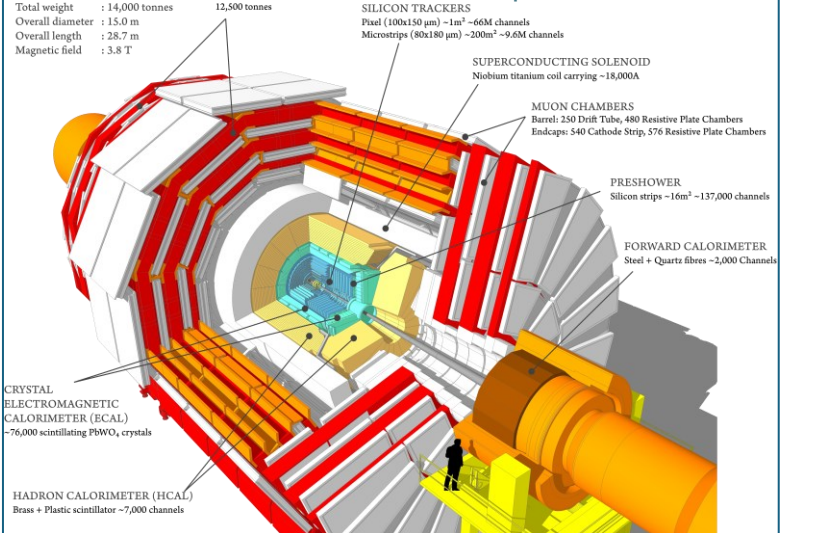
4. Applied Medical Sciences: The Rise of the "Digital Twin"

In nuclear imaging, radiology, and oncology, applied science is transitioning from static snapshots to living, breathing computational replicas. [6, 7, 8]

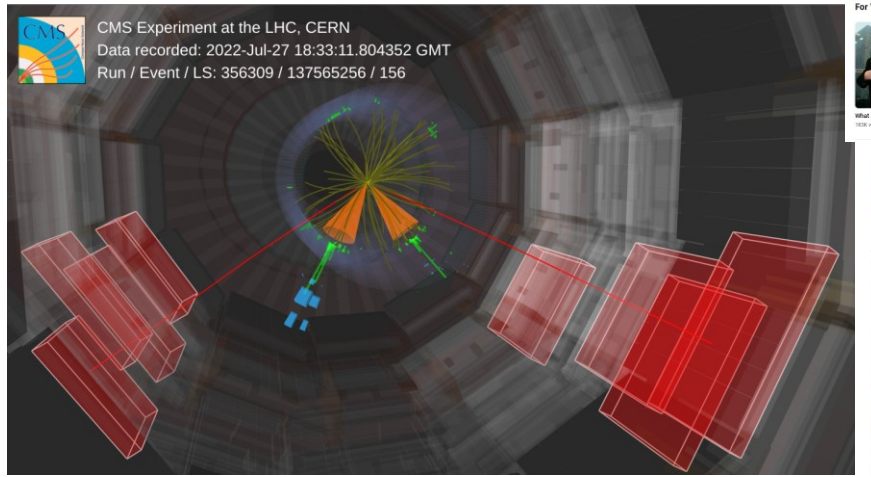
- Multimodality Fusion:** In the past, a radiologist looked at a CT scan for anatomy, and a PET scan for metabolic activity. Today, medical AI platformscan instantly fuse these diverse image streams
- The "Digital Twin" in Radiation Therapy:** This is the absolute cutting edge of applied medical science. Giant healthcare collaborations) are creating **virtual representations of individual patients**. [6, 8, 9]
- How it Works in Practice:** Instead of guessing how a deep-seated tumor might react to a blast of radiation, doctors use a highly complex computational replica of the patient's specific body.. [6, 7, 8, 9, 10]

[1] <https://www.youtube.com>
[2] <https://theaiinnovator.com>
[3] <https://techjacksolutions.com>
[4] <https://www.forbes.com>
[5] <https://www.reddit.com>

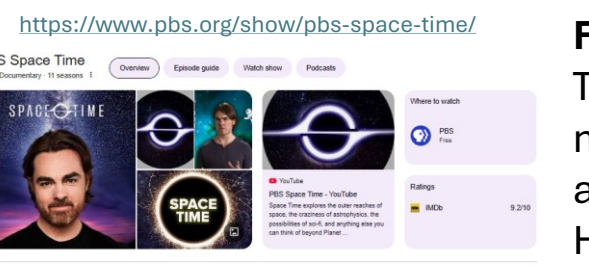
[5] <https://www.reddit.com>
[6] <https://siim.org>
[7] <https://www.pharmacytimes.com>
[8] <https://ir.sophiagenetics.com>
[9] <https://www.fiercebiotech.com>
[10] <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov>



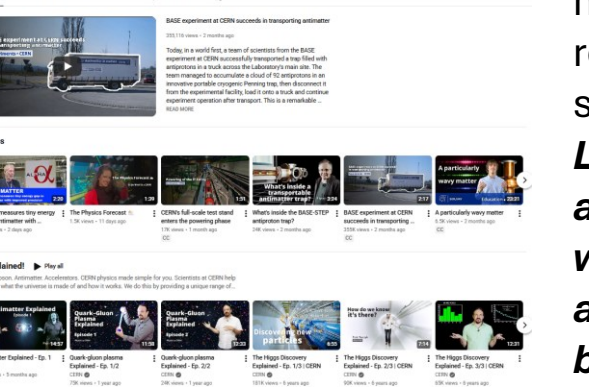
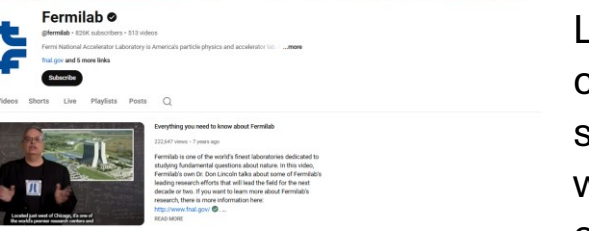
What I worked on before the Internet Revolution



<https://home.cern/first-run-3-physics-result-cms>



<https://www.youtube.com/user/fermilab>



Fermilab / Dr. Don Lincoln

This is probably the closest match in spirit: short-to-medium explainers, authoritative, friendly, and squarely about particle physics: quarks, neutrinos, antimatter, Higgs, accelerators, detectors, Standard Model, etc. Fermilab’s own video archive and YouTube playlists include a large “Dr. Don” set/public lectures. ([YouTube](#))

CERN YouTube + CERN Science pages

CERN’s channel is excellent for LHC/Higgs/antimatter/accelerator context, with some very clean “physics made simple” material. CERN’s own science page describes its main focus as particle physics, while noting broader programs in antimatter, nuclear/high-energy physics, cosmic rays, and related areas. ([YouTube](#))

Best polished conceptual explainer: Quanta Magazine

— **Standard Model video / particle physics coverage**

Quanta’s “Video Tour of the Standard Model,” with David Tong, is a great single link for a reunion-style “why this matters” slide. Quanta also has ongoing particle-physics reporting, including recent pieces on where the field stands after the LHC era. ([Quanta Magazine](#))

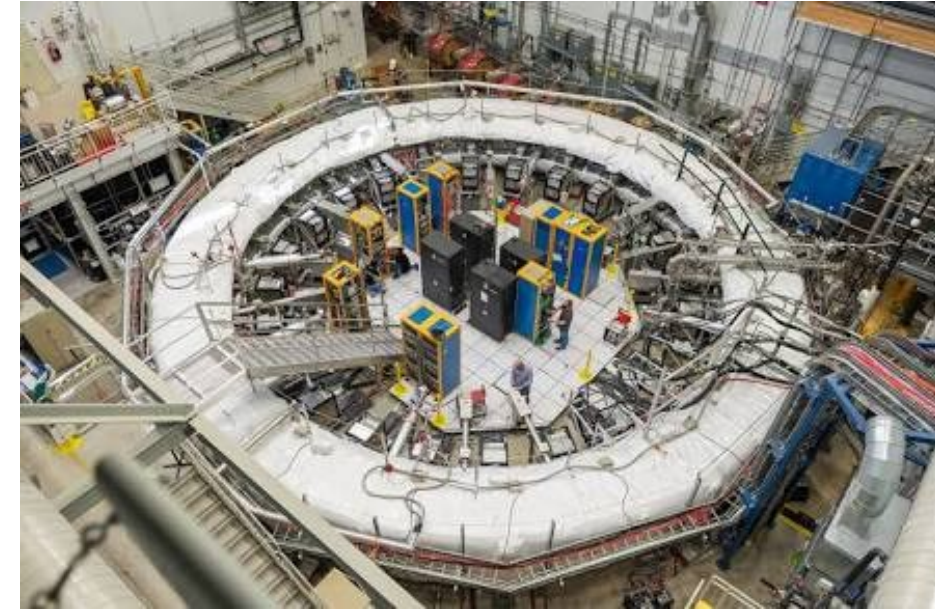
Learning: Science is reliable because it is reproducible, and in that sense can be used to predict the future within an allowable range of possibilities. What actually happens at the microscopic level is random, but the relative likelihoods of outcomes are knowable.

Science builds cumulatively, collectively, and internationally.

What do you mean likely to succeed? At what? At that?

There was this one bizarre thing I succeeded at as part of a gigantic team carrying on a grand tradition – it was in Big Science, in Experimental Particle Physics. I did that for 10 years 40 years ago, after which I went into Molecular Imaging in Medicine and left academia, but this year they gave the whole giant team from back then (and associated teams before and after) a “Breakthrough Prize” in an attempt to popularize Science, and I thought if I could make this particular subject popular with my North Central High School Class of 1976 Golden Reunion crowd, now that would be a success. Financial Success? Allow me to change the subject; I mostly got paid in stories – but some of them are killer. Like all stories they are only good if shared with friends. So anyway, our giant team succeeded in putting a leash on theorists everywhere by measuring the sum total of all vacuum quantum fluctuations in the vicinity of muons, which you can think of as unstable, overweight electrons that we watched decay...

Especially Physics, like when I was on the
Boston University Faculty in the 1990s



Above: The Muon g-2 storage ring is a 50-foot-diameter superconducting electromagnet

Below: Muon g-2 cultural artifacts – Breakthrough Prize Merch



Muon g-2: From Wobble to Breakthrough Prize

THIS IS AN ORVAL N. P. THEISEN MEMORIAL SLIDE

Medical Imaging, Molecular Imaging, and Radiation Therapy

RadiologyInfo.org —

Medical imaging & radiation therapy for patients

Best general public source. Covers CT, MRI, PET/CT, nuclear medicine, interventional radiology, radiation safety, and radiation therapy in patient-friendly language. It is produced by RSNA, ACR, and ASRT.

(Radiologyinfo.org)

SNMMI Patient Resources — PET, nuclear medicine, molecular imaging

Best public source for explaining how PET and molecular imaging differ from purely anatomical imaging. SNMMI describes molecular imaging as showing what is happening at the molecular and cellular level, including chemical and biological processes. (SNMMI)

RadiologyInfo PET/CT page — PET plus anatomy

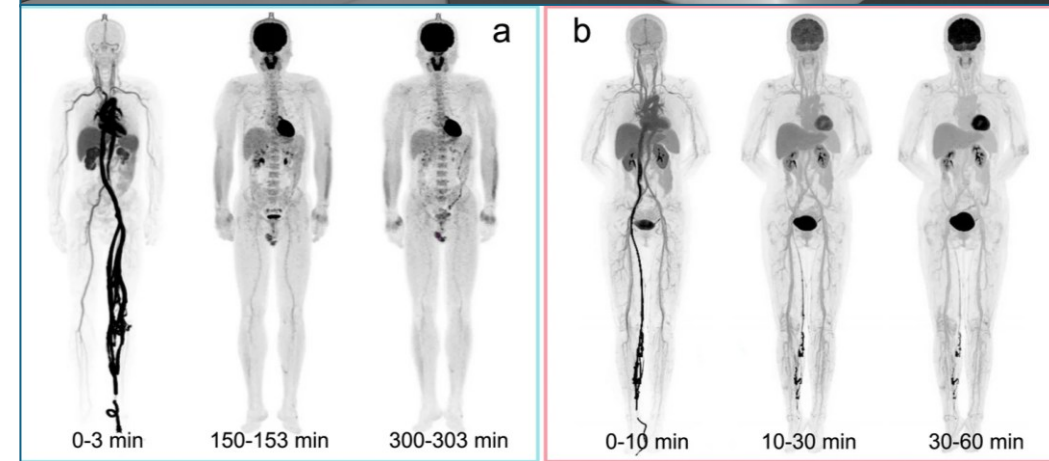
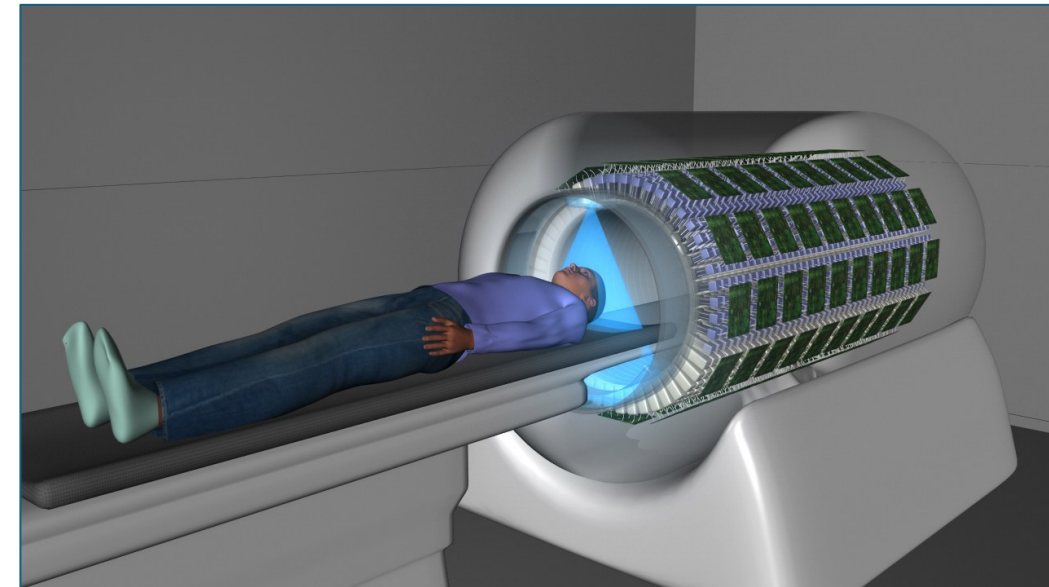
Good single link for classmates who want to understand PET/CT: PET measures body function/metabolism, while CT provides anatomical structure; together they give complementary information.

(Radiologyinfo.org)

RTAnswers / ASTRO — Radiation therapy education

Best patient-facing radiation oncology source. RTAnswers provides brochures, side-effect charts, videos, FAQs, and a glossary; ASTRO also has patient videos explaining what to expect during radiation therapy. (RTAnswers)

What I worked on after the Internet Revolution – Molecular Imaging



Performance and application of the total-body PET/CT scanner: a literature review

THIS IS AN ORVAL N. P. THEISEN MEMORIAL SLIDE

What has happened thus far in the AI Revolution – Deep Learning and Multimodal Molecular Imaging

NIBIB / NIH — Medical imaging and AI impact

Good public-government source for AI and multimodal imaging. NIH/NIBIB has material on medical imaging AI, fairness, and the emerging integration of clinical imaging with multimodal data for precision medicine. ([NIBIB](#))

FDA AI-Enabled Medical Devices list — What AI is actually cleared for use

Useful “reality check” link. FDA maintains a public list of AI-enabled medical devices authorized for marketing in the U.S.; it is especially relevant because radiology/imaging is one of the dominant areas for medical AI. ([U.S. Food and Drug Administration](#))

From Seeing Anatomy to Measuring Biology

CT/MRI/X-ray show structure. PET and molecular imaging show function, metabolism, and biology. Radiation therapy uses imaging to target treatment. AI is increasingly used to help reconstruct, detect, segment, quantify, and combine images with other clinical data.

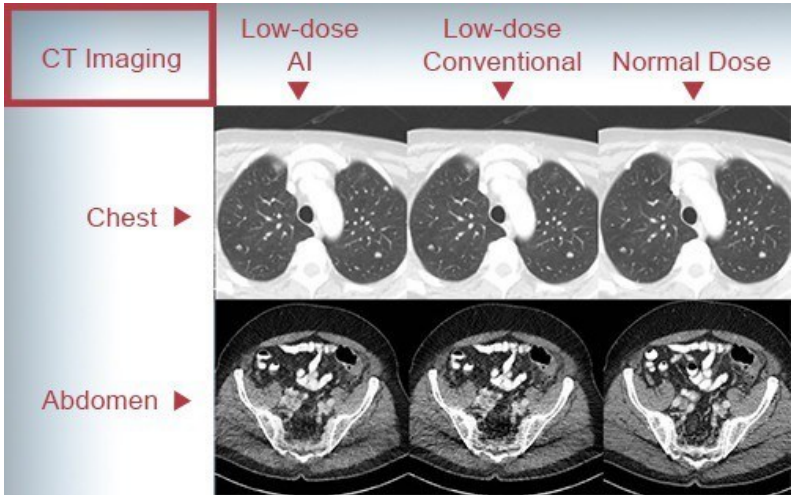
Where AI Is Changing Imaging

Reconstruction · denoising · segmentation · lesion detection · image registration · PET/CT and PET/MRI fusion · radiomics · treatment planning · multimodal clinical decision support.

Low-Dose & Fast Image Reconstruction

AI converts low-dose CT images to high-quality scans

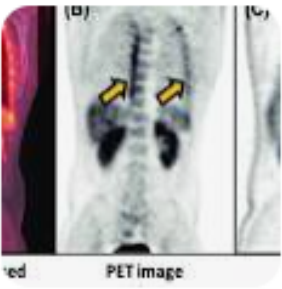
Traditionally, lower tracer doses or shorter scan times meant noisy, grainy images. AI models can reconstruct ultra-low-dose scans to match or exceed normal-dose quality, heavily suppressing image noise without losing spatial resolution



<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5414501/>
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12891154/>

Artifact Reduction & Attenuation Correction

Patient movement, metal implants (like hip replacements), and breathing cause visual artifacts and corrupt tracer quantification. AI algorithms dynamically predict and correct these errors—such as generating synthetic CT maps or filtering metal streaks—ensuring highly precise diagnostic values.



-Artifacts when a patient... ResearchGate

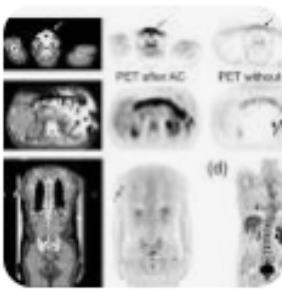
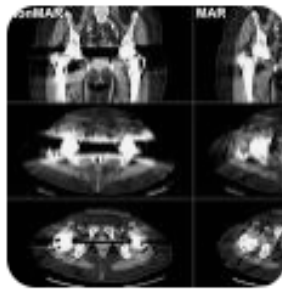


Fig. 4. Sources of imagin... ResearchGate



Quantitative Effect of Met... Springer Nature

https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Sources-of-imaging-artifacts-in-PET-CT-a-metal-implants-b-contrast-medium-c-body_fig2_343026078

The foundational difference between Catholic virtue ethics and Aristotelian ethics rests on how excellence is measured: Catholic virtues operate on a unipolar axis of alignment with God, while Aristotelian virtues operate on a bipolar axis of moderation between two extremes. [1]

The Structural Core: Unipolar vs. Bipolar

- Catholic Ethics (Unipolar):** Virtues are vertical alignments. Goodness is the presence of light, and sin is the absence of it. You cannot have too much charity or faith.
- Aristotelian Ethics (Bipolar):** Virtues are horizontal balances. Virtue is the Golden Mean. It sits precisely between a deficiency and an excess. Too much or too little of a trait is a vice. [2, 3, 4]

The Mapping: 7 Catholic Virtues to Aristotelian Means

Here is how the seven virtues map against Aristotle's framework of the mean:

The Four Cardinal Virtues (Human Virtues)

These map directly because Thomas Aquinas adopted them from classical philosophy, though Catholicism added a spiritual dimension. [5]

- Prudence (Right Reason in Action)**
- Aristotelian Mean:* **Prudence/Wisdom (Phronesis).**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Sits between **Impulsiveness** (deficiency of thought) and **Analysis Paralysis** (excess of thought). [6, 7, 8]
- Justice (Giving Others Their Due)**
- Aristotelian Mean:* **Justice.**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Sits between **Suffering Injustice** (proportional deficiency) and **Inflicting Injustice** (proportional excess). [9]
- Fortitude (Courage)**
- Aristotelian Mean:* **Courage.**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Sits between **Cowardice** (too much fear) and **Rashness** (too little fear/recklessness). [10, 11, 12]
- Temperance (Self-Control)**
- Aristotelian Mean:* **Temperance.**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Sits between **Insensibility** (inability to enjoy pleasure) and **Self-Indulgence** (overindulgence). [13, 14, 15]

The Three Theological Virtues (Divine Infused Virtues)

These do not fit cleanly into Aristotle's bipolar system. In Catholic theology, these are infused by grace and cannot be taken to excess. However, comparing them to Aristotle reveals deep conceptual shifts. [16]

- Faith (Belief in God and His Revelations)**
- Aristotelian Analog:* **Intellectual Truth/Conviction.**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Aristotle would view a healthy mind sitting between **Skepticism/Cynicism** (deficiency of trust) and **Credulity/Gullibility** (excess of trust).
- Hope (Desire and Expectation of Eternal Life)**
- Aristotelian Analog:* **Magnanimity (Greatness of Soul).**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Magnanimity sits between **Pusillanimity** (underestimating oneself) and **Vanity** (overestimating oneself). In a purely secular sense, hope sits between **Despair** (deficiency) and **Presumption** (excess). [17, 18, 19, 20]
- Charity (Love of God Above All, and Neighbor for His Sake)**
- Aristotelian Analog:* **Highest Friendship (Philia).**
- The Bipolar Axis:* Aristotle's friendship sits between **Malice/Hostility** (deficiency) and **Obsequiousness/Flattery** (excess). For Aristotle, you cannot love an enemy, whereas Catholic Charity demands it. [21, 22, 23, 24]

Summary of the Divergence: If you want to explore further, we can look closer at how **Thomas Aquinas bridged these two worlds** in the Summa, or we can look at the **different definitions of happiness** (Beatitude vs. Eudaimonia) that drive these two systems.

[1] <https://study.com>

[2] <https://study.com>

[3] <https://www.psychologytoday.com>

[4] <https://thedispatch.com>

[5] <https://www.davidpcassidy.com>

[6] <https://academic.oup.com>

[7] <https://www.youtube.com>

[8] <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov>

[9] <https://philosophy-models.blog>

[10] <https://bestiary.ca>

[11] <https://people.wku.edu>

[12] <https://www.academia.edu>

[13] <https://www.planksip.org>

[14] <https://louis.pressbooks.pub>

[15] <https://www.slideshare.net>

[16] <https://www.artsofliberty.org>

[17] <https://www.lesswrong.com>

[18] <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com>

[19] <https://philosophybites.com>

[20] <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com>

[21] <https://mcgrathblog.nd.edu>

[22] <https://catholicinrecovery.com>

[23] <https://covenantcatholic.org>

[24] <https://www.cambridge.org>

[25] <https://academic.oup.com>

[26] <https://review.catechetics.com>

[27] <https://www.pdcnet.org>

[28] <https://www.cambridge.org>

Catholic Virtue (Unipolar) [25, 26, 27, 28]	Aristotelian Mean (Bipolar)	Deficiency (Aristotle)	Excess (Aristotle)
Prudence	Prudence	Impulsiveness	Over-thinking
Justice	Justice	Submissiveness	Dominance
Fortitude	Courage	Cowardice	Recklessness
Temperance	Temperance	Insensibility	Licentiousness
Faith	Truth/Trust	Cynicism	Gullibility
Hope	Magnanimity	Despair / Meanness	Presumption / Vanity
Charity	High Friendship	Hostility	Obsequiousness

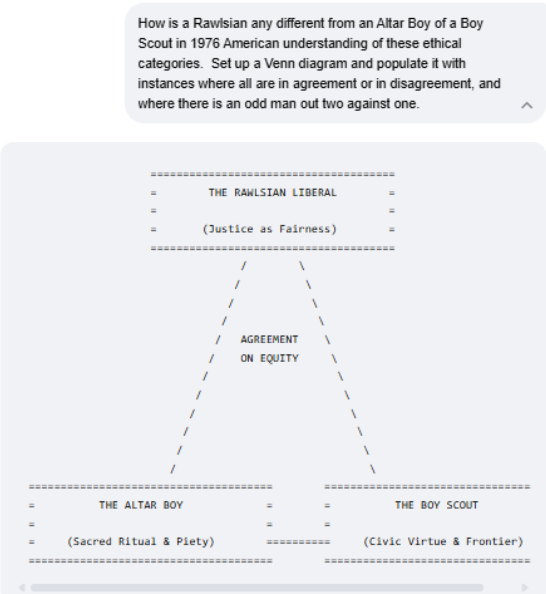
Virtus Catholica (Unipolaris)	Medium Aristotelicum (Bipolaris)	Deficientia (Aristoteles)	Excessus (Aristoteles)
Prudentia	Prudentia	Temeritas / Impulsivitas	Nimia Deliberatio / Astutia
Iustitia	Iustitia	Submissio	Dominatio
Fortitudo	Fortitudo / Audacia	Timiditas	Temeritas / Audacia
Temperantia	Temperantia	Insensibilitas	Intemperantia / Licentiositas
Fides	Veritas / Fides	Diffidentia / Cynicismus	Credulitas
Spes	Magnanimitas	Desperatio / Pusillanimitas	Praesumptio / Vanitas
Caritas	Amicitia Extensa	Hostilitas	Assentatio / Obsequium

THIS IS A LAURA LEE BRISCOE MEMORIAL SLIDE

An Altar Boy, a Boy Scout, and a Rawlsian Liberal Walk into a Bar...

To understand how a **Rawlsian liberal** (following John Rawls's landmark 1971 book *A Theory of Justice*) differs from a **1976 American Altar Boy** or **Boy Scout**, we must look at the mid-1970s cultural landscape.

In 1976—the American Bicentennial—the Altar Boy and Boy Scout represented traditional, institution-driven, baseline American morality. Rawls represented the new, secular, institutionalized academic framework for justice. While they often arrive at similar moral conclusions, their underlying operating systems are completely different. Here is how these three ethical categories map out across a Venn diagram of agreement and conflict.



Two Against One: The Rawlsian as the "Odd Man Out"

Cases where the traditional 1976 institutionalists align against the secular philosopher.

- **The Source of Moral Authority:**
 - *Altar Boy & Boy Scout:* Align together. Both look to a **transcendent or historical authority** outside themselves—God, the Church, the US Constitution, or the Scout Oath ("Duty to God and my Country").
 - *Rawlsian:* Disagrees. Rejects external, inherited authorities. Moral rules must be constructed rationally from scratch behind a **Veil of Ignorance**, where no one knows their status, class, or religion ahead of time.
- **The Value of Tradition and Ritual:**
 - *Altar Boy & Boy Scout:* Align together. Both find deep ethical grounding in **tradition, hierarchy, and uniforms**. The Altar Boy respects liturgical vestments and Latin/English rites; the Scout respects badges, ranks (Eagle), and flag ceremonies.
 - *Rawlsian:* Disagrees. Rituals and traditional hierarchies have no inherent moral value. They are only permissible if they do not create unfair structural inequalities for those at the bottom.

Two Against One: The Altar Boy as the "Odd Man Out"

Cases where the secular philosopher and the civic scout align against the sectarian religious figure.

- **The Scope of the "Good Community":**
 - *Rawlsian & Boy Scout:* Align together. Both operate on a **pluralistic, civic model** designed to include people of different creeds. The 1976 Boy Scout framework includes a vague, non-sectarian "Duty to God" that accommodates Protestants, Catholics, and Jews alike. Rawls seeks a "political conception of justice" that creates a stable framework for a deeply pluralistic society.
 - *Altar Boy:* Disagrees. His specific ethical universe is tied directly to **dogmatic, sacramental, and denominational truth** (Roman Catholicism). Salvation and cosmic order are tied to a specific Church, not just general civic harmony.

Three-Way Agreement (The Center)

Where all three agree on the correct ethical action, though for different reasons.

- **Helping the Downtrodden:** All three agree society must care for the poor and vulnerable.
 - *Rawlsian:* Dictated by the **Difference Principle** (inequalities are only justified if they work to the maximum benefit of the least-advantaged).
 - *Altar Boy:* Driven by the **Gospel mandate** and corporal works of mercy (feeding the hungry, clothing the naked).
 - *Boy Scout:* Driven by the Scout Law to be **"Helpful"** and **"Kind,"** performing a "good turn daily."
- **Basic Fairness in Competition:** Cheating or rigging a game is universally rejected.
 - *Rawlsian:* Violates the principle of **Fair Equality of Opportunity**.
 - *Altar Boy:* Violates the Seventh Commandment ("**Thou shalt not steal**").
 - *Boy Scout:* Violates the first point of the Scout Law: **"A Scout is Trustworthy."**

Two Against One: The Boy Scout as the "Odd Man Out"

Cases where the philosopher and the church server align against the rugged frontier individualist.

- **The Myth of Self-Reliance vs. Systemic Interdependence:**
 - *Rawlsian & Altar Boy:* Align together against pure meritocracy. Rawls argues that natural talents are a "common asset" and that no one inherently *deserves* their genetic luck or wealthy upbringing. The Altar Boy is grounded in the concept of **Grace**—the idea that all good things are an unmerited gift from God, not something earned purely by personal grit.
 - *Boy Scout:* Disagrees. The 1976 Scout ethos is heavily underlaid by **frontier self-reliance, survivalism, and rugged individualism**. The Scout earns his way up through personal mastery of skills (Merit Badges), embodying the ideal that character and hard work are what elevate a person.

THIS IS A JERRY HOPKINS MEMORIAL SLIDE (whether he's still around or not)

“Be sure to use your talents for the betterment of mankind – it’s ever more important that a scientist believe now. – Jerry Hopkins, 1976

Q (from Me): *I remember reading a book of intellectual or religious history of thought and anthropology regarding conceptions of the divinity correlating with progressively larger collections of humans from clans to tribes to kingdoms to empires, in particular with the rise of monotheism. Can you help me recall the title for what I think must have been a popular book since it was quite entertaining.*

Overview of Differences

Feature 	<u><i>The Evolution of God</i></u> (Robert Wright)	<u><i>Big Gods</i></u> (Ara Norenzayan)
Primary Discipline	Historical analysis, game theory, journalism.	Evolutionary psychology, quantitative anthropology.
Core Mechanism	Non-zero-sum games (intergroup trade, diplomacy, and politics).	Supernatural surveillance (the psychological effect of being watched).
Primary Focus	The historical development and scriptures of the Abrahamic faiths .	The broader cross-cultural data and cognitive mechanics of religion.
Subtlety / Tone	Narrative-driven, textually specific, philosophical.	Empirical, experimental, data-driven.

A (from It): The book you are looking for is almost certainly "**Big Gods: How Religion Transformed Cooperation and Conflict**" by evolutionary anthropologist and psychologist Ara Norenzayan. It explores exactly this premise: how the social scale of human groups directly influenced their concept of divinity.

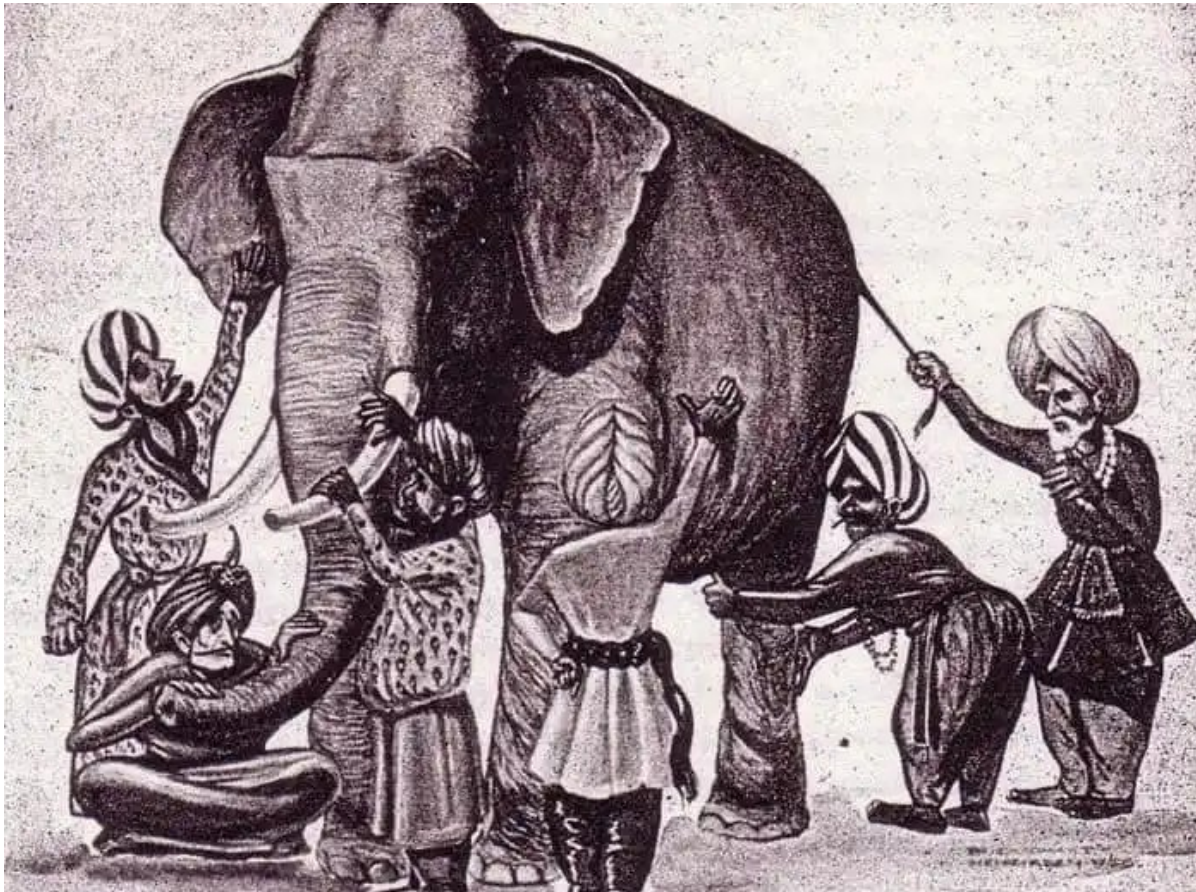
Key concepts from the book include:
•**From Bands to Empires:** As human groups scaled up from tight-knit hunter-gatherer clans to anonymous, sprawling empires, purely localized or ancestral spirits were no longer enough to maintain order or enforce cooperation among strangers.
•**The Rise of "Big Gods":** This transition necessitated the evolution of moralizing, omniscient, and watchful deities—the "Big Gods" of the major monotheistic and large-scale polytheistic faiths. Sincere belief in these gods served as a psychological mechanism to build trust, enforce social norms, and prevent free-riding in massive societies. You can find the book and read reviews on Princeton University Press or Amazon.

Note: If this doesn't sound exactly right, you might also be thinking of Robert Wright's "The Evolution of God," which maps a similar trajectory from animism to monotheism through the lens of human history.

I personally believe in God, just not in a supernatural One – Bill Worstell, 2026

The Many-Sidedness of Reality

The overarching metaphor which I have applied is the Buddha's parable of the blind men and the elephant. Now combine that with Applied Mathematics, also known as Computer Science or more recently Data Science (AI for short, being Artificial in having been built by us, and Intelligent in the sense of adept at communicating high impact information effectively). What will these blind men do, once they have some idea (or so they think) of what this elephant is, and what it might do?



We live in a hyperlinked reality, but we couldn't read or write that way in 1976. Now we can: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Poems_of_John_Godfrey_Saxe/The_Blind_Men_and_the_Elephant https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Blind_men_and_an_elephant - The above engraving was published in 1907. Saxe's popular poem, first published in 1872, could well have been taught in NC's inaugural English Lit classes of 1908. At Harvard, Ralph Waldo Emerson and his student Henry Thoreau loved Sanskrit.

THIS IS A ZOE LYNETTE MCGARRY (NEE SQUIRES) MEMORIAL SLIDE

In the recorded texts, the Buddha does not cite the parable as coming from an earlier source, but rather tells it as a story about a king from the past. [Access to Insight +2](#)

The earliest known written record of this parable is found in the **Tittha Sutta** (part of the *Udāna* in the Pali Canon), which dates back to roughly **500 BCE** during the lifetime of the Buddha. [Wikipedia](#)

How the Buddha Frames the Story

In the *Tittha Sutta*, the Buddha uses the parable to address his monks about rival religious teachers who were constantly arguing over spiritual truths. [Buddhism now +1](#)

- **The Framing:** The Buddha begins by saying, "*Once in the past, bhikkhus, there was a certain king in this same Savatthi...*".
- **The Narrative:** He describes how this ancient king gathered blind men to examine an elephant just for his own amusement to watch them argue.
- **The Conclusion:** After telling the story, the Buddha delivers his own "inspired utterance" (verse), comparing the blind men to sectarian teachers who only see one side of the truth and argue out of attachment to their own views. [Buddhism now +2](#)

Historical Context & Debate

While the *written* record belongs to Buddhism, scholars of Indian philosophy point out a few nuances: [Wikipedia +1](#)

- **Oral Tradition:** It is highly likely the story existed as a popular regional folklore or proverb in ancient India before the Buddha adopted it. Proverbs during this era were often shared across cultures before being written down.
- **Jain Claims:** Some scholars suggest the core idea aligns so perfectly with the Jain philosophical concept of *Anekantavada* (the many-sidedness of reality) that it may have originated in the ancient Jain oral tradition around or before the 5th century BCE. [Facebook · Mini Philosophy +3](#)



Occam's razor (also known as the law or principle of parsimony) is a problem-solving heuristic stating that when presented with competing explanations for the same phenomenon, you should prefer the simpler one. The theory with the fewest unproven assumptions or entities is most likely to be correct. [1, 2, 3]

[Occam's Razor - Definition & Examples \(4 Minute Explainer\)](#), YouTube · Helpful Professor Explains! · 2025 M02 1

Core Principles

- **Origin:** Attributed to the 14th-century English philosopher and Franciscan friar **William of Ockham**. He famously stated (in Latin): "*Plurality should not be posited without necessity*". [1, 4, 5]
- **Not Always the "Simplest" Literal Truth:** It does not mean you should blindly accept the most basic answer. Rather, your explanation shouldn't be *more complex* than absolutely necessary to account for all the facts. [4, 6]
- **A Rule of Thumb:** It is a logical guiding tool, not an immutable law of the universe. Complex phenomena sometimes require complex answers, but starting with the simplest hypothesis helps avoid over-complicating things unnecessarily. [4, 5, 6]

Avoiding conspiracy thinking...

Real-World Examples

- **Everyday Life:** If your internet suddenly stops working, the simplest explanation is that your router is temporarily malfunctioning. A more complex, less probable explanation is that extraterrestrial interference has targeted your specific neighborhood network.
- **Medicine:** In diagnosing a patient, a physician will primarily search for *one* underlying medical condition that accounts for all a patient's symptoms, rather than assuming the patient has five separate, simultaneous diseases (a concept known as diagnostic parsimony). [4, 7]
- **Science:** When evaluating models of the solar system, heliocentrism (planets orbiting the sun) provides a mathematically simpler and cleaner explanation for the observed movements of celestial bodies than geocentrism (complex, looping epicycles of planets orbiting the earth). [8]

[Occam's Razor Explained](#), YouTube · Mike Gastin · 2022 M02 3

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org>
- [2] <https://www.ebsco.com>
- [3] <https://www.desy.de>
- [4] <https://www.tiktok.com>
- [5] <https://www.britannica.com>
- [6] <https://www.youtube.com>
- [7] <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov>
- [8] <https://www.reddit.com>



Who is the Mystery Woman named Rieken next to Mr. Rieken?

1988



1981



Rolling Stones-start me up

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzlgJ-SfKYE&list=RDZzlgJ-SfKYE&start_radio=1

Kim Rieken, Social Studies

Kim Rieken is a highly respected, long-tenured **Social Studies and Government teacher** who spent her career inspiring students at North Central High School. [1]

Archival records from The Spokesman-Review highlight her notable contributions and background:

- **An NC Fixture:** She started teaching at North Central when the "new" building facility first opened its doors in **1981**. [1]
- **The Legacy:** She was a foundational pillar of the Social Studies department, widely known for teaching high-level courses like **Advanced Placement (AP) U.S. History** and **Government**. [1, 2]
- **Award Nominee:** Her dedication to her students earned her a nomination for Spokane's "**Best Teacher Award**" in 1998. [3]
- **Community Impact:** She famously taught local historical figures, including former Seattle Deputy Mayor and regional SBA Administrator Mike Fong, who fondly remembered her classroom as a major influence on his career in public service. [2, 4]

[1] <https://www.spokesman.com>

[2] <https://www.spokesman.com>

[3] <https://www.spokesman.com>

[4] <https://dc.medill.northwestern.edu>

🎵 Her 1981 Theme Song: "*Start Me Up*" (The Rolling Stones)

The year **1981** was a historic time for North Central High School. The school moved into its brand-new building facility, and Kim Rieken arrived to light a fire in the Social Studies department.

The number one rock anthem of 1981—"**Start Me Up**" by **The Rolling Stones**—perfectly captures the high-energy drive she brought to AP U.S. History and Government.

THIS IS A MELVIN DEAN RIEKEN MEMORIAL SLIDE (whether he's still around or not)

This is for Mr. Rodkey, Mr. Exley, Mr. Theisen, Mr. Erickson,
and Mrs. Murray's Husband...



WWII Vets – The Greatest Generation

My personal sentiments, but I learned U.S. History from Mr. Chalich...

PUBLIC-SPIRITED STEM & EDUCATION
ARE THE **AMERICAN WAY!**

PUBLIC-SPIRITED INTERNATIONAL SCIENCE AND ACADEMIC FREEDOM
OPEN INQUIRY. PEER REVIEW AND TRANSPARENCY.
REPRODUCIBLE RESULTS AND SHARED KNOWLEDGE.
FREEDOM FROM POLITICAL INTERFERENCE

TRUSTWORTHY, TRANSPARENT & TESTED TECHNOLOGY
PUBLICALLY ACCOUNTABLE, VERIFIED AND TRUTHFUL
ENGINEERING IN THE PUBLIC INTEREST
SAFETY, INTEGRITY, PUBLIC BENEFIT & HONEST MANAGEMENT

EVIDENCE-BASED MEDICINE
SCIENTIFIC CONSENSUS,
TRANSPARENT ECONOMICS
PUBLIC EDUCATION AND PUBLIC SERVICE
FREE INQUIRY, TRUTH,
PUBLIC OUTREACH

GOVERNMENT SERVES RATHER THAN RULES THE PEOPLE

LIES, HATRED, MISINFORMATION AND WAR-MONGERING

POLITICIZED SCIENCE

HARMFUL TECHNOLOGY

CORRUPTION AND SELF-DEALING

POLITICIZED MEDICINE

MILITARIZED PROPAGANDA

THE TRUMP REGIME IS **UN-AMERICAN!**

NO KINGS RALLY · MARCH 28, 2026

GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE BY THE PEOPLE FOR THE PEOPLE

GOVERNMENT OF THE DICTATOR BY THE DICTATOR FOR THE DICTATOR



FREEDOM & SELF-GOVERNMENT
ARE THE **AMERICAN WAY!**

AMERICAN CONSTITUTIONAL DEMOCRACY

ARTICLE I · THE LEGISLATURE

We the People

IN CONGRESS ASSEMBLED

↓

SERVES THE PEOPLE & HOLDS THE EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABLE

ARTICLE II · THE EXECUTIVE

THE PRESIDENT SERVES RATHER THAN RULES THE PEOPLE

ARTICLE III · THE JUDICIARY

AUTOCRACY KLEPTOCRACY TYRANNY

LIES CRUEL AND HATRED CRIMES

VIOLENT NARCISSISM

PREDATORY SOCIOPATHY

MURDEROUS NIHILISM

THE TRUMP REGIME IS **UN-AMERICAN!**

NO KINGS RALLY · MARCH 28, 2026

GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE BY THE PEOPLE FOR THE PEOPLE

GOVERNMENT OF THE DICTATOR BY THE DICTATOR FOR THE DICTATOR



New Tools for Research, Review, Expression, and Presentation are constantly advancing, and it is up to us to put their use to our best advantage in working for our preferred society.



That's what I learned in High School, back when we were Indians, and now that we're a Wolfpack...

THIS IS A GEORGE CHALICH MEMORIAL SLIDE



My personal sentiments, but I learned social action from Mr. Hughes...

FREEDOM & OPPORTUNITY
ARE THE **AMERICAN** WAY!

FREEDOM OF BELIEF AND CONSCIENCE
RELIGIOUS AND SECULAR RIGHTS TO INTELLECTUAL
AND MORAL AUTONOMY, CONSISTENT WITH THE
GOLDEN RULE AND MUTUAL RESPECT
FREEDOM OF EXPRESSION AND TRUTH
RIGHT TO FREE ACCESS TO TRUE INFORMATION AND TO DISSENT
FREEDOM FROM WANT
RIGHT TO HIGHER STANDARDS OF LIVING WITH ACCESS TO AND
OPPORTUNITY FOR GAINFUL AND PRODUCTIVE EMPLOYMENT
FREEDOM FROM FEAR
RIGHT TO COLLECTIVE SELF-DEFENSE WITH FREE
ALLIES AGAINST AUTOCRATIC AGGRESSORS
FREEDOM FROM ARBITRARY POWER
RESPECT FOR THE SOVEREIGNTY OF
OTHERS AS WISHED FOR OURSELVES

GOVERNMENT
OF THE PEOPLE
BY THE PEOPLE
FOR THE
PEOPLE

GOVERNMENT
OF THE DICTATOR
BY THE DICTATOR
FOR THE DICTATOR



1783

No
KINGS

LIES, HATRED,
MISINFORMATION
AND WAR-MONGERING

FALSE
PIETY

MEDIA AND
INFORMATION
CENSORSHIP
AND DISHONESTY

CORRUPTION
AND
SELF-DEALING

HUMAN
RIGHTS
ABUSES

WARS OF
CHOICE AND
CONQUEST

THE TRUMP REGIME IS **UN-AMERICAN!**

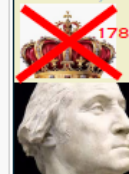
NO KINGS RALLY - MARCH 28, 2026

LIBERTY & JUSTICE FOR ALL
ARE THE **AMERICAN** WAY!

AMERICAN CIVIL LIBERTIES UNDER THE CONSTITUTION
FREEDOM OF INFORMATION & ACCOUNTABILITY
TRANSPARENT GOVERNMENT, FREE PRESS, FREEDOM
OF INFORMATION, OPEN DEMOCRACY, RULE OF LAW
VOTING RIGHTS & WOMEN'S RIGHTS
UNIVERSAL SUFFRAGE, EQUAL PROTECTION, REPRODUCTIVE AUTONOMY
WORKER'S RIGHTS
FAIR WAGES, UNION RIGHTS, SAFE WORK, ECONOMIC DIGNITY
CRIMINAL AND CIVIL RIGHTS
DUE PROCESS, EQUAL JUSTICE, HABEAS CORPUS,
CIVIL LIBERTIES, ASSUMPTION OF INNOCENCE
EQUALITY AND EQUAL PROTECTION
VOTING RIGHTS AND EQUAL PROTECTION
TO ALL OF ANY RACE, COLOR, AND
CREED, BIRTHRIGHT CITIZENSHIP

GOVERNMENT
OF THE PEOPLE
BY THE PEOPLE
FOR THE
PEOPLE

GOVERNMENT
OF THE DICTATOR
BY THE DICTATOR
FOR THE DICTATOR



1783

No
KINGS

ABUSE AND
DENIAL OF
CIVIL LIBERTIES
AND JUSTICE

BIGOTRY,
LIES,
HATE
SPEECH

LIES, CRIMES,
CORRUPTION
AND ABUSE OF
LEGAL SYSTEM
AND POWERS

LIES, CRIMES,
CORRUPTION,
SELF-DEALING,
BETRAYAL OF
OUR LEGACY

LIES, CRIMES,
HUMAN
RIGHTS
ABUSES

JUDICIAL CAPTURE,
PARTISAN ABUSES
OF JUDICIAL POWER.
BETRAYAL OF SWORN
DUTY TO DEFEND
CONSTITUTION

THE TRUMP REGIME IS **UN-AMERICAN!**

NO KINGS RALLY - MARCH 28, 2026

Egalitarian
Symmetry
and
Practical
Arguments
for Diverse
Viewpoints
demand
respectful
debate
plus
sympathy
and
empathy
for friend
and foe
alike.

That's what I learned in High School, back when we were Indians, and now that we're a Wolfpack...
THIS IS A GERARD EAMON DE VALERA HUGHES MEMORIAL SLIDE

In the new millenium, we have NC historians.

spokesman.com/stories/2008/jun/05/nc-marks-centennial/

NEWS > VOICES

NC marks centennial

Thu., June 5, 2008

X

Email

Reddit



By Lisa Leinberger 
lisa@spokesman.com
(509) 459-5449

“Nearly 300 students, all in the first high school year, left their names yesterday morning on the rolls of the North Central high school, the doors of which were thrown open yesterday for the first time.”

The Spokesman-Review, Sept. 9, 1908

In the century since those words were published in The Spokesman-Review, thousands more students have passed through the school’s halls, whether the fabled old building that was torn down in 1981 or the new that replaced it. North Central opened with only 12 classrooms and a promise for more.

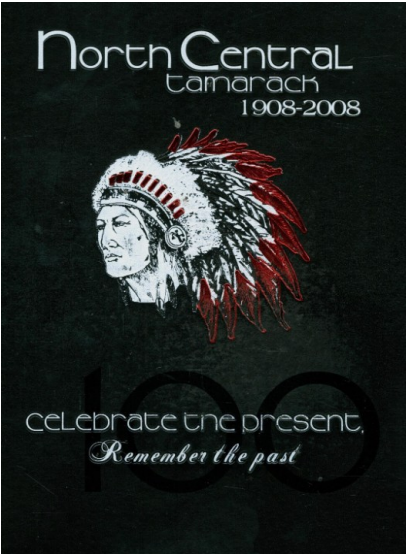
“The plans for the entire high school,” said the 1908 newspaper article, “to be built a wing at a time, call for 80 rooms and will constitute the finest high school west of Chicago.”

The article went on to say that the school had the luxury of restrooms reserved only for teachers, “handsomely furnished and comfortably finished, with private closets and washrooms.”

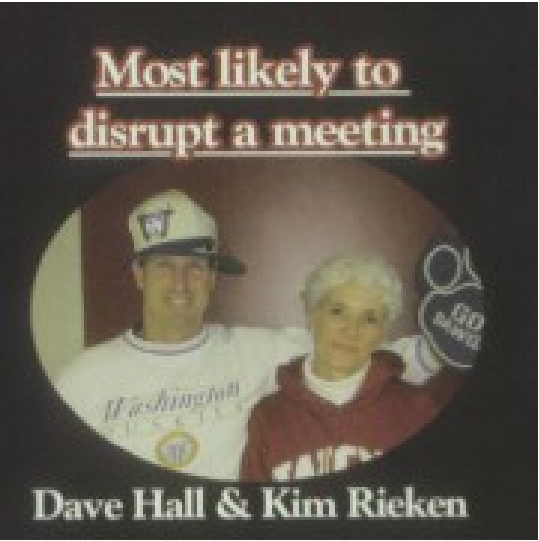
Alan Hanson, a retired NC teacher, former student and now the school’s unofficial historian, said when he started as a student in the old building he noticed the wooden stairs had been worn down from generations of students going either up or down, depending on which wing of the building they were in, since the staircases weren’t big enough to fit students going in both directions.

He said he just knew that he was in a very old, traditional place.

The school is proud of its traditions. and makes the claim that it is the oldest continual high school in Spokane.



2008



Kim Ricken, Social Studies

<https://www.classmates.com/siteui/yearbooks/4182717980?page=79>

Alan Hanson, a retired NC teacher, former student and now the school’s unofficial historian, said that when he started as a student in the old building he noticed the wooden stairs had been worn down from generations of students going either up or down, depending on which wing of the building they were in, since the staircases weren’t big enough to fit students going in both directions.

THIS IS A MELVIN DEAN RIEKEN MEMORIAL SLIDE (whether he’s still around or not)

And we know how to reach them...

Yes. The “unofficial historian” is **Alan Hanson**, a **1967 North Central graduate**, retired NC teacher, and longtime Alumni Association leader. In the 2008 centennial article, *The Spokesman-Review* calls him “a retired NC teacher, former student and now the school’s unofficial historian,” and quotes him extensively on the old building, early NC traditions, Elsa Pinkham, Lowell Bradford, and memorabilia saved when the old school was torn down in 1981. ([Spokesman-Review](#))

He was still publicly active well after that. In 2021, *The Spokesman-Review* identified Alan Hanson as “a 1967 graduate of North Central High School, a retired teacher of the school, and the current president of the North Central High School Alumni Association.” ([Spokesman-Review](#)) A 2024 NC Alumni Scholarship form still used **Alan Hanson** as the scholarship mailing/contact person and gave the alumni phone number as **509-466-3562**. ([Core Docs](#)) It does look as though the **formal presidency has passed on**. The current North Central Alumni Association “Who We Are” page lists **Zack Zappone ’09** as president, says he has been president since **2023**, and gives his school email as zackz@spokaneschools.org. The same page lists **Kathie McGonigle ’70** as secretary, **Chris Krauel ’78** as treasurer, **Darlene Linahan ’63** for membership, and **Al Hanson** as editor managing the Association newsletter. ([North Central Alumni](#))

So I’d summarize it this way:

Alan Hanson appears still to be an active NC alumni/history contact, but no longer the formal Alumni Association president. The official leadership torch seems to have passed to Zack Zappone ’09, while Hanson remains connected through alumni history/newsletter/scholarship work.

Best contact points:

North Central Alumni Association

Email: northcentralalumni@gmail.com

Phone: **509-466-3562**

The Association site lists both at the bottom of its pages and on the contact page. ([North Central Alumni](#))

Zack Zappone ’09, current Alumni Association president

Email: zackz@spokaneschools.org ([North Central Alumni](#))

For Tamarack/yearbook questions specifically:

The Alumni Association’s Yearbooks/Tamarack page says extra Tamaracks are available for many years and gives the current yearbook teacher as **Amy Sinisterra**, AmySi@spokaneschools.org. It also notes that online Tamaracks from **1912–1976** can be read through Spokane Public Library. ([North Central Alumni](#))

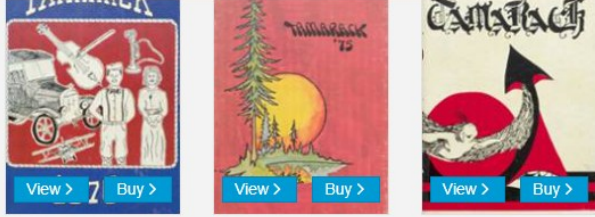
One caution: the Alumni site has a small inconsistency. The contact page still labels “Alan Hanson ’67 President,” while the current “Who We Are” page says Zack Zappone has been president since 2023. I would treat **Zack as the current official president**, and **Alan Hanson as the elder historian/newsletter/scholarship contact** unless they clarify otherwise.

THIS IS A MELVIN DEAN RIEKEN MEMORIAL SLIDE, (whether he’s still around or not)

And we've got a solid database, just behind a bit of a paywall...

classmates.com/siteui/places/school/north-central-high-school/3347/gallery?year=2002&bypass=1&gl=1*nudntt*_up*MQ...*_ga*MTM4MDQ5NzU2M4xNzgwNzU5NDQ1*_ga_456HUP09MM*czE3ODA3NTk0NDUkbzEkZzAkDE3ODA3NTk0NDUkajYwJGw...

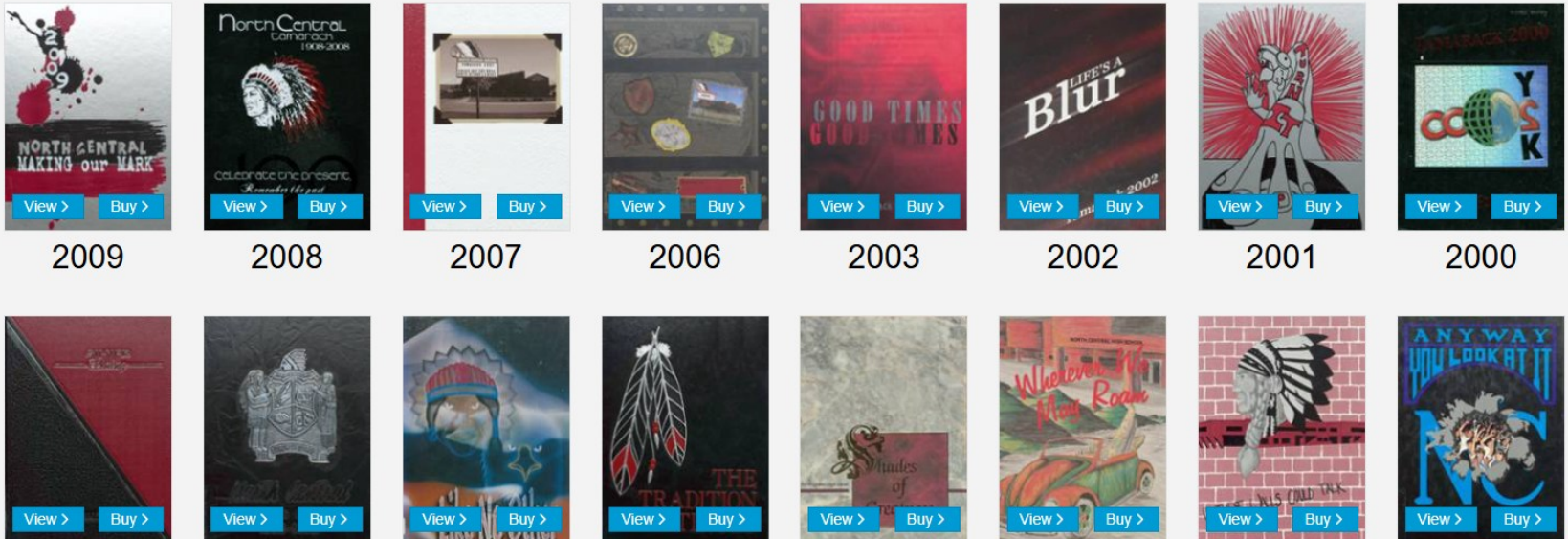
abraham.html https://en.wikipedia... Google Accounts Google Settings MassHR https://doc-08-24-a... Work Verizon | My Verizo... Gmail YouTube Maps UI Online News Files - Dropbox All Bookmarks



1976 1975 1974

All 146 yearbooks for North Central High School

Collapse



2009 2008 2007 2006 2003 2002 2001 2000

1999 1998 1997 1996 1994 1993 1992 1990

At Classmates.com

<https://www.classmates.com/siteui/places/school/north-central-high-school/3347/gallery?year=2002&bypass=1>

Thank You!

And Sorry for those not discussed here – this is just from my individual perspective.

But the links are there for everybody, so you can make your own from the Tamaracks and AI queries as shown here for anyone you like.